

Lee goes on a lucky streak at the casino and thinks he's cleaning up but when it all goes awry, he finds himself in a sticky situation with the wrong people. His wife improvises a way out of their debts but now that she's in control, she demands that he now 'cleans up' the mess...

THE CUCKOLD COLLECTION



Cleaning Up

PAUL
GARLAND

Paul Garland

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A Note To The Reader

Also By Paul Garland

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The Cuckold Collection

Early in 2020, I decided to start a new series of original stories, focusing more on the ‘cuckolding’ types of relationship rather than just the ‘hotwife’ aspect, which my ‘No Angels’ and ‘Cerulean Erotica Presents’ series explored, albeit more ambiguously in some books than in others.

I came up with six different themes that I wanted to explore and after I completed the first book, ‘Size Matters,’ a friend of mine inspired another story and so ‘Ex Appeal’ became the second in the series. The third book, ‘Dark Curiosity’ was inspired by a true story a fan wrote to me about and ‘Locked Up’ came to me in a weird dream I had. The previous book to this, ‘Access Denied’ was inspired during the events of the coronavirus lockdown.

‘Cleaning Up’ is the last book in the Cuckold Collection (for now, at least) and was born from my own love of the game of poker and the awareness of the dangers of gambling and from the popular trope of women having to dig their men out of the shit when things go awry. I also hadn’t written a book featuring more dominant female lead characters and so decided to go down

that line this time and see how it worked out. I think it worked out great but I'd love to know what you think, so feel free to give me your feedback.

If you're not already aware of my other books, feel free to check out my other series: 'No Angels' (six novels and six novelettes), 'Cerulean Erotica Presents' and 'Sexy Season Stories', all available from your favourite digital eBook retailers.

Thanks for reading!

Paul

1

Chapter 1

“Pocket aces,” I said, triumphantly flipping my two cards over. I had the ace of spades and ace of hearts in my hand, which along with the two other aces on ‘the flop’, the five cards dealt up onto the table, gave me the winning hand, four aces.

“Quad aces,” the guy sitting opposite me said with a dark expression. “That’s twice this game you’ve had four of a kind. Are you cheating or just lucky?”

“Neither,” I replied flippantly. “It’s pure skill, friend.”

“I’m not your friend,” the man scowled but shoved his chips across the table before getting up so violently he knocked his chair over.

I watched him storm out of the room then turned to the other four players sat around the poker table. “Someone’s upset. Perhaps he shouldn’t try bluffing someone holding the nuts.”

‘The nuts’ was the best hand possible, something that I’d managed to end up with quite a few times this evening. I looked at the pile of chips in

front of me, wondering whether or not to cash out while I was ahead, or to go with the flow, seeing as lady luck was apparently with me tonight.

This was the first time in a while that things had gone my way. If I went back in time twelve months, I was winning regularly. Over a short period, I went from playing in small games, learning the game while winning minor amounts to playing in larger tournaments where my aggressive strategies won me money that I'd never seen before. I didn't keep count but I won at least ten thousand pounds and gained so much respect in the casino that people stopped playing with me. Because the casino had a maximum amount they were allowed to pay out, some of the bigger spenders organised their own private games outside of the casino and my rising status among the poker crowd eventually gained me an invite into these 'home games.'

They weren't actually played at anyone's home. Two of these (strictly illegal) event organisers owned their own venues, one a club, the other a restaurant and the games took place in there, albeit behind a barrier or in a private room, so the general public wouldn't see what was going on.

It was great. I enjoyed rubbing shoulders with some of the wealthier people in town and I had a bit of success at first, although I was keen not to take all their money and piss anyone off, so I actually went easy on people at first. But then it all went wrong. Lady Luck abandoned and I went on a bad streak, losing game after the game. Losing is a big part of playing any sport where luck is involved, but it's one thing getting unlucky in a £10 game of poker and another where you've paid £1000 to play.

It's all about risk and reward, I knew that, but what I didn't realise is that the risk should always be viewed in proportion to your circumstances. For instance, Frank, the local bar owner, had over £100,000 in the bank, he

once told me and the pub was worth five or six times that. For him, losing a grand was nothing. But for me, that was half a month's wages from my day job. It was a big deal. I couldn't afford to lose many games. Another thing I didn't realise is that once I was in this secret 'club' or high-stakes games, I was expected to play regularly or be kicked out.

So, because of those reasons; a mixture of naivety as to my risk levels and expectations put against me, combined with Lady Luck either abandoning me or joining forces with some of the other players at the table, within a few months, I was broke. Everything I'd gained in the casino was gone. And then I found myself borrowing money to try and win it back.

That was the biggest mistake.

Fast-forward to now. I'm sitting in the casino, after being kicked out of the 'club' several weeks ago, with a pile of chips in front of me worth nearly a thousand pounds. I want to cash out. I want to say 'thanks to the guys I'm playing with, pick up my chips and take them to the kiosk to be exchanged for real money. Then I want to say 'goodbye' and go home.

But I don't. Because I'm now stuck owing ten grand to the guys I'd borrowed from to try to stay in the club, to try and win more than I was borrowing. Because I'm an idiot.

If I can turn this one grand into two grand, that's a bigger chunk of money I can pay off to Pat Brewster and Johnny Sharples, the two people I owe. Two people that it turns out aren't nice people at all. They're not the friendly guys I thought they were when they welcomed me into the club. They're gangsters. And they want their money back.

The worst thing about this is that I've already paid them some of it back. The amount I owed built up fast, to nearly twenty-five grand. *Twenty-five grand*. What the fuck was I thinking? The thing was, if I won one game

at the club, with the stakes involved, I could easily win eight, nine or ten grand, maybe more. But I never won. Like I said, Lady Luck had long since left my side.

I'd paid Sharples ten grand and Brewster five grand, using the money that my wife and I had in our savings account. I didn't tell her because I knew that eventually, by the law of averages, I had to win a few games. The amount left owing was a lot, but it wasn't totally impossible for me to repay it. With some determination and common sense, I'd pay it off. I'd got myself into a bad situation but it was fixable. I just needed time.

So I kept playing but when I lost a couple of big hands, my chips halved, I stopped. I was being stupid. I'd been sitting on a grand and now I was sitting on £500. It was time to stop, as tempted as I was to try and get back to a grand. With a heavy heart at having lost half my winnings, I got up, cashed out and left, telling myself that I'd still won nearly £500. That was a good result. It was another chunk I could pay off to Brewster.

When I got home, my wife, Jessica, was waiting for me.

"Hey, baby," she said with a warm smile. "You're earlier than I thought. You said you might not be home until midnight. How was the meeting?"

After I often did whenever I returned from the casino, I felt terrible for lying to her about where I'd been, but if she knew how often I went to the casino and the amounts I was gambling, she'd be horrified. If she knew that I'd emptied our savings account, she'd be beyond horrified. She'd be apoplectic.

"It was good," I said and gave her a kiss on the cheek. "Still no bonuses being handed out, so money is going to continue to be tight for a while but fingers crossed, things will pick up soon."

I worked as a salesman at a car salesroom and I did okay at it. The pay wasn't terrible but it wasn't enough to instantly cover the amount I'd lost or borrowed from our savings.

"That's okay," she said, wrapping her arms around me and giving me a squeeze. "We'll get through it. We always do."

I watched as she walked away, feeling incredibly guilty for letting down and getting us in this position. Jessica had no idea about the trouble I was in and I needed to keep it that way. I needed to protect her.

She sat on the sofa, watching some TV but I stood in the doorway for a moment before joining her, looking at her. Her long red hair was flowing over her shoulders and black sweater which hid her considerable buxom. Jess was a lovely person and she was also incredibly cute with her crystal-clear blue eyes and slightly freckled cheeks and sexy with her pale skin and voluptuous curves. She deserved better than me. I knew that.

I had to fix this. But how?

We watched some TV for a while and had some supper and I tried to relax but for some reason, the burden of my debt and guilt towards Jessica was heavy on my shoulders tonight. Some days I could just push the thoughts of it out of my head. I could stick my head in the sand for a few hours and forget about it, allowing myself to relax but tonight wasn't one of those nights.

Tonight, I was uptight and anxious and my wife sensed it as we cleared away the pots after supper.

"Are you really okay?" she asked me as I washed up. "You seem miles away tonight."

"I'm fine," I said with a reassuring smile. "I'm just tired, that's all."

“Really?” she said, her light-blue eyes studying me. “Is it the meeting? Are you worried about work? I’m sure it’ll pick up.”

I wasn’t going to fool her, so I changed tactics. “Yes, it’s work,” I sighed. “They’re wanting me to do more hours for the same money. I have to do it - it’s not ideal - but it’s kind of getting me down.”

“That sucks,” she nodded sympathetically. “You know if things are that bad, I can take more hours on at the garage.”

“I don’t want you to,” I shook my head. Jess making more money didn’t help the situation. We didn’t share a bank account. We’d always kept our money separate. I paid for the bills and she paid for things like food and nights out or other extras to our usual household spend. I couldn’t start asking her for money to restock the bank account which she didn’t know I’d drained.

“Well, the offer is there,” she said. She worked part-time at the moment, more because she wanted to work rather than *had to*, which is how I wanted it. We’d been married for two years now - together for ten - and we’d been thinking about buying a house and starting a family. Buying a house was going to be difficult now seeing as I’d lost all the money we’d saved as a deposit and starting a family would be hard if Jess had to work full-time hours.

“I know,” I smiled, “But we don’t need to both work full-time. As you said, it’ll come together in time.”

We finished up what we were doing and went up to bed. Again, I was struck by how lucky I was to get a girl like Jess. I got into bed and watched her undress, admiring her large, firm pale breasts and light pink nipples and the flash of reddish pubic hair I saw as she pulled a nightshirt on.

“Don’t you think it’s cold tonight?” she asked, pulling the quilt a little higher and she got into bed.

“Well, it is nearly the start of winter,” I pointed out.

“I know, it’ll be Christmas before we know it.”

That was another worry. Christmas was only a couple of months away and while we didn’t have kids to pay for, I did like to spoil Jessica with a nice present every year as well as my various nieces and nephews and family. This year, I wouldn’t be able to, unless things changed fast.

I switched the bedside lamp off, plunging the room into darkness and lay on my side, trying to push my worries out of my mind so I could get a good night’s sleep but Jess pressed her body against me and sighed in my ear.

“You could always warm me up,” she whispered, then reached a hand over my hip, letting it rest so that it brushed against my cock in my shorts.

“I’m kinda tired,” I started but she wasn’t going to just let me sleep. When Jessica was horny, she was horny. Another thing I was grateful for, a wife with a healthy sex drive, even after ten years together. She pulled my shorts down and took my cock in her hand, slowly stroking it until I got hard.

“You’re not *that* tired,” she giggled as I turned around to face her, lifting her nightshirt and sliding down the bed to take one of her nipples in my mouth. My other hands caressed the other breast, cupping and squeezing and then I moved over her, letting my erect cock find the entrance to her lightly-furred pussy.

“I seem to have found some energy from somewhere,” I admitted as I pushed myself into her.

Jessica wrapped her arms and legs around me as I began to fuck her and then once I'd done, emptying myself inside her pussy, she sighed.

"I might come off the pill next month," she said, looking at me as I returned to lying next to her in bed. "What do you think?"

"Are you sure you're ready?" I asked, trying to think of a way of delaying her but in my tired, post-coital state, my mind wasn't working very fast.

"I think so," she replied. "We'll talk about it tomorrow, maybe?"

"Okay." I closed my eyes and tried to sleep, but the worry about my situation didn't let me for quite a while. I just lay there, listening to Jessica's soft breathing next to me, praying to Lady Luck to rescue me somehow.

2

Chapter 2

I worked hard that week and put aside as much money as I could, including my winnings from the casino but unfortunately, events caught up with me the very day I was going to visit Brewster to pay off some of his debt.

I left the car dealership where I worked and headed to the bus, only to be headed off before I could get there by a tall, wide slab of a man. I went to walk around him but he stepped in front of me again.

“Lee Parker?” he said, in a voice so deep it was almost subterranean.

“Yes,” I said, looking up into his eyes, dark and deeply set in a flat face. “Who are you?”

“Mr Sharples would like a word,” he rumbled, then without asking for me to agree he pointed at a black transit van parked nearby.

I gulped. This wasn’t good. “I was going to come over tomorrow-”

“Not tomorrow.” The man pointed at the van again. “Now.”

I walked over to the van and as I approached, the large door on the side slid open. I paused but the fellow behind me bundled me into the dark space

within before I could object.

When I managed to sit upright and look around, the door was already locked, sealing me in and then the van sped off at speed. I sat in the back, clinging to the wall of the van so I didn't get thrown around and was relieved when a short time later, the door opened up again.

I blinked at the bright light streaming in, trying to work out where I was. It wasn't anywhere familiar. A road I'd never seen before.

"This way," the big man said, walking past me towards the massive house we'd parked outside.

I followed him up the long drive, through the imposing front doors and into a luxuriously decorated living room. Johnny Sharples was waiting for me there, sitting on a white leather armchair.

"Thank you, Conroy," he said to the burly bodyguard that that dragged me here. "You can leave us now. Mr Parker won't cause me any problem."

"This is abduction, you know?" I said, trying to appear undaunted. "There was no need. I was coming to see you tomorrow."

"Were you now?" Johnny said, scowling at me. "With the money you owe me?"

"I've got £700," I said, pulling the envelope out of my pocket which I'd been planning to give to Brewster, but now had been forced to change my mind.

Johnny Sharples took the brown package from me and fished the wad of money out with a podgy hand. He was a big man but more fat than muscle. His belly was round and his neck had disappeared into his chin and shoulders, his fleshy hips only just fit into the wide chair.

"Seven hundred," he counted, then put the money on the glass and gold table between us. "Not enough but it's a start. Get me another £700 next

week and I'll let you keep paying me like this, weekly, until we're even."

"I can't afford this much every week," I replied calmly, "But I can--"

"I don't want to hear it." The man rubbed his thick fingers through his slicked-back black hair. "Seven hundred next week. Yes?"

"I'll see what I can do," I continued, "But I can't promise it, Johnny. You know things are hard for me right now. You'll get your money, I promise, but I can't commit to regular payments. You know I owe Brewster as well."

"Oh, I know," Johnny reached under his chair and pulled out a box of cigars, offering me one, which I declined. "But what you owe Brewster isn't my concern. I want my money, Lee. Sort it."

"I'm doing what I can," I reminded him, then Sharples shouted for his man who seemed to magically appear from nowhere to escort me back outside. "Are you taking me home?"

"I don't know where you live," the big man shrugged, then turned around and went back into the house, leaving me stranded on the street outside.

"For fuck's sake," I muttered to myself. I had no idea where I was. I couldn't be far, the trip here had only taken fifteen minutes and indeed, once I walked a little way, I found myself in the next town to where I lived and worked. It wasn't far, five miles away, and I managed to catch a bus home.

"You're late," Jessica said as I walked through the door. She looked worried.

"I'm sorry," I apologised. "I missed the damn bus again."

I'd had to sell the car a few months ago. I told her that I'd had an accident in it and the insurance company had written it off and that we

couldn't afford to buy a new one for a while. I said I'd manage on the bus and the place where Jessica worked was literally down the road, so it wasn't a huge deal to go without for a while. In reality, I'd sold the car to try and recover what I'd lost from the savings account, but of course, it didn't work out. I gave a little of the proceeds to Sharples and Brewster and the rest I gambled away like an idiot.

"There's someone here to see you," Jess said with an intake of breath and I realised that this was the real cause of her concern.

"Hello?" I said, walking through into the living room.

Waiting for me in there was another stranger, this one tall and slim with a long nose and a bald head. A diamond earring glistened in his ear as he turned to face me.

"My name is Vinny," he said around a piece of gum that he was chewing. "I work for Pat Brewster."

Oh, crap. In my haste to find my way home, I'd forgotten about Brewster.

"I was meant to be seeing you tonight. I'm sorry," I apologised. "I got held up at work then missed the bus and completely forgot. Tell Mr Brewster I'll come over tomorrow."

"Why tomorrow?" he asked, tilting his head and regarding me coolly. "Did you forget to draw out the money too? I'm happy to drive you to the bank right now if you want?"

"Money?" Jessica said from behind me and my heart sank.

"I'll explain later," I said to her over my shoulder then turned back to Brewster's man. "The thing is, there's been a hold up with the money. I'm late being paid this week, but I'll get together what I can and bring it over tomorrow."

I had absolutely no idea where I was going to find some money for tomorrow without Jess and I basically starved but I wanted to get this Vinny guy out of my house.

“You will definitely visit Mr Brewster tomorrow,” the man said.

“I promise,” I nodded.

“I wasn’t asking a question,” Vinny said, smoothing down his jeans as he stood up. “I was telling you.”

He walked past us, his eyes all over Jess’s body, leering up and down her body, then turned at the door. “I’ll see you tomorrow, Lee.”

“You will,” I said. “As soon as I finish work.”

Vinny winked at Jess, then pulled the door shut behind him and left. I walked to the kitchen window and watched him get in the car, a black BMW and then stayed there, my heart beating like a bass drum until the car pulled away and disappeared up the road.

“What money?” Jess inquired as I eventually turned around to face her, my mind whirling with ideas of how to explain this to her.

“I borrowed some money from Pat,” I shrugged. “I wanted to get a new car, remember? We couldn’t afford it and I-”

“You know Pat Brewster?” Jess stared at me.

That stopped me in my tracks. “Yes,” I said slowly. “Do you?”

“I went to school with his daughter,” my wife eyed me. “How do *you* know him?”

“I met him at the casino,” I answered truthfully. Jessica knew that I sometimes went to the casino and played a *little bit* of poker. She had no idea how often I still went. She thought I’d stopped going when my lucky streak came to an end. If she knew how much I’d gambled and lost...

“So you know he’s a criminal?” Jessica was still staring at me. “He’s not the type of person you borrow from and then don’t pay back.”

“I know but I am paying him back.”

“We didn’t get a new car,” my wife said, stepping towards me and folding her arms across her chest. “So what did you do with the money?”

This wasn’t going well. “I spent it,” I said, running out of ideas. “We were really short that month and I guess I just used it to pay bills and-”

“Really?” Jess tapped her finger on her bottom lip, narrowing her blue eyes again. “And how much are we talking about here?”

“I can’t remember,” I replied, stalling for time. “I was going to ask Pat tonight but I forgot to go.”

“How much are we in debt to Pat Brewster for, Lee?”

“Just over a thousand,” I sighed dramatically. Of course, it was much more, so I admitted to it being *a lot*, so it would seem bad while protecting her from the actual truth.

“I don’t like owing Pat Brewster money,” Jessica walked to the kitchen window and looked through as if she was worried about Vinny coming back. “Take it from our savings and pay him back. We can put the money back in next month.”

“That’s an idea,” I said, cringing inside because obviously, that wasn’t an option. I wasn’t going to tell Jess that though. “I don’t like doing that but I guess if we have to.”

“I’d rather delay buying a house than have our arms and legs broken,” Jess said without an ounce of sarcasm.

“He’s not *that* bad,” I scoffed.

“You don’t know the Brewsters very well then.” Jessica walked past into the hallway and locked the front door. “I went to school with Charlotte

and her brothers and trust me, some of the stories I used to hear were enough to make your stomach turn.”

“Really?” I shook my head. “I knew he was some sort of gangster, but I didn’t think he was that bad. He seems a really nice, jovial kind of guy.”

He had, at first. He was all too nice while winning my chips from the poker table. He was even kind and friendly when lending me money to keep playing but as soon as I had to quit the poker club and the situation changed to me struggling to pay him back, things had changed.

“Well, perhaps you should find out more about people before borrowing money from them.” Jessica fiddled with a strand of her long red hair as she walked back into the living room to sit down. “Tomorrow, you can draw out however much it is that you owe, then I want you to go right over and pay him. Okay? Let’s get this dealt with sooner rather than later. The longer you keep men like Pat Brewster waiting, the worse the situation gets.”

“I will,” I assured her. “I’ll get this dealt with. I’m sorry you had to deal with Vinny. I should have told you but I was trying to protect you from it if anything.”

“You don’t need to protect me from anything,” Jessica said, turning on the TV and turning her body away from me slightly so that I could tell she was annoyed. “Just don’t get us into shit like this and if you do, tell me. Since when did we start keeping secrets from each other in this marriage?”

“I said sorry,” I said glumly, sitting next to her.

“Just deal with it tomorrow,” she said firmly. “I don’t want men like Vinny or Brewster’s other minions, including his sons, anywhere near our house again.”

“I will,” I said, my stomach tightening at the thought.

How the hell was I going to find the money?

3

Chapter 3

“Greg?” I said when my friend finally answered the phone. “Everything okay? I called a couple of times and you didn’t answer.”

That wasn’t like him. I’d become concerned for my best friend who I’d known since school.

“Yeah, I’m fine. Sorry,” he apologised. “I was driving. My mom’s car broke down so I had to go pick her up and sort everything out.”

“As long as you got it all sorted,” I replied. I was going to ask Greg for a favour but I felt bad now that he’d already gone out of his way today for someone. It’d be better coming from me in person. “Do you fancy meeting up at lunch for a chat? I need to ask you something.”

“Sure,” he answered and I arranged to meet him at the pub not far from the car dealership where I worked. I hated asking my best friend for money but there was only him and my parents I could ask and they weren’t likely to help me because they weren’t well-off themselves.

We met in the Cross Keys an hour later, a pub which was owned by one of my poker-playing friends incidentally and as we sat down in a booth with a beer in hand, I decided to come right out with it and ask the question.

“This isn’t easy for me to ask but I need to borrow some money from somewhere,” I said, looking Greg in his dark brown eyes with as sincere an expression as I could muster.

“Money?” Greg looked up from the rim of his pint glass after he’d taken a sip. “What for? Is everything okay?”

Greg was a good guy. His dark, deep-set eyes, short brown hair and bent nose made him look somewhat thuggish but he was one of the kindest people I knew.

“Not really,” I said slowly. I’d already decided to tell him about Brewster. I wasn’t going to tell him the true extent of the trouble I was in or about Johnny Sharples but there was no need to completely lie to Greg. He wouldn’t judge me, I knew that. “I’m in a bit of debt.”

“What kind of debt?”

I took a long swig of my beer and exhaled a long, deep sigh. “I borrowed some money to try and get back some money I’d lost playing poker,” I paused. This was harder to admit than I thought it be. “And now I’m struggling to pay it back. The issue is who I’ve borrowed it from, a guy called Pat Brewster. I didn’t know at the time but it turns out he’s not a very nice - or patient - person.”

“A loan shark?” Greg asked, his face attentive and his expression neutral. I was glad he didn’t know who Brewster was.

“Kind of,” I said, “But not the legit kind. He’s more the backstreet lender who gets his boys to break your legs if you don’t pay on time.”

“Oh,” Greg said, putting his pint down on the table. “Fuck. That doesn’t sound great, Lee. Are you going to be able to pay him back or are you in over your head?”

That was a straightforward question. I didn’t expect any different from Greg and I answered as honestly as I could.

“I will be able to pay him back eventually,” I said, which was true. It was paying Sharples at the same time as well as the speed he wanted me to pay up. “Just not to the schedule he’s decided to set.”

“I see,” Lee seemed relieved to hear me say that I *could* pay it back. “How much do you need to borrow? I’m not sitting on thousands in the bank but if I can help, I will.”

“Five hundred?” I asked the bare minimum I needed.

“Wow,” Greg’s dark eyebrows climbed a little higher up his forehead. “That’s a lot. Is that the total you owe? Or is that just a chunk of it?”

“Just a chunk,” I admitted. “A small chunk. It’s a few grand altogether.” I needed Greg to know I was in a bit of deep water without him knowing I was close to drowning.

“I can just about manage that, I guess.” He stroked his chin. “But Lee, that’s all I’ll be able to lend and you’ll have to pay me back when you can. I’ve got a mortgage and family and bills too.”

“I know,” I said with a smile. Relief flooded through me. Five hundred should be enough to get Brewster off my back for a while. “It’ll really help me out and I’ll pay you back soon, I promise.”

After we’d finished our drinks and had something to eat, Greg drove me to the bank where he withdrew the cash for me.

“I’m really grateful for this,” I said, grabbing his shoulder and squeezing it. “I promise to return the favour somehow to you one day.”

“No need,” he said, watching me put the money safely in the pocket and then driving me back to work. “It’s what friends are for. We have each other’s back when needed.”

That evening after work, I was prepared to catch the bus to Brewster’s Italian Restaurant, *La Tavola*, above which was the office where he was usually to be found. If he wasn’t there, he was at home; an imposing three-storey house right across the town square from the restaurant. But as I arrived at the bus stop, a silver Lexus with blacked-out windows pulled up alongside, the window winding down to reveal Vinny’s grinning face.

“Get in.”

I reached for the passenger side handle but Vinny shook his head menacingly. “Back seat.”

I got in the back and the Lexus sped off in the direction of the town centre. At least I got to ride in comfort this time while being escorted to meet a local crime boss, unlike yesterday’s memorable-for-all-the-wrong-reasons journey, bouncing around in the back of a transit van.

When we arrived, I got out of the car and headed towards the restaurant but Vinny immediately grabbed me by the back of my jacket and turned me around.

“The house,” he said. “Mr Brewster’s away so you’ll be dealing with Mrs Brewster today.”

The Brewster’s city centre home was impressive. We first had to pass through a ten-foot-high security gate before even reaching the front door, where we had to then wait while security allowed us in after looking at us through the camera perched above our heads.

“She’s waiting for you in the sitting room,” Vinny pointed at the door at the very end of the long hallway I found myself in. “No funny business. I’ll

be waiting outside the door.”

“No funny business?” I stared at him. “What do you mean?”

He didn’t answer. Instead, he more or less pushed me through the oak-panelled door into a plush *art deco* style room, where Pat Brewster’s wife was waiting for me, sitting on a polished-leather chaise lounge.

“Hello,” I said as she examined me for a moment. She was in her mid-forties, perhaps older, but was still a stunning-looking woman. Her face was serene with a beautiful bone structure, bright blue eyes and red lips. Her blonde hair was short and beautiful styled in waves and the beauty spot near her bottom lip made me realise who she reminded me of - Marilyn Monroe, if she’d lived into her forties.

“I am Yvette,” she said, in a foreign-sounding, perhaps French, accent. “My husband is away on business. You were supposed to see him yesterday. Why did you not turn up on time?”

For some reason, Yvette scared me more than Pat ever had. Pat was a small man, menacing in his own way, no one messed with him but Yvette had something else about her that I couldn’t put my finger on. Perhaps it was her undoubted beauty but whatever it was, she was *intimidating*.

“I was late getting paid,” I lied, then immediately realised that was a mistake.

“That’s what you told Vinny,” Yvette smiled, those red lips turning upwards at the edges but her eyes showed no warmth. “But that’s not true, is it?”

“No,” I gulped. “I was-”

“You got taken by Johnny’s men,” Yvette saved me the job of explaining. “Where I am in no doubt they relieved you of the money that you were planning on bringing to us.”

“That’s right,” I frowned. “How did you know?”

“You don’t need to worry about that,” Yvette’s smile had faded. “But you do need to worry about not having our money. My husband isn’t the forgiving sort when it comes to being let down, you see.”

“I’ve got the money,” I said, quickly fumbling around in my pockets and pulling out the wad of money that Greg had loaned to me. “Five hundred pounds. It’s the most I can pull together but if I keep giving you sums like this every so often, I’ll soon be out of your debt.”

“Five hundred?” Yvette gazed at me, her blue eyes meeting mine and holding them. “There’s a game tonight, Lee Parker. Do you know Kai Frost?”

“I do know Kai,” I replied. He was one of the big-league poker club players, one that had taken a lot of money off me.

“You could take this money and play,” Yvette tilted her head, watching me like a bird watches a mouse that it’s about to catch and eat. “I could get you into the game if you want? Maybe you could double it? Triple it or more.”

“Or I could lose it all and be in an even worse position,” I replied, shaking my head.

“Very well,” Yvette’s lingering gaze shifted, looking away as though I wasn’t even there anymore. “Five hundred will have to suffice for now. My husband will be in touch next week. Put the money on the table and leave.”

I looked around, locating a mahogany table and placed the money on it. Then I practically fled the room and the terrifying woman inside it, almost bumping into Vinny who was - as promised - waiting right outside the door.

“You made a payment,” he said, his jaw set and his expression grim. “That’s good. Keep it up or you’re dog meat. Mr Brewster has already

given me and his boys the okay to shake you up a bit if you didn't pay anything tonight but it looks like you've earned a reprieve."

"Tell your boss I'm good for the money," I said, trying to regain my composure so I could look him in the eye and pretend I wasn't intimidated by him. "Just ask him to be patient. He'll get it back, all of it, as soon as I can pay it."

"I'll tell him, but you know what Mr Brewster is like," Vinny shrugged. "If you don't want me turning up at your house again, find the money. Or else next time I turn up, I won't be alone. Or unarmed."

"You don't need to threaten me," I stood my ground but Vinny put a hand against my chest and pushed me backwards, making me stagger slightly towards the door.

"Just go," he growled.

I gave him one last look, trying to protect any pride I had left and headed out, the lock on the door opening automatically and the gate doing likewise as I reached it. Then I headed home, the weight on my shoulders lifted, at least temporarily.

4

Chapter 4

“**D**id you sort it?” Jessica said as soon as I stepped into the house. She must have seen me walking down the drive because she met me at the front door. “Did you pay Pat Brewster off?”

“I made a down payment,” I nodded, smiling to appease her obvious anxiety. “I didn’t pay it all off. I don’t want to put too big a dent in our savings.”

“And he was happy with that?”

I walked past her and into the kitchen, making myself a much-needed coffee. “Yes. He knows I’ll pay him back, he just needed some reassurance.”

“That’s good,” she said, following me through. “But I really wish you’d just paid it all off. I’d feel so much better, even if it did slow our savings down a little.”

“I spoke to Greg too,” I said, deciding to tell her before she found out. I had to be careful to cover my tracks. “He’s loaning me some money to help pay Brewster off.”

“Great,” Jess’s smiled but still look uneasy. “I don’t like the thought of borrowing from one person to pay another though.”

“I know but I’ve got it all planned out,” I replied, trying to reassure her. “You trust me, right?”

My wife nodded and left me to prepare dinner. The rest of our evening went pleasantly enough, we even ended up having sex that night. Jessica’s worries had abated or at least gone dormant and I managed to suppress my own anxieties. This lasted for the rest of the week and into the next - until it came time for the next payday.

I’d managed to scrape together what was left from my wages and a work bonus after paying the necessary bills at home and was pondering on whether to give it to one of my creditors or the other or if I should split it between the two when once again I was denied the choice.

“Parker,” a familiar voice said as I stepped out of the salesroom at the end of the day. I cringed and turned, knowing who I’d see standing behind me.

“Hello, Conroy,” I said to the brick wall of a man waiting for me next to the door. “I was just about to set off to see your boss.”

“It’s Mr Conroy to you,” the tanned, black-haired thug said. “And Mr Sharples will be pleased to hear that but there’s no need. Give me the cash and you can head straight home.”

“Okay,” I said, after taking a minute to think. “But I want to call him and let him know.”

“Don’t trust me?” The big man stepped up close, putting his face close to mine. “You’re probably right not to. Call him.”

I got my phone out and dialled the number. I had both Sharples and Brewster’s numbers from when we played poker together but I’d scarcely

ever used them. It felt slightly scary, drawing their attention in such a way but I had to right now.

“Johnny,” I said when he answered. “It’s me, Lee. I’m giving your man, Conroy, three hundred pounds. I know it’s not as much as last week, but it’s all I have.”

“Three hundred, huh?” Sharples rasped back. “That’s all? You’re not holding out on me, are you, Lee? Saving some to pay Pat Brewster?”

“Well, I need to pay him something too,” I admitted. “Look, Johnny. I need to pay both of you. You’ll get your money in time, I promise.”

“I come before Brewster,” Sharples told me, his tone raised in both volume and pitch. “You borrowed from me first then lost it to Pat. He’s had enough of your money already. Give me another hundred and I’ll let you off this time around.”

“Four hundred?” I said, quickly calculating my chances of talking Johnny around and arriving at zero. “Fine. I’ll send it with your man now.”

I hung up and Conroy held out a meaty hand for the money. I counted out four hundred, which only left two hundred for Brewster but it was what it was. I had more chance of talking around than I did Johnny.

“I’ll see you next week,” Conroy rumbled before walking away with a smirk on his annoying face.

I simply stood there for a moment, the reality of the situation hitting home. I *would* see Conroy again next week. And the week after. And the week after that until Sharples was finally paid off. At the rate I was paying, that was a long way away. A *long* way. A repeating sequence of giving away almost all my weekly pay stretching so far into the distance that it felt hopeless.

But moping about it in front of my workplace wasn't going to help things. I headed out and boarded the bus to Brewster's restaurant in town, wondering how he'd react to accepting only two hundred. I simply couldn't give him any more and when I gave the money to Yvette shortly afterwards, after being allowed into the restaurant back office, I told her that.

"It's all I've got, Yvette," I said, shrugging apologetically. "Sharples keeps posting his man outside my workplace so that as soon as I leave, he can intercept me and take the lion's share. I don't know how to stop it."

"That's an excuse," Yvette replied. She looked as glamorous again today as she had last week, her blonde hair perfectly coiffured and a set of huge pearls around her neck. She smoothed down the black velvet dress she was wearing as she stood up from the desk. "I'll inform my husband of the situation but he's not going to be happy, Lee."

"I'll work it out next week that Pat gets the bulk of whatever I'm able to pay next week," I promised, taking a step backwards as she approached me.

Yvette stopped just inches away from me and then reached up and tapped the tip of my nose with her forefinger, which made me flinch and I felt my cheeks redden in embarrassment. Why was I so scared of such a petite woman?

"Make sure you do," she smiled, then abruptly turned away. "If that's all, I have work to do."

I rushed out of the office, my face still burning as I left the restaurant and headed home, hoping that my discomfort wouldn't show in front of Jessica, who needed reassurance and encouragement.

"This week's payments made," I announced as I walked into the house like it was something to be proud of. "We're getting there slowly."

“That’s good,” Jessica replied, walking down the stairs to greet me with a smile. But then her smile dropped and I turned to see what she was looking at over my shoulder.

Too late. I hadn’t heard Vinny follow me up the front garden path and he was halfway through the front door before I had time to try to shut it behind me. He barged it out of my grasp with a firm shoulder, then his hand was on my chest, pushing me back into the house.

“What the fuck?” I had time to yell but in one stride he was in front of me, his hand now around my throat carrying me backwards to pin me against a wall.

“Stop!” Jessica screamed and tried to pull at his shoulder but another man, one I didn’t recognise grabbed her by the back of her shirt and yanked her backwards.

“Get off of her,” I tried to shout but the fingers around my throat turned my voice into a croak.

“Lee,” Jessica cried out and I tried to see what the man was doing to her but Vinny thrust his ugly face into mine, his forehead connecting with my brow in a headbutt. He held me there, pinned against the wall as I tried to recover my senses from the echoing pain in my head.

“This is your last warning,” Vinny drawled, his cigarette breath filling my nostrils. “Next week, Mr Brewster wants a proper payment. At least a grand. If he doesn’t get it, we’ll be back and this time we’ll help ourselves to whatever we want. I’m sure there’s stuff here we could sell.”

“We’ll take whatever we want,” the other man repeated and Jessica cried out again.

Vinny gave me one last shake, his eyes glaring into mine to emphasize what he’d said and then he let go. The sudden ability to breathe made me

cough and I spluttered to the ground, my legs giving way so that I slid down the wall onto my backside.

The other man was holding my wife from behind, his right hand pawing at her breast and he kept her crushed against him, out of the way of Vinny and me. As Vinny moved out past, the man let go of Jess who swiped at him, then Vinny with a clenched fist but her blows just bounced off the pair of them unnoticed.

“You fucking bastards,” she yelled, following them outside and I struggled to my feet to go after her but by the time my unstable legs carried me to the door, she was already walking back down the path with tears streaming down her face. The two men had disappeared out of view.

“Oh my God,” I gasped, pulling her into my arms and holding her there for a moment. “Are you okay?”

“Am I okay?” she screamed unexpectedly and pushed me away. “No, I’m not fucking okay. I thought I was going to be raped. I thought you were going to be beaten up or worse.”

“What did he do to you?” I asked, reaching up to touch my forehead which I suddenly realised felt warm.

“He fucking groped me,” she hissed into my face. “What’s he going to do next time, Lee? What are they going to do to you? I’m pretty sure it’ll be worse than having my breasts grabbed and you getting your head split open.”

I looked down at my hand and saw blood. There was a lump above my eyebrow and I felt at it gingerly, feeling a cut an inch long or so. I hoped it didn’t need stitches.

“I’ll sort it,” I said, suddenly feeling faint, then the room seemed to spin and turn upside down and the lights went out.

* * *

“He’s going to be fine,” I heard Greg say. “Just keep your eye on him for a few hours and take him to the hospital if he encounters any symptoms like a severe headache or double vision. Call me if you’re at all worried.”

Greg was a paramedic. Was I in the hospital? I opened my eyes, squinting because the light above me seemed incredibly bright.

I was in our bed, gazing at our bedroom ceiling. I turned to the side, my head throbbing painfully with the motion, to see Greg and Jess nearby.

“He’s coming around,” she said, bending down to look at me. “Hey.”

“Hi,” I said, feeling my head and finding some paper stitches stuck over the wound. “What happened?”

“You passed out,” she replied. “I didn’t know what to do so I called Greg. You were bleeding and-”

“You’ve got a bit of a concussion,” my friend said, patting me on the shoulder. “You’ll be okay. I’ve cleaned and patched up the cut on your head so all you need to do is rest tonight and fingers crossed you’ll feel better in the morning.”

“Thanks,” I said, smiling weakly at him.

“We’ll talk about this tomorrow,” Greg told me before turning to Jess and hugging her. “Make sure he calls me.”

“I will,” she promised and then they left the bedroom together as she went to see him out.

I tried to sit up, struggling to a more upright position but as soon as Jessica came back in, she shouted at me and told me to rest.

"I just need a drink," I replied.

"I'll get you one," she said, sitting on the edge of the bed. She was beautiful, her red hair shining in the bedroom light like it was on fire. I'd let her down. I'd failed her so badly. I felt terrible. I watched her leave again, returning with a glass of water. "Here you go."

I took a sip, savouring the coldness of it soothing my hot, dry throat. "Thank you."

"Whatever it does to our savings," Jessica said, her fingers pushing my hair away from the cut on my head, "Pay Brewster off. Just give it to him. We can rebuild our savings, even if it puts all our plans back a year or two."

"I can't," I said, my voice barely louder than a whisper. Tonight had shown me that there wasn't anywhere to hide anymore. There wasn't any point in lying. I had to do something to fix this. I couldn't let Jessica be in danger because of my mistake. If she left me because of what I was about to tell her, then at least that would put her out of danger. It would make her safe and that was the most important thing.

"What do you mean?" Jessica stroked my cheek softly, but her eyes were considering me now warily - as if she knew.

"I can't," I shrugged, the simple movement making my head throb painfully again. "The savings account. I used it. I tried to win back the amount I owed and I lost it."

"You-" Jessica shook her head faintly, moving her hand and sitting up straight to stare at me from further away. "You *lost* it?"

"Poker," I nodded. "I'm sorry."

"You lost it," she said, through gritted teeth. "You lost it *all*?"

When I nodded, my wife stood up and turned her back on me, pausing as if she was going to say something but she didn't. She simply walked out of the room, slamming the bedroom door shut behind her.

5

Chapter 5

“**Y**ou don’t understand. I was playing well and winning. Not just winning, I was winning *everything*. I was cleaning up.”

“You were *cleaning up*?” Jessica stared at me aghast at what I was saying even though it was the truth. “Well, you’re not doing well at cleaning up the mess you’ve made right now, are you?”

I’d wanted to follow her last night. I’d wanted to get out of bed and talk to her but when I tried, my head spun and I just couldn’t. I’d laid back and closed my eyes, trying to work out what the hell to do and then I’d fallen asleep.

When I woke up, the sun was shining in through the windows and the bed next to me was unslept in. Jess must have slept in the spare room. I got up carefully and was pleased that my head seemed much better. My forehead was still slightly swollen and tender but the pounding headache had gone. I found Jessica in the kitchen, drinking a hot coffee while staring out of the window.

Then the argument had begun, leading me to where I was, frantically trying to defend my action of the last few months.

“I *will* clean it up,” I protested. “Give me chance and I’ll sort everything out.”

“How?” she demanded, a fire in her usually serene blue eyes. “We’re broke, Lee. You’ve blown every fucking penny we had. You’ve ruined everything.”

“I know,” I replied solemnly. “I was winning and I don’t know what happened. My luck changed overnight. I don’t understand why. I got in such a mess but I’m out of it now and trying to put things right.”

“You’re out?” Jessica laughed ironically. “You’re deluded. That’s what you are. We’re in a mess so deep, with no way out, that you’re probably going to get your legs broken next time and not just a headbutt to the face.”

“I meant that I’m out of playing poker,” I replied. “Those high-stakes games anyway.”

“You’re out altogether,” Jessica waved her finger at me. “If you play so much as one more game-”

“I won’t,” I said quickly. For a moment, I was tempted to tell her that I’d won some money last week but I didn’t. She was furious with me and rightly so.

“How dare you even touch our savings?” she said, turning away from me and gazing out of the window again. It was as if she couldn’t bear to look at me. That hurt. “Some of that money was left to me by my grandma when she passed away.”

“I know and I’m sorry.”

“It wasn’t yours to spend.” Jessica shook her head, still staring outside. “I can’t forgive you, Lee. I hope you know that.”

“What do you mean?” I said softly, fearing the words she might say next.

“I can’t trust you anymore,” she replied, her tone flat. “How can our marriage survive when I can’t trust you?”

“But-”

“There are no *buts*, Lee,” Jessica finally turned around and I saw tears in her eyes. “You’ve fucked it up. We can’t buy a house now. We were going to start a family...”

“We still can,” I said, walking over to her but she held a hand out in warning for me to not come any closer.

“How?” Jessica narrowed her eyes, then looked down at the floor. “We’re fucked, Lee. No, there’s no easy way out of this. I’m going to help you, if I can, with Pat Brewster but I don’t know what I can do about the other guy.”

I’d come clean this morning. Not just about how I’d ended up losing everything but also the true amount we owed and the fact that it wasn’t just Brewster, but also Johnny Sharples.

“What do you mean?” I asked, trying to think of a way to convince her to change her mind and give her some hope.

“I’m not going to just walk out and leave you in the shit,” Jessica finally looked up at me instead of examining the floor between her bare feet. “I’ll call Charlotte. We were never friends at school but we got on just fine. I’ll ask her to talk to her father and see if she can get him to ease off us.”

I’d thought about asking her to do that but right now didn’t seem like an appropriate time to ask her for anything.

“Thank you,” I said, trying to convey my genuine appreciation as best I could.

“But it doesn’t mean anything,” Jessica muttered, walking away to get her phone. “You and I are probably still done.”

“Don’t say that,” I pleaded, following her into the living room where she picked her phone up and searched for Charlotte’s details.

“I’ve got her on my Facebook,” she said, ignoring my plea. “I’m calling her, so shut up.”

I sat down, my heart racing and my stomach churning with the reality of my predicament. Jessica was thinking of leaving me and I couldn’t bear the thought.

“Charlotte? Hi,” I heard Jessica say. She put a finger to her lips for me to stay quiet as she talked to her old schoolmate. “I know we haven’t talked in forever but I really need your help with something.”

I listened, trying to fight off the feeling of embarrassment and shame that I was filled with, as Jessica told Charlotte what had happened and about the depth of the situation we were in.

“I understand that,” Jessica said as the conversation seemed to draw to a close. “I appreciate anything you can do, so thank you.”

I watched as Jessica listened to whatever Charlotte was saying next, wondering what Brewster’s daughter *could* do - if anything at all - to appease her father.

“Great. I’ll be there. See you in a while,” she said eventually, before hanging up. “Charlotte is going to speak to him but she thinks it would be best for me to talk to him personally as well. So I’m going over this evening when he’s home.”

“Do you think he’ll listen to you?” I asked, trying not to get my hopes up too much but allowing myself just a glimmer of optimism.

“I don’t know but I’ll try,” Jessica said, putting her phone down and looking at me with a flat, emotionless expression. “Just don’t think it means anything about you and me.”

“Jessica-” I started.

“No, Lee,” she cut me off angrily. “I’ll try to sort Pat Brewster out because I’m not a bitch. I’m not a lying asshole like you. I’m a good person who doesn’t get people they’re meant to love in the shit. Now go and shower because you smell and I need time to think.”

I nodded and realised I was probably better off keeping my mouth shut for now and doing what she wanted - giving her time to think.

I headed upstairs and ran a hot shower, allowing myself time to think too. In a way, I felt like a load was lifted from my shoulders now that my wife knew everything. Not having to hide anything from her; not having to lie to her, was a burden I was pleased to be rid of. Now I just had to find a way to get her to forgive me, while also negotiating on how to pay off my debts without getting myself beaten up again.

Jess barely spoke to me all day. I’d taken the day off work, citing the lie that I’d been ‘mugged’ and proving it with a photo of my bruised and patched up forehead. But for all the time I got to spend with my wife, I might as well have gone to work after all.

I heard her briefly on the phone again during the afternoon but when I tried to engage with her in conversation again she said she was busy and had to get ready to see Pat. She went upstairs and when she came down to tell me she was going, an hour or so later after having had a shower and got dressed, I was surprised at how she looked.

“You look amazing,” I commented, taken aback at how dressed up she was. She was wearing one of her best outfits, a tight black catsuit, with

pretty open-toed black heels and her red hair was beautifully styled, held back from her face in a silver clip. Her makeup was sexy, with scarlet lips and a light blue eyeshadow bringing out the colour of her irises.

“Thank you,” Jessica said, allowing herself to smile slightly at the compliment. “Pat is taking me out for dinner so that we can talk properly.”

Taking her out for dinner? I didn’t like the sound of that.

“To his restaurant?” I said, realising that was probably what he meant.

“That’s what I thought,” Jessica replied, “But no. He wants to take me to some restaurant he likes to visit. A French bistro somewhere out of town.”

“Do you think that’s safe?” I asked, staggered that she’d even consider going somewhere out of town with someone like Brewster.

“He knows who I am,” my wife reasoned. “In the sense that I’m one of Charlotte’s schoolmates and a sort of distant friend. He also knows that Charlotte knows where I am, plus you know where I am. He won’t do anything.”

“But why can’t he just talk to you at his restaurant or his house?”

“Apparently, he was going anyway, to have a business meeting but his date pulled out, so I’m helping him out by accompanying him.”

“Wait,” I said, scratching my head. “You do know he’s married, right? Why isn’t his wife going with him? Why does he need a ‘date’?”

“You clearly don’t know what men like Pat Brewster are like, do you?” Jessica looked at her watch. “I had better go. The worst thing would be for me to be late.”

“What do you mean by ‘what men like Pat Brewster are like’?” I said, stepping in front of her as she made to leave.

“They always have to show off in front of their business partners or rivals,” Jessica raised her eyebrows. “He’ll pass me off as his latest bit on the side. I can handle that if he means him not breaking your legs next time.”

“But what if-” I started to ask but Jess cut me off with another questioning look.

“I can handle myself,” she replied, easing her slim body past me and towards the door. “I think what you meant to say was ‘thank you.’ I’ll call you later.”

With that, she walked out through the front door, leaving my head spinning at today’s turn of events. Would she be safe with Brewster? I saw the logic in what she’d said - that he wouldn’t dare do anything bad to her, not with Charlotte being the one to set her meeting up, but did I trust Charlotte? She was Brewster’s daughter and probably in on his whole corrupt setup.

I picked up my phone, feeling the need to text him. I wanted to warn him, to put something like, ‘if you harm a hair on my wife’s head’ but I didn’t. He’d already had one of his thugs grope her while Vinny assaulted me and I knew that was just the start of what was to come if I didn’t pay up. If I sent him a threatening message - if I went back at him at all for yesterday’s events - it’d only make things worse.

I tossed my phone to one side and tried to watch something on TV to help myself relax but it didn’t work. I was on edge for the entire evening. I called Greg at one point, thanking him properly for coming over and looking after me yesterday but even my best friend didn’t seem keen to talk to me. His responses comprised mostly one-word answers until I gathered

that he wasn't in the mood for conversation and then I let him go back to doing whatever it was he was doing.

The night went on and on and no word from Jessica. By ten o'clock, I noted that she'd been out for three hours now. That was plenty long enough for them to have dinner and talk about our debt to him.

I picked up my phone again but refrained from calling her. It would be better to send a simple message first so I texted her, asking if she was okay and where she was. She must know I'd be worried about her but I didn't receive a reply. Half an hour later, I picked up the phone again, this time to call her but right at that moment, I heard the front door open and I rushed through to the hallway to see her closing the front door behind her.

"You're back," I stated the obvious, relief flooding through me. "Are you okay?"

"I'm fine," she replied, putting her bag down and kicking her heels off. "You'll be pleased to know that he's going to let you forego the rest of this week's payment and next week's too. We still owe him the money, but he's going to give you a longer period to pay it over."

"That's amazing," I said, happiness joining the other emotions that had been running rampant through my head all day and night. "How on Earth did you get him to agree to that?"

"I explained our situation," Jessica headed upstairs to get changed. "I told him you're not a bad person. Just that you've been stupid. I talked about Charlotte, put on the charm, made sure he enjoyed my company. And I promised to be his 'date' again this weekend."

"You did?" I said, following her upstairs but she turned around when she reached the top.

“Yes,” she said with a smile. She seemed in a much better mood than she had been this afternoon for some reason. “Now, I’m tired from not sleeping much last night, so I’m going to take my makeup off and go to bed. I want you to lock up downstairs and come to bed too.”

What did that mean? Had she forgiven me? I didn’t reply, I just did as I was told, heading back downstairs and locking the doors and windows before turning everything up and making my way back upstairs.

When I walked into the bedroom, I was in for another surprise. Jessica was laid on the bed, on top of the covers, totally naked.

“I think we both agree that you owe me for tonight,” she purred. What had gotten into her? Then she opened her legs, showing me her pussy, her reddish pubes neatly trimmed into a rectangle shape.

“I guess,” I said, stepping into the bedroom but leaving the door open so I could see her in the light coming in from the landing outside.

“Being pampered and spoiled by Pat has made me horny,” she whispered. “Lick my pussy. You owe me that, at least.”

6

Chapter 6

This seemed too good to be true, but as I undressed and joined her on the bed, she explained something.

“Before you start, don’t think you’re going to get to fuck me,” she said softly. “I’m not sucking your dick or making you cum. You owe me, Lee. Until you’ve earned my trust back, you’re not getting anything from me except this.”

With that, she reached down with one hand and pulled my head between her thighs. I wasn’t going to complain too much; I loved licking her pussy, so I let her press her mound into my face, extending my tongue to run it over her small labia.

She was already wet. Her pubes were sticky and matted with her juices. I’d have rather she showered before we did this but I wasn’t in a position to argue.

“That’s it,” she said, guiding my head with both hands until my tongue was over her clit and then as I allowed it to dance around her swelling bud, she pushed me further down. “Put your tongue inside,” she instructed.

I did as I was told, reaching up with my hand to part her lips with my fingers and dabbing down her slit until I found her hole. Then I pushed my face closer against her and teased my tongue into her as much as I could. She was cool and sticky and tasted odd because of how wet she was. Slightly salty and watery but I didn't care. I wanted to pleasure her. I'd do anything to get back in her good books.

"Good," she said, moving her hips almost like she was trying to grind her pussy into my face and onto my tongue. "Don't stop until I cum."

Jessica's own fingers were on her clit, rubbing it while I worked my tongue in and out of her and then up and down her slit. I took her labia into my mouth, sucking them and doing every trick I knew how to help her orgasm until eventually, she came, grabbing my head again and pushing her pussy into my face. Her legs trembled and she moaned loudly but held me there until her orgasm had subsided, then she pushed me away.

"Now I need to sleep," she said, rolling away from me.

I wrapped my arms around her and pressed my rock-hard cock against her ass but she pushed me away.

"No," she informed me firmly. "You can cuddle me but if you want *that* sorting out, you can do it yourself once I'm asleep."

I didn't say anything. Tonight had ended up much better than I expected and I was grateful for that. I wasn't going to do anything to spoil things. I

wrapped my arms around her again, being careful not to poke my erection against her and went to sleep.

* * *

“Are you going back to work today?” Jessica asked, shaking me awake the next morning.

“Yeah,” I said, levering myself up to a sitting position. “I should. I can’t take several days off with a mild concussion and a cut forehead.”

“I made you a coffee,” she said as she put a hot cup on the bedside cabinet. “I’ll see you downstairs. I want to talk to you quickly before you leave.”

She wanted to talk to me? I wondered what that was about, probably something to do with last night. I drank my coffee while trying to digest everything that had happened yesterday. Jessica had spoken about leaving me, saying she thought the damaged trust between us meant an end to our relationship but somehow she’d seemed to change her mind on that after the meeting with Brewster. She wouldn’t have let me make her orgasm or even share a bed with me if that was still the case.

I showered and examined the cut on my head in the mirror when I came out. The swelling had mostly gone down and the cut itself seemed to be healing beneath the small white adhesive strips that Greg had stuck over it.

All of this wasted a lot of time, resulting in me not having much time to talk to Jessica before I had to set off. I hoped whatever it was, it wasn’t anything too lengthy. She had referred to it as a ‘quick talk’ earlier.

“Your head looks better,” she commented as I joined her in the kitchen.

“It feels better too,” I agreed. “Did you want to talk to me before I go? I’m running a little late, so…”

“I did,” she said slowly, then looked away before continuing. “About last night.”

“I think I know what you’re going to say.” I could tell she was finding it difficult to talk to me, so I tried to help her out. None of this was Jessica’s fault.

“You do?” she said, frowning at me.

“Maybe,” I shrugged. “You don’t want me thinking that because I went down on you last night, that everything is fine or back to normal. You’re still mad at me and I deserve it. I know I’ve got a lot to do to build up your trust in me, but I want to try. I know I’m probably really down in your estimation right now and that our relationship is kind of in a mess but all I can do is ask you to give me a chance. Just one chance to fix things.”

Jessica didn’t answer. She pursed her lips and looked at me, her blue eyes blinking several times as she considered what I’d said. “There’s a lot to do for you to fix this, Lee. I’m not going to lie, you’ve really hurt me and upset me by lying to me and-”

She cut off suddenly, her eyes closing as if she was in pain.

“I’m sorry,” I apologised for what felt like the millionth time. “Just give me a chance. If it doesn’t work out, then I understand. Totally, I do. But one chance is all I ask for. I will do anything, *anything*, to keep us together and win your trust back.”

“Anything?” Jessica repeated. “I can ask *anything* of you? Is that what you’re saying?”

“Yes,” I nodded. I would. There was nothing I wouldn’t do for the woman I loved.

“Go to work,” she instructed. “And while you’re there, think of a way to sort out this Sharples guy. I can buy you time with Pat but I don’t know this other man and I don’t want his thugs turning up at my door like Brewster’s did the other day.”

“I will,” I promised with a half-smile that hopefully showed her I was happy and determined to fix things at the same time.

Then I left, setting off to work and hoping that my boss at the salesroom wouldn’t be too full of questions about the cut on my head.

* * *

That day and evening went well. Work was busy. I sold two cars, despite looking like I’d gone twelve rounds in a boxing ring and when I got home, I told Jess that a sizeable bonus would be coming my way, which would help out with Sharples.

She seemed in a better mood again, although she maintained some distance from me and when we went to bed that night, there was no repeat of last night’s action.

The next day was similar, a good day at work with another sale but as I left that evening, I noticed a woman who seemed to be watching me from a car parked a few yards down the road from the salesroom. Normally, I wouldn’t have thought anything of it, but I was sure I’d seen the same car and the same woman yesterday. She wasn’t easy to forget with her long, straight, chocolate-coloured hair and beautiful, huge, dark brown eyes.

I wondered if I should talk to her, perhaps she was looking for someone, but then again, she could simply be picking someone up from the

salesroom. She might be the girlfriend or wife of one of the other salesmen.

I made my way home, appreciating how nice it was to not have to look over my shoulder for Vinny or Conroy and it was the weekend tomorrow, so I'd be able to relax and not have to worry about work or any thugs following me around.

When Saturday came around, after another pleasant enough, if uneventful Friday evening, I decided to take Jessica out for lunch. Spending a lot of money somewhere fancy wasn't a good idea, but I thought even just lunch in a local coffee shop might get us out of the house for a few hours and give me some time to talk to her on neutral territory.

"Did you remember that I'm going out with Pat again later?" Jess mentioned as we sat sipping our coffee while waiting for our food to be brought over.

"What?" I asked, confused. "I know you mentioned something the other night but you never said it was tonight or even a confirmed thing."

"I thought I'd told you," Jessica replied. She looked lovely even when casually dressed like today, her red hair simply held up in a plain ponytail and her face makeup-free. "He's got another meeting but this time it's in his own restaurant, so I shouldn't be as late."

"And what do we get in return for you being his *date* again?" I asked, feeling better about it being at La Tavola this time.

"I assume he'll give you another week free from paying, but I don't know. It's just something I promised the other night," my wife replied, pausing as the waiter arrived with our food. "I'll clarify it later."

"Well, just to be clear from my end," I said, risking a joke, "If you want me to do the same thing I did after your night out the other night, I'll be happy to reward you for your help again."

Jessica picked up a slice of the pizza we'd ordered and studied me while she ate. "You enjoyed that, huh?"

"I did," I smiled, tucking into a slice of my own. "You seemed to as well, from how hard you came."

"Well," Jessica stated, "I suppose I did. We'll see what happens tonight but either way, remember, Lee. It doesn't mean that you and I are okay. You've still got a long way to go on that score."

"I get that," I said, just happy that she hadn't just rejected me out of hand.

That evening, Jessica got changed into another gorgeous outfit ready for her night out. This time she elected to wear an emerald green dress, one of my favourites because of the way the colour contrasted against and set off the fiery red of her hair. Again, her makeup was classy but sexy and with her red hair worn long this time, she looked amazing.

"I'm actually jealous," I admitted when she came downstairs, being careful not to stumble on the stairs in the green stilettos she was wearing. "You're... stunning."

"Let's hope Pat and his friends think so." Once again, she allowed herself a small smile at me gushing over her before heading out in the taxi she'd ordered.

I felt more relaxed this time, managing to find something to do to distract myself from the fact that my wife was out with another man. I picked a movie and made myself some popcorn from the kitchen cupboards and while I watched it, I kept reminding myself that Pat Brewster was simply using Jessica as a *fake date* to impress his business colleagues. That's all it was. And she was doing it to get me out of the trouble I'd managed to get us into. Maybe she was enjoying it a little - Brewster's

restaurant was good, the food was always of the highest quality - and who wouldn't enjoy a free night out with good food in nice surroundings? Even if the people you were with weren't the best company.

Then again, Brewster could be good company when he wanted to. Whenever I'd played poker with him, he'd always been fun to be around. He was loud and outspoken but always funny with it. People gravitated towards him. Maybe he was entertaining Jess and making the night less of a grind for her. I hoped so. Jessica going through an awful night just to make my life better wasn't what I wanted. Then again, the thought of her having too good a time was almost equally painful to think about.

Because she was in town at La Tavola, I'd expected her to be home earlier this time but she wasn't. I resisted the urge to call or text this time, unless it got really late, like after midnight or something.

Fortunately, I didn't have to. The clock was just about to turn eleven o'clock when I heard the door open, followed by the sounds of her stumbling through the hallway.

"Oh, fuck," I heard her say, followed by a giggle and when I got up to see what was going on, I found her on the floor, examining one of the stilettos, the heel broken clean off in her hand.

"Hey. Are you okay?" I asked, concerned that she might have hurt herself.

"I'm fine," she giggled. "I fell over."

"I can see that," I chuckled, bending down to pick her up and put her back on her feet. As I did so, I could smell alcohol on her. "You're drunk, aren't you?"

"I shouldn't have had that last glass of wine," she agreed. "That's what did it."

“I take it you had a nice evening,” I said, guiding her into the living room but when she realised where I was taking her, she put her hands against the door frame and shook her head.

“I had a *fantastic* night,” she whispered conspiratorially, “But I’m not to tell you why. Not yet. Besides, remember you said you’d lick my pussy when I got back. So it’s bedroom time, not living room time.”

She couldn’t tell me why? Had Brewster and his buddies been discussing confidential stuff in front of her? I was intrigued, but right now, I needed to do as she said and get her to bed.

I lifted her into my arms, making her giggle in my ear and carried her upstairs. I could lock up later. Right now, I wanted to bury my face into her pussy again.

7

Chapter 7

“I want you to lick it good like you did last time,” she whispered huskily as we reached the bedroom.

I lowered her onto the bed, then began to undress but Jessica didn’t even bother doing that. She simply lifted up the hem of her skirt, hitching it up to her waist and then slipped down her panties, which she threw across the room before spreading her thighs wide.

“Slow down,” I laughed. “Let’s get undressed and do it properly.”

“I don’t want to wait for that,” she said eagerly, sitting up so she could grab my hand and pull me to the bed. “Just do it. I want to look at you doing it.”

“What’s got into you?” I had time to ask before she grabbed me by the hair - slightly painfully - and yanked my head down between her thighs.

“I’m drunk and horny,” she moaned, her fingers going straight to her clit while waiting for me to start. This wasn’t like Jessica at all, but whatever was behind her being like this, I liked it.

She was wet again. *Really wet.* Again, her fine, reddish pubes were soaked and matted around her slit but just as I slid a finger into her, she stopped me.

“Lie down on your back,” she said, an urgency in her voice.

I thought she’d changed her mind and was going to undo my trousers and fuck me but she soon erased that notion by instead, straddling my head and lowering her pussy onto my surprised face.

Jess’s fingers were on her clit again, teasing herself as she rubbed against my mouth. I flicked my tongue out, pushing it between her folds, something which made her groan sexily, so I reached up and wrapped my hands around her hips and went to work on licking her beneath.

Again, her pussy tasted slightly salty and watery but I kept licking her as she rode my face until after only a few minutes, her fingers rubbing her clit hard in a small circle, she orgasmed. Her entire body shuddered and she cried out as a gush of pussy juice surged from her pussy all over my chin and mouth. Then she rolled away like she had done the other night, breathing heavily.

My own cock was hard and throbbing in my shorts. “I don’t suppose...” I said, rubbing my crotch and then undoing my belt.

“I’m tired,” Jessica said over her shoulder. “Plus you’re still not forgiven yet.”

That was a blunt knockback but I accepted it. I’d been a shit after all. A lot of women would simply have walked out but Jess was still here, for some reason or other, presumably because she loved me.

I waited until she was asleep, her breathing slow and regular and then I got up to go to the bathroom to relieve myself. I couldn’t sleep with this hard cock of mine and the taste of her pussy on my lips. As I got off the

bed, I picked up her panties to throw them in the wash basket and noted how damp they were. She must have been really horny tonight but then as I got into the bathroom and turned on the light, I dropped them in surprise.

Maybe it was a surprise or perhaps it was disgust. I wasn't sure which but the reaction was caused by the cause of the dampness. In the gusset of the panties in my hand was a thick later of white, sticky mucus. It looked very much like sperm.

I bent down and picked them up again, this time with the tips of my fingers to look closer. I couldn't be certain. Perhaps her pussy juice was just creamy. I didn't know, I wasn't an expert on such things but it looked a lot like cum to me.

I tossed them into the wash basket. Jessica *had* been to see Brewster tonight, hadn't she? Or had she been out with someone else and used Pat as a cover story? Then again, maybe she'd done... with Pat? No. She wouldn't. Not with Pat Brewster. Not even to get us out of debt.

I took a deep breath, trying to quell the rolling waves of emotions flooding through me. Jealousy. Hurt. Betrayal. Anger. Anxiety. They were all there, along with arousal which persisted despite this sudden shock.

I must be wrong. I wasn't cum. No way.

I stripped out of my clothes, got into the shower and jerked off, surprised at how hard my dick still was and I tried not to imagine Jessica fucking Pat Brewster or some other man but the image wouldn't go away. I managed to cum, despite the unwanted thoughts and then with the mental clarity that post-orgasm, the painful emotions returned again.

Had Jessica cheated on me? I realised that even her pussy had that metallic, salty twang to it, which now I thought about it, was how cum was

supposed to taste. I didn't actually know, I'd never tasted it, but it kind of added up and added to the evidence in her panties.

I got into bed, put my arms around my possibly unfaithful wife and tried to go to sleep.

* * *

After a fitful night with little sleep and what rest I did get was plagued with dreams that I didn't quite recall but weren't pleasant ones, I dragged myself out of bed. On Sundays when I wasn't working, we usually had a lie-in together but today Jessica was already awake and downstairs. I could hear her moving around and music playing, so I went into the bathroom for a shave and stopped when I saw my face in the mirror.

She's cheated on you, my face said to me with an expression of disdain. I blinked and shook myself, aware that I was still half-dreaming.

I filled the sink with hot water and soaped up my cheeks and neck. *She's whored herself out to Pat Brewster*, my paranoid mind whispered to me as I ran the razor across my chin, rinsing it between each stroke.

Look at her panties. They're full of cum.

I finished my shave, rinsed off the remaining foam and then felt my face for smoothness.

She let Brewster fuck her.

I had to stop thinking like this or I'd drive myself crazy. I brushed my teeth, got dressed and went downstairs, taking a deep breath before walking into the kitchen, where I could smell something cooking.

“Good morning,” my wife to me with a smile so easy and natural that any thoughts of her cheating on me yesterday went right out of my mind. There was no way she could hide something like that from me as well as this. She’d feel guilty and awkward. I knew Jess. She was a good, kind person.

“I didn’t sleep well,” I said, shuffling to the table and sitting down. “I had... weird dreams all night.”

“I guessed that. You were restless and talking in your sleep. You woke me up a few times.”

“I did?” I asked. I normally didn’t sleep talk, as far as I was aware of. “What was I saying?”

“I’m not sure,” Jess shrugged, putting a plate of bacon and eggs in front of me. “You were mumbling mostly. I couldn’t make out any words.”

“Well, whatever it was, it wasn’t good.” I tucked into the breakfast as she sat down opposite me at the kitchen table with her own food. “Thank you for this, by the way.”

“You’re welcome.” Jess beamed at me in a way that she hadn’t done since our falling out. “I wanted to talk to you and-”

She was interrupted by a knock at the door.

“Who’s that?” I said. We didn’t usually have any visitors this early on a Sunday morning. “What time is it? It’s early, right?”

“It’s half-past ten,” Jessica frowned, obviously not expecting anyone either. “I let you have an hour or two in bed, seeing as you’d obviously had a rough night.”

She got up and went to the front door and when she returned, the rotund shape of Johnny Sharples followed her into the kitchen.

“Hey, Lee,” he said jovially, eyeing the food in front of me. “I’m sorry to disturb you having breakfast.”

“Johnny,” I raised an eyebrow. “What are you doing here?”

“He said he needed to talk to us,” Jessica said from beside him, concern in her eyes. “Is everything okay?”

“Don’t worry,” Sharples said, raising his pudgy hands above his head. “I mean you no harm. I’m not Pat Brewster. Conroy can be... useful when that sort of thing is necessary, but that’s not really how I like to conduct business.”

I nodded at Jessica that it was okay and after a moment, she turned to Johnny. “I was just about to eat but if you like, feel free to sit and eat my breakfast and I’ll make myself some more.”

“No, no, but thank you,” he grinned at her. “I will take a coffee though if that’s not too much trouble. In fact, sit down, I’ll make one myself.”

Jessica hesitated, watching him walk over to the machine to pour himself a cup but I managed to catch her eye and nodded again, trying to reassure her. Sharples was still intimidating but he wasn’t Pat Brewster.

“Please sit down,” he told my wife, pointing at the chair and then smiling as she did so, perching his wide frame on the seat next to her. “Eat.”

Jessica put a forkful of bacon into her mouth but was still watching him warily out of the corner of her eye.

“What can we do for you, Johnny?” I said after I’d taken my own mouthful and chewed and swallowed it. I was trying to act cool but my heart was hammering in my chest.

“First of all, how’s your head?” he said, pointing to the cut.

“It’s fine,” I nodded. “Thanks for asking. Brewster’s man roughed me up pretty bad but I’m okay.”

“He didn’t hurt your lovely wife though, I hope?”

“His other man grabbed me,” Jessica said and I realised I hadn’t introduced her properly when he referred to her as my wife.

“This is Jessica, by the way,” I interrupted. “Sorry. Jess, this is Johnny. Obviously. The other guy who I-”

“Owe money to. I know,” she nodded, then turned to face him. “Which I’m guessing is why you’re here.”

“Indeed,” Johnny nodded, making his second chin wobble. “I hear that you’ve come to an agreement of sorts with Pat Brewster. I’d like to talk to you about that.”

“Oh,” Jess said sharply, glancing at me uncomfortably. “Right. How did you know about-”

“Pat and I aren’t exactly friends,” Johnny explained, “We’re actually more like rivals. But we talk. You know how it is.”

“Ah,” Jess said, her eyes darting around the kitchen for some reason. “I’d hoped that Pat would keep our *arrangement*... confidential. I asked him to keep it between us and-”

“I understand,” Johnny rubbed a hand through his thin, dark, slicked-back hair. “But it’s business. We have a shared interest in Lee here, he’s a mutual creditor to both our companies and when this sort of problem arrives, we often share information.”

“I see,” Jessica nodded, fiddling with a strand of red hair that was hanging down one side of her cheek. “But it’s *confidential*, you see?” When said that, she nodded her head in my direction almost imperceptibly. *Almost.*

Johnny’s eyes widened slightly, then his face settled immediately back to a neutral expression. “Okay. Right. Well, now that I’ve seen you for

myself, I understand why Pat Brewster is satisfied with your... arrangement-”

“He asked me to accompany him to a couple of business dinners,” Jessica filled in the gaps on the arrangement, “As his *pretend date*. To impress his business associates, I assume. I don’t believe him and his wife are on the best of terms.”

“Oh, no that’s not true,” Sharples shook his head. “He and Yvette are a very close couple. No, he likes to show off to people and give off the impression that he has a lot of different girlfriends. You know what I mean. Yvette is simply very tolerant and understanding of Pat’s... *little ways*.”

What was going on here? Their exchange wasn’t doing anything to allay my fears of last night.

“Lee, could you give me and Johnny a moment on our own to talk?” Jessica said, giving me a look that indicated that it wasn’t a question.

“Is... everything okay?” I returned, my eyes switching to Sharples and then back to my wife.

“It’s just like with Pat,” Jess flashed me a smile and a wink. “Let me sort it. It’ll take two minutes, I promise.”

“If you’re sure,” I replied, getting up and walking into the living room but when I closed the door, I made sure to leave it ajar very slightly but enough to put my ear to so I could hear the conversation.

There was nothing for a moment. The two of them were probably giving me time to get out of earshot and then make sure I didn’t walk back in. Then Jessica spoke.

“What do you want?”

“Pat Brewster says he fucked you yesterday,” he said quietly, but not quietly enough.

“He’s lying,” Jess replied after a moment’s pause.

“I don’t think so. Pat wouldn’t lie to me. Has no reason to.”

“We have an arrangement,” Jess said, then I heard movement so I quickly retreated around the corner, just as the door was pushed shut by someone. I cursed and went back to the door, pressing my ear against it. Luckily, I could still hear them talking.

“So gets to enjoy your... lovely body,” Sharples was saying, “And you get... what?”

“He lets us off with paying for a week or two,” Jess replied. Her voice sounded resigned and sad but I didn’t know how that made me feel. I felt... numb. Everything I’d worried about last night was true.

“And if I offered you a similar - or better - arrangement?” Sharples said, making my fists bunch in anger. I wanted to yank open the door, storm in and punch him in the face. I almost did but Jess would say ‘no’, wouldn’t she?

“How would it be better?” Jessica’s voice was hushed, barely audible. “Better as in just being a dinner date and not having to open my legs for you?”

“No.” I heard Sharples laugh softly. “Better as in I would actually allow your... time... to count as a payment. Your debt would go down, not just be deferred.”

“Okay,” my wife replied, making my jaw drop in surprise. “Let me think about it. Tell me, how much does Lee owe you exactly?”

I wasn’t listening now. Upon hearing those words, I turned and walked away from the door, unable to believe what she’d just said - that she’d think about it. She’d admitted to letting Pat Brewster have sex with her.

I walked to the far side of the house, sitting by the window and looking outside until Johnny appeared and said something, followed by a 'goodbye' and a wave of his hand. I didn't hear anything. I was too deep in thought. All my feelings were numb still.

I waited for the sound of the front door opening and closing and then waited for Jessica to step into the room before turning to her.

"What's going on?" I asked.

8

Chapter 8

“Johnny wants me to go out for dinner tonight,” Jess said, sitting on the sofa next to me. “He’s jealous, I think. I know what men like him are like. His ego is dented because Pat’s got something he hasn’t and he wants the same.”

You mean he wants to fuck you? I thought. He’s jealous that Pat’s got to fuck you, now he wants a piece.

But I didn’t say that. As I sat there looking at my pretty wife, her red hair held up on the top of her head in a high ponytail, with just a couple of strands hanging down either side of her face, her blue eyes searching mine, I felt a new emotion to add to the mix: shame.

This was my fault. Because I’d got us in so much debt and then failed to find a solution, Jessica had to resort to this. She’d let a complete stranger screw her to help me out. And now she was going to let another man do the same. All to get me out of the trouble I’d gotten us into.

“Tonight?” I found myself saying. “I thought we could go out or-”

“With what?” Jess raised an eyebrow. “We’re broke, Lee.”

“I know,” I said, struggling to think of what I should say and do. “Do you want to go out with him?”

In my head, the question had been, *do you want to fuck him?* But again, I kept my thoughts to myself, for now, at least.

“It’s just dinner,” Jessica lied. “I told him I had to ask you first. In return, he’s going to actually knock £500 off our debt.”

Our debt. She’d said *our* debt. That made me feel terrible again. This wasn’t her debt. It was mine.

“I’ve got us into this situation,” I managed to say. My throat was dry. I needed a drink, preferably something alcoholic. “Not you. I owe the money, not you, Jess. You shouldn’t be having to do... *this...* for me.”

You shouldn’t be doing it all. We’re married. My inner voice was raging to be spoken out loud but I was trying to keep control until my whirling emotions calmed down.

“We owe them money,” Jessica replied, her eyes bright, focused and steady as she lowered her face to meet mine. I was looking down at my knees, fighting the sensations of anger and shame. “Not you. *Us*. We’re married. I might not have forgiven you but I haven’t completely given up on us, Lee. I’ll fight for our marriage as long as I think there’s a way to fix things. That’s what I was going to talk to you about this morning before Johnny turned up.”

For some reason, that felt like another hammer blow to the stomach. It confirmed what I thought; that she loved me and valued her marriage so much that she’d lowered herself to this - sleeping with Brewster and now possibly Sharples. While she was actually breaking her marriage vows and betraying me, in an ironic way she was doing it *for us*.

“I don’t know what to say.”

“Well, a thank you might be a start,” Jessica put her hand on my shoulder and stood up. “I’ll clean up in the kitchen, then we spend some time together this afternoon before I get ready to go out.”

I watched her leave, her curvy but firm behind looking great in the grey sweatpants she was wearing. I didn’t know how I felt. I didn’t know what to do or how to react. All I knew was that everything was spiralling out of my control and didn’t know how to stop it.

* * *

We did spend time together that day. We watched a movie, shared a bowl of popcorn and some nachos and we even *kind of* cuddled a little bit on the sofa. We were certainly a lot closer physically than we’d been recently, to the point where things felt almost normal.

Almost.

All I could think of was what was going to happen later. I couldn’t let Jessica go through with it. Going on a dinner date with Pat Brewster - being the pretty face on his arm, to show off to his buddies - was one thing. But letting her go out knowing it was more than that - *so much* more than that - was a different thing. She was prostituting herself out to get us out of debt.

That might seem a harsh way of looking at it, but it was basically true and I couldn’t let her do it.

“Right,” she said, clearing up the popcorn and nacho bowls from the living room table. “I’d better go and get ready. I’ve arranged to meet Johnny in an hour.”

I’d seen her texting someone but didn’t know it was Sharples.

“I don’t want you to go,” I blurted out. “You don’t have to do this. We’ll find another way.”

Jessica shook her head. “It’s not up to you and anyway, if I cancel on Johnny now, he’ll be pissed.”

That was true but still, I’d rather face the wrath of Johnny Sharples than let him fuck my wife. “You don’t need to,” I said. “I told you, I’ll find another way.”

“There is no other way,” Jessica simply shrugged, not seeming at all reluctant to do what she was going to do. “I’m going out and that’s it, Lee.”

She went upstairs, despite me calling her name one more time. If I was going to stop this, I was going to have to physically stop her from leaving and not just talk her out of it so when she came downstairs, looking glamorous in a white top and skirt, I stood in the hallway blocking the door.

“How do I look?” she said, doing a twirl in front of me.

“Beautiful,” I said, which was the truth. She looked incredibly sexy, her hair flowing loose over her shoulders in fiery waves and her makeup bold and daring with bright red lips and blue eye shadow.

“Thank you,” she replied with a strangely shy smile. “I should go. I don’t want to be late. I took way too long getting ready.”

“I don’t want Sharples to fuck you,” I muttered, standing between her and the door.

“Okay,” Jessica laughed. “I’m just going to dinner with him, Lee. Same as with Pat.”

Had I misheard earlier? I’d heard her confirm to Sharples that she’s had sex with Brewster. Hadn’t I? The cum in her panties, her weird behaviour, it all made sense. And yet, she’d just said that she hadn’t so convincingly that I was now doubting myself.

Did I say something? Did I ask her right out? The problem was that today was the first day that she'd given me hope for our marriage. If I got this wrong, if I accused her of something she hadn't done, it could ruin everything.

Jess walked around me and opened the door. Did I stop her?

"I'll see you in a few hours," she said. "Just think of why I'm doing this, okay?"

Then she was gone. The door closed behind her and a minute later, I heard a taxi pull up and then leave. It was too late now. I would just have to wait and see what happened.

* * *

The next three hours were almost unbearable. With Brewster, I'd been nervous and tense but now, knowing the potential truth of the situation, the stakes were even higher. I wasn't just worried about her safety and welfare or the outcome of the evening as far as the debt situation - now I was worried about the sanctity of my marriage.

I couldn't relax. I tried watching a film. I tried listening to music. I couldn't even eat. I had a couple of beers and tried to sleep but nothing worked. My mind was in overdrive as there would be no stopping it until Jessica walked back through the door.

"I'm back," I heard her say, just as I was starting to doze off in our bed. "Lee?"

"I'm upstairs," I called down.

“Hey.” She walked into the bedroom, tossing her white shoes on the floor and walking over to me. “Why are you in bed so early? Are you okay?”

“I’m just tired,” I lied. “Remember, I didn’t sleep well last night. You’re not drunk this time?”

“Nope,” Jess grinned. “To be honest, I’ve been nursing a bit of a hangover all day and the thought of more drink-” she pulled a vomiting face.

“So, how did it go?” I asked.

Did you fuck him? was the question my mind asked.

“Good,” she said, turning around, indicating for me to help her with the zip on the back of her skirt which was stuck. “He took me to La Tavola, to show off in front of Pat. See, I told you, these men are all about their stupid egos.”

“Okay,” I nodded. “And then... what?”

“What do you mean?” Jess slipped down the skirt and then undid and removed her top to reveal a sexy lacy white bra and panty set. “Oh, how did I get on with him? Excellent. He’s a funny guy and quite good company actually. He’s also taken five hundred pounds off our debt and nothing is due this week now.”

“So you had a meal, some drinks - non-alcoholic drinks - and then came home?”

“You’re being weird tonight,” Jessica frowned at me as she took off her bra, exposing her lightly freckled 36D breasts. “Are you sure you’re okay?”

She seemed so calm, so composed that she couldn’t have fucked him. There was no way that Jess could lie so well and so brazenly to me.

“I’m sorry,” I replied, watching her pull a nightshirt over her head before wriggling out of her panties. “Maybe I’m a little bit jealous. These guys getting to take my wife out and parade them on their arm like they’re theirs.”

She got into bed next to me, the smell of her floral perfume wafting into my nostrils. “You don’t have to worry you know. I’m not so impressed with Pat’s fancy restaurants and Johnny’s jokes that I’m about to run away with them or anything. It’s only... It’s only dinner.”

That pause was accompanied by a momentary swallow and an expression on her face like she’d had to stop herself from saying something she shouldn’t. Was I imagining it or had she been about to say ‘It’s only sex’?

“As long as that’s all it is,” I said, half-joking.

Jessica looked at me for a moment, then reached across and turned the lamp off, plunging the bedroom into darkness. “I already locked the door,” she whispered, pressing her body against mine. “Are you going to lick my pussy again or do you want to watch me masturbate? These nights out do seem to make me horny.”

I bet they do, I thought to myself. *Watch her masturbate?* That was a new one. When she mentioned licking her pussy, a horrid thought crossed my mind. Something I hadn’t thought about until now. If she *had* slept with Brewster the other day and yesterday, the salty wetness I’d tasted must have been...

“Masturbate,” I whispered. “I’d like to watch that.”

As she opened her long legs and started to rub her pussy, I tried to look for any evidence of cum between her legs or even any sign at all that she might have had sex tonight. It was too hard to tell. Unless I tasted her pussy,

there was probably no way of knowing but I wasn't going to risk it. I'd already potentially tasted Brewster's sperm. I had no intention of tasting Sharples's as well.

"You can masturbate too if you want," Jess sighed, her fingers teasing her clit in small circles as I watched.

The sight in front of me was a turn on. Jess had pushed the nightshirt up and was playing with one of her nipples with the hand that wasn't between her legs. I took down my shorts and stroked my already hard cock, watching her pleasure herself.

"Kiss me," she moaned. "I want you to kiss me as I cum."

I leaned forward, thrilled that she was letting me kiss her. This was a huge step.

"Oh, I'm cumming," she said against my lips as they connected. Her body began to jerk and then she kissed me hard, her tongue invading my mouth, seeking out mine.

And then I tasted it. The slightly metallic, watery saltiness. Was I imagining it or had Sharples ejaculated in my wife's mouth. I kept kissing her trying to work out if it was sperm I was tasting and for some reason, my cock twitched in my hand at the thought of her sucking him and before I could stop, I came.

"You came too?" she said breathlessly, looking down between us. While I'd tried to catch it in my hand, some of my sperm had shot out and landed on her lower body.

"Yes," I replied, rolling away and getting a tissue from the bedside cabinet. I wiped my hand then used it to clean the cum from her belly. Then I rolled over, away from her, a weird feeling of disgust and shame creeping over me. "I'm tired. Good night."

“Oh, okay,” I heard her say. “Did I say something wrong?”

I didn’t reply. I just closed my eyes and hoped that when I woke up in the morning, everything would be back to normal and this whole past week or two would turn out to be just a nightmare.

Chapter 9

When I woke up, it was Monday morning. Work lay ahead and everything that had happened last week was still real. Jessica had been out with Johnny Sharples yesterday and got him to let us off with one week's payments, wiping five hundred pounds from our slate. Whether or not she'd done that by having sex with him or giving him a blowjob, or just through her charm and powers of persuasion, I still didn't know. But I had to find out somehow. The problem was I was scared. Scared of asking the question and what it might do to our improving but still fragile relationship and more simply, scared of the answer itself and how it would affect me emotionally.

I came so close to asking her that morning over breakfast but didn't. When she asked me again what had been wrong with me last night and if she'd said something to upset me, I dismissed it out of hand, saying I'd just been tired and grumpy.

I headed out to work and fortunately had another busy day, which was good as it kept me distracted from what was going on in my head but when

I left the salesroom that evening, I was in for a surprise.

I was already deep in thought as to what to and say to Jessica tonight and so didn't notice the car with the window open and the chocolate-haired beauty sat in the driver's seat until she spoke to me.

"Lee?" she said in a hushed voice. "Lee Parker?"

"That's me," I said, bending down to look through the window at her. "Can I help you?"

"I'm Charlotte Brewster," she introduced herself. "We need to talk."

"Pat's daughter?" I asked, immediately feeling like an idiot in front of the gorgeous woman for asking such a stupid question.

"Get in," she said and reached across to open the passenger side door. "I'll give you a ride home."

"So you can do what? Take me to your father for another facial injury?" I said, pointing to the still-healing cut on my forehead.

"I heard about that and I'm sorry," Charlotte replied, refusing to react to my slightly angry tone. "No, I'll just take you home so we can talk on the way."

"Talk about what?" I shrugged. "Just tell your dad that when he's bored of taking my wife out for dinner and pretending that she's his girlfriend or whatever, he'll get his money."

"That's what I want to talk about," Charlotte said patiently. "Your wife and my dad. Please, just trust me and get in. You'll want to hear what I've got to say."

I stood there a moment longer, then realising that I was probably in danger of causing a scene outside my workplace and inviting questions I really didn't want to be asked, I got into the car and shut the door.

“Say what you have to say but you don’t have to take me home,” I said but Charlotte had already started the car and was pulling away.

“Stop being silly,” she said, concentrating on the road as we approached a roundabout. “It’s no trouble for me to take you home and as I said, it gives me chance to talk to you about Jessica.”

“I know you two were friends at school and that she called you and asked you to help out. I know you arranged for her to talk to your father and I know that he’s using her as eye candy at his business meetings. I’m grateful that you’ve helped out,” I told her. I didn’t mention that he might also be having sex with Jess, but that’s something Charlotte didn’t need to know.

“We weren’t friends,” Charlotte corrected me. “I couldn’t stand Jessica at school. She was horrible to me.”

“What?”

“You might not know this, but your darling wife was very much one of the mean girls at school.”

“I doubt that,” I scoffed which caused Charlotte to look sideways at me for a moment.

“Jessica was popular at school,” she explained. “I wasn’t. It might be hard to believe now but I was *ugly* at school. I had glasses, acne, braces on my teeth. I was a mess.”

“Maybe so, but I’m fairly sure people weren’t mean to you when they found out who your family are.”

“My dad wasn’t rich back then,” Charlotte replied, looking at me again as we paused at a red light. “This was ten years ago, Lee. Back then Dad just ran a small Italian restaurant. He didn’t have any of his other businesses

as he does now. We barely had any money. It's only the last five or six years that things changed in that way."

"I didn't know that," I confessed. I really didn't. I'd just assumed Pat had always been the man he is now.

"So, yeah. I have no love for your wife at all, Lee. She was a complete bitch back then."

"Then why did you help her?" I asked, trying to take in this new information about Jess.

"Because I'm not like the rest of my family," she replied, with a small smile at me. "I know what my dad is involved in. I know my brothers are all mixed up in it too and I don't like it. I'm not involved with any of it. I want to make my own life away from all of that. I like to think of myself as a good person. If someone asks me for my help, I'll always try, no matter if they were a bit of a bitch back when we were kids."

"Well, I appreciate it," I said, wondering if Charlotte was really being sincere or if this was just Pat Brewster's somehow setting me up again.

"And there's the problem," Charlotte said, turning onto the long road which headed to our home. "I *have* helped you out but now I feel bad about it, knowing what I know."

I looked at her. She was incredibly pretty, her hair perfectly straightened, her skin beautiful bronzed, almost like a model or pop star. She was what you'd expect from a daddy's girl with her *daddy* being someone like Brewster and yet she certainly did seem a lot different to her father.

"Why do you feel bad?" I had to ask, suddenly fearing the worst. "What do you know?"

“I know a lot about how my father operates,” she replied, choosing her words carefully. “And I know what a schmuck he is. He’s always cheating on mum and she just lets him get away with it because she’s got her own playthings. The entire thing grosses me out and now I’ve got your wife involved in it all.”

“Involved?” I pressed her to continue. “What do you mean?”

“So you don’t know the whole of it,” Charlotte nodded to herself. “I thought so.”

“The whole of what?” I said, growing impatient. “Charlotte, stop beating around the bush and just tell me what’s going on. Why do you feel bad?”

Charlotte didn’t look at me. She kept focused on the road. “Dad said you were a good poker player. One of the best he’s ever played with.”

“Didn’t stop him taking all my money though and what’s that got to do with anything?”

“Was it just that you got really unlucky?” Charlotte asked, finally looking sideways at me for a moment. “Is that why you got into so much debt to him? Is that how poker works? You just lose a few big games because your luck turns sour and then you’re chasing it and chasing it and-”

“Yes,” I responded, getting frustrated with her change of subject. I felt like she was going to tell me something about Jess and her father and I wanted to get to the heart of that. Not a conversation about my bad luck story. “That’s about the gist of it. Now, what were you going to tell me about Jessica? She’s involved in... what?”

“There’s a couple of things I wanted to tell you,” Charlotte pointed through the window. “Which house is yours?”

“Further down the road, just there,” I pointed to it.

“I’ll pull over here,” she said, stopping a hundred yards or so away. “So she won’t see us together. Look, I won’t drop everything on you. If you just want to know about Jessica and not the other stuff, well, that’s okay, I guess. Maybe we’ll talk again. I like you. You seem a nice guy. Certainly not someone who deserves... all the stuff that’s going on right now.”

“What stuff?” I exhaled, removed my seat belt and turned to face her. “Charlotte, what’s the reason you’ve been watching me after work? I saw you last week. Twice, I think.”

“I wanted to tell you sooner but I didn’t know how to.”

“Tell me what?”

“Dad isn’t just using her as eye candy,” Charlotte said quickly, as though she was trying to just say it before she changed her mind. “He’s having sex with her.”

I didn’t reply. I just stared at her, watching her huge dark brown eyes and wondering what she was thinking or trying to achieve by telling me this. Was this all part of some plan? All an attempt masterminded by Pat Brewster, to hurt me?

However, it confirmed my suspicions. I’d seen - and even tasted - what could be evidence of Jess being unfaithful. It made sense too although I still found it unbelievable that she’d actually do it - that she’d go that far, make that much of a sacrifice - for me.

“How do you know that?” I said, looking down at my hands which were gripping my thighs rigidly. “How do you know that’s true?”

“Daniel - that’s my younger brother - told me,” she replied gently. “He saw them doing it in dad’s car last week. He saw *everything*, dad likes to show off. He’s somewhat of an exhibitionist, you could say. Then on Saturday night, Dad brought her home and they went into his bedroom. My

bedroom is next door and I heard them at it, Lee. They were in there for an hour and I heard everything.”

The way Charlotte was looking at me made me feel suddenly foolish. She thought she was breaking this news to me for the first time and was watching me process it, looking for the inevitable hurt and betrayal that I must be feeling. She might seem a nice girl, she might say she was different to her father, but still, I wasn’t going to let a Brewster have that victory over me, even a younger female one.

“I know,” I replied, trying to salvage some dignity. “She doesn’t know that I know, but I’m not stupid, Charlotte. I figured out what was going on after the first evening they spent together.”

“And you’re okay with it?” she asked softly.

“No,” I sighed. “I didn’t know for sure until you confirmed it just now and even now, I don’t know what to do about it.”

“You have to stop it.”

“I can’t,” I put my hands over my face. “There’s no other way. What’s done is done.”

“Find the money and pay him,” Charlotte said and I felt her hand on my arm, pulling my hands free of my face so she could look at me. “Offer to work for him. Whatever you have to do. I told you I have no love for your wife, I don’t, but I feel bad for you and what she’s having to do. It’s not right and that’s why I’m here, to try and stop it because if I don’t, I’ll feel like I’m no better than him or the rest of my family.”

“I don’t have the money,” I replied, shaking my head. “I’ve tried everything, Charlotte. Your dad sent his thugs around. I thought they were going to rape Jess and beat me up and next time, they just might. If Jessica

is doing this, then you have to understand she thinks this is the only way out of it, and she's probably right."

"Maybe..." Charlotte started, looking out of the window in thought, "Maybe the one person that could stop it might listen to you."

"And who's that?" I asked.

"My mother," Charlotte nodded, switching her attention back to me. "She and dad do their own thing but they're also still very close. He listens to her and if she tells him to do something or not do something, he usually does what she says. You could go to her - you've met her, right?"

"I've met her," I nodded, remembering Yvette and how strangely intimidating she was. "But what would I say?"

"Whatever you do, don't tell her I've said anything," Charlotte pointed out, "I'm already the black sheep of the family for refusing to get involved in anything they do, so if she or dad knew that I'm even telling you this stuff... well, I don't even want to think about that."

"So, I go to her and tell her that I've somehow found out that her husband is fucking my wife," I murmured half to myself, trying to work it out in my head, "And I say I'm not happy about it and I'm sure she isn't happy about it either... and then I ask her to make him stop?"

"You'd be better pleading to her," Charlotte screwed her lips up in thought. "Tell her how much you love Jessica and that it's breaking your heart. My mother has a big ego, bigger than dad's even, but she also has a romantic, good-hearted side too. So, if you play up to her ego and give her the whole broken-heart thing... It might be worth a shot."

"I'll think about it," I said, looking out of the car towards the house. "I should go."

“There’s something else too,” she said after an awkward silence for a few moments.

“I don’t need any more details,” I interrupted her. “I get the picture, your dad’s fucking my wife-”

“No, it’s about dad-”

“Charlotte, I don’t need to know anything else about what your father does or whatever,” I insisted, trying not to appear ungrateful but to still be firm. “I really appreciate you telling me this, Charlotte, I do. It’s great that you’re trying to help me and it’s good that you don’t want to get involved in your dad’s dealings, but I have a lot to process right now and I just need to go home. Okay?”

“Okay,” the beautiful young lady sat behind the steering wheel said. “I understand. Can I just give you my number? Then you can call me when you’re ready for the rest of what I had to tell you.”

I just needed to get home and see Jessica. I didn’t know how I was going to react but I simply needed to go, so I gave Charlotte my phone and once she’d put her number into my contacts, I thanked her again, got out of the car and walked the short distance to the house.

Chapter 10

By the time I walked through the front door, I'd decided what I was going to do. It was only fair for me to give Jessica a chance to tell me herself what she'd done. If she confessed everything, we could talk. If not... I didn't know what I'd do, but hopefully, it wouldn't come to that. She'd come clean and then we could talk about it. I just had to give her a nudge.

"Good day at work?" she said, then looked at the watch on her wrist. "You're a little early."

"I got a lift," I replied although I didn't tell her who from. "What's for dinner? If you haven't already started cooking, maybe I could order us something in. Pizza, maybe?"

"You don't have to," Jess replied with a smile. "Can we afford it?"

"I know I don't *have* to." She'd unknowingly played into my hands. "But when you're married, you do things for each other, right?"

"What?" she asked, smiling but with a puzzled look on her face. She looked gorgeous today even though she was dressed down in a t-shirt and jeans and had her hair tied back.

"We do things for each other," I repeated. "When you love each other."

"You're being weird," she laughed. "Order us pizza and stop it with the mushy weird stuff."

“I’m not being weird,” I said after I’d ordered us takeout. “Or mushy. You’ve sacrificed things for me, you went out and endured *stuff* with Pat and Johnny, for me.”

I emphasized the word ‘stuff’, trying to hint that I knew but if she recognised that or even suspected that I was fishing for information, she didn’t react to it.

“I wouldn’t say *endured*,” she shook her head. “Sure, I wouldn’t normally go out and allow men like that to parade me on their arm like some sort of trophy mistress, but it really wasn’t that bad. And I’ll do keep doing it as long as it takes until we’re free from them and our debt to them.”

“I really appreciate you doing it though,” I carried on. “You’ve done it twice with Pat now and once with Sharples. All for me.”

“For *us*,” she corrected me again, still not cottoning on to what I was trying to communicate to her: that I knew. Then for some reason, her tone changed. “And you are being weird. I told you, don’t think you’re forgiven yet, so you really don’t need to do all this ‘I appreciate it’ type stuff. I’m doing what I’m doing to get you out of the shit so we can try and give our marriage one last fair shot.”

With that, she turned and walked out of the kitchen and into the living room. I saw her sit down and point the remote at the screen and wondered why she’d just changed like that. Had I caught a nerve? Did she feel guilty?

The pizza arrived soon after and as we sat and ate it while watching a movie, I kept looking at Jessica, trying to work her out when a new thought entered my head. If she’d fucked both Brewster and Sharples, who else had she fucked? She could have cheated on me before. I wouldn’t know. This sort of thing could have been going on for years. Brewster’s cock might not be the first she’d had inside her since we got married.

Stop, I told myself. *You have to stop thinking like this.*

“Are you happy?” I asked her, knowing the question was out of left field, but the words sprung out of my mouth before I had a chance to stop them.

“With the pizza?” she giggled. “Yes, it’s delicious.”

“No, I mean happy with *us*.” I reworded the question. “I know you’re not happy right now, with everything that’s happened but before this started, were you happy? With me? With us? With everything, our marriage, our sex life?”

“No one is completely happy,” Jessica shrugged and tore a chunk of pizza off the slice in her hand to stuff in her mouth. “But yes, I was happy enough until all this happened. Why?”

“Is there anything you want to tell me or talk about?”

“Lee, you’re being weird. Just stop,” she pushed the rest of the pizza into her mouth then when she’d finished eating, she sighed. “I’m tired and not in the mood for whatever is wrong with you tonight. I’ve got a lot on my mind too, you know? Can we just watch the movie then have an early night. Maybe we can talk properly tomorrow.”

I didn’t reply. I just nodded, finished off my own pizza and went back to watching the movie in silence. I’d given her the opportunity to tell me. I could tell that what she was doing was bothering her and I’d given her a pathway to confess to me, but she hadn’t. She’d rather keep up the lie.

What should I do? Should I just come out with me and tell her that I knew? I could use the cum-filled panties as a way of explaining rather than drop Charlotte into trouble.

But I couldn’t. For some reason, I just couldn’t. I don’t know whether I was scared of losing my temper if I went in confrontational or if my ego

just couldn't face another inevitable bruising by admitting that I knew in a more passive way. Whatever it was, I couldn't bring myself to talk about it. I needed Jessica to confess to me. And she didn't.

"You're right," I said after a while. "I am in a weird mood. I'm sorry. I think I need a walk to clear my head."

"What?" Jess said, tilting her head and looking at me. "I knew you were. You were moody last night too. Talk to me."

"It's just this whole thing," I said, standing up. "Brewster, Sharples. Us. I just need to clear my head."

Jessica didn't seem convinced but she nodded. "Okay. Keep your phone switched on so I can call you. Things might not be good right now, but I still care about you. I'm worried."

"Really, it's just a walk," I said, putting on my coat and shoes. "Give me an hour. I just need some space to think."

She looked like she was about to say something as I left, but she didn't.

She didn't. I felt a pain in my chest like my heart was being torn in two and yet I couldn't act on it. This was of my doing. I'd put us in this situation. If I hadn't been such a dumb idiot; if I hadn't got so deep into debt; if I hadn't chased lady luck after she turned her back on me; if I hadn't thrown good money after bad, none of this would have happened.

I stood outside on the cold, damp street. It was dark but it wasn't that late, so I pulled out my phone and brought up the last number entered into it and hit 'dial'.

“Charlotte,” I said when she answered. “It’s Lee. Can you talk?”

* * *

“Are you sure this is okay?” I asked as she drove me to their house.

“If it wasn’t okay, we wouldn’t be going,” she replied with a brief smile.

I’d called her and asked when and how I could get to see her mother. I hadn’t expected her to reply that *right now* was a good time. Pat was out, as were her brothers, so her mother was alone and when Charlotte had mentioned it to her, she’d said that I could come over now if I wanted to.

I’d decided now was okay. I could say what I wanted to say while I was in the mood to do it. If I simply walked the streets like I’d intended to, or given myself any more time or opportunity to think about it, I’d probably talk myself out of it.

“I’m nervous,” I said. “Your mother terrifies me.”

“Don’t be silly,” Charlotte grinned. “Just remember what I said. Preen her ego and be nice. Not too nice, mind you. Anyway, where’s Jessica? Or should I say, where does she think you are?”

“I tried to get her to confess,” I told Charlotte what I’d said back in the house and she listened, nodding sagely. “I ended up getting in a bad mood and went out for a walk.”

“I’m sorry it went that way,” she looked at me with a sympathetic smile. “But okay, listen. We’re here. Follow me into the house and remember everything I told you.”

We got out of the car and I followed her through the security gate and into the imposing house but before Charlotte send me into the conservatory

where her mother was waiting for me, she leaned in close and whispered something.

“Be nice but be careful. Remember what I said about my mother having playthings? She likes you. She told me that, but trust me, you don’t want to go down *that* route.”

“Right,” I said, suddenly feeling incredibly awkward in front of Charlotte. “I’ll behave myself with your mother, I promise.”

“It’s not you that I’m worried about,” she whispered, then left me as Yvette appeared in the doorway. Pat Brewster’s wife was wearing a black top and pyjama bottoms, still managing to somehow look glamorous and attractive in her nighttime loungewear.

“You wanted to see me?” she arched a perfectly shaped dark eyebrow, at odds with her platinum blonde hair which was tousled beautifully around her face.

“I do,” I nodded, taking a deep breath and following her into Brewster’s conservatory. It was beautifully decorated, as I expected it to be, with pale alabaster walls, a large open fireplace and an enormous crystal chandelier hanging above our heads as she made me sit down next to her on the white leather sofa.

“My husband is screwing your wife,” she said, picking up a wine glass and filling it up from a bottle on the table. “Is that what you came to tell me?”

Shit. I wasn’t expecting that and it totally threw me. I’d rehearsed how this would go in the car on the way here and it didn’t start like this.

Preen and plead. That was Charlotte’s advice.

“Yes, he is,” I said, my mind working fast and trying to adjust.

“Would you like a glass of Chablis?” she said next, “While you work out what to say.”

Yvette was good. I felt way out of my league but I was here now and this might be the only shot I had at saving my marriage.

“I’d love a glass, yes, thank you.” I watched as she filled up a second glass and passed it to me. I tasted it and savoured the sharp, dryness of it. I’d never had Chablis before. “I came to ask you if there was anything you could do to help me. Your husband’s... *arrangement* with Jessica is,” I paused, trying to find the right words to say, “...making me uncomfortable.”

“I see,” Yvette smiled over the rim of her glass.

Preen and plead. Charlotte’s words echoed in my head. *She’s romantic too, don’t forget.*

“I hope you don’t mind me saying this,” I said quickly before she could continue. “But you’re an incredibly attractive woman. I don’t understand why Pat would ever want to touch another woman when he’s married to someone like you.”

As soon as I said that, I cringed inwardly at the cheesiness of it. I wasn’t good at this but I had to try.

Yvette pursed her lips and I took a deep breath, wondering if I’d said the wrong thing.

“Thank you. I always try to look presentable,” she said finally, allowing me a small smile. She indicated at the black pyjamas she was wearing. “Although you’ve caught me quite unprepared for guests.”

“I know and I’m sorry for asking to see you at such a late hour,” I apologised. “But I really need your help.”

“My husband and I have an understanding,” Yvette said, taking another sip as I did the same. “He is allowed to have other women, as long as I am allowed to do the same.”

I raised my eyebrows, pretending that this was the first I’d heard of this.

“You like women too?” I joked, trying to act cool and composed. “Or do you mean men?”

“I do like women,” Yvette’s mouth twitched up at the corners mischievously. “But it’s mostly men that I spend my spare time with.”

“As long as it works for you and Pat, it’s good. That’s my take on it,” I nodded understandingly.

“So why would you think that I would - or even could - tell Patrick to stop fucking your wife?” Yvette angled her head and waited for me to answer.

“Because you’re beautiful and he obviously loves you more than anything,” I said, finally getting to use some of the words I’d rehearsed in my head earlier. “He used to talk about you a lot when we played poker together. He worships the ground you walk on. As would I, if I was married to someone that looks like you.”

“Ooooh, that’s good,” Yvette smiled, her eyes lidded. “Carry on.”

“I love Jessica,” I said, opening up my arms and taking a deep breath. “And while she’s done what she’s done, that hasn’t changed. I’m not supposed to know. She’s kept it from me but I know she feels bad about it. I thought that - maybe - if I could somehow stop it from happening again, I could forgive her, forget about it and we could move on and pretend it never happened.”

“You could do that?” Yvette said. “You could really forgive and forget, just like that?”

“I don’t know,” I shrugged. “I’m a romantic. I believe in love, so I have to try.”

I went to take another sip but my glass was dry. I couldn’t even remember drinking it all. Yvette noticed and filled it up for me while studying me.

“I could talk to him,” she said after a long moment. “I could tell him that I think he’s going too far and potentially breaking up a marriage. The problem with Pat is that he just doesn’t think at times. Or at least, not with his heart. He thinks with his brain when it comes to satisfying his ego and with his dick when he’s horny. Which he is a lot of the time.”

“Would you do that for me?” I asked. “I’m desperate. I love Jessica so much. I know I got us into this debt situation but this isn’t the way I want to get out of it.”

“What do I get in return?” Yvette said, after another long moment.

“My gratitude,” I said, shrugging and groping for a better answer. “Anything I can do-”

“You said you think I’m beautiful.” Yvette moved closer to me on the sofa. Her face was lit down one side by the flickering light of the chandelier above us. She was so attractive. “You’re a good-looking man, Lee. Take me to bed and show me what kind of man you are. Then I’ll think about talking to Patrick.”

“What?”

“Do I have to spell it out for you?” Yvette laughed. “Fuck me and if you’re good, I’ll tell Pat to never fuck your wife again.”

Shit.

Despite Charlotte’s warning, I had not anticipated *this*.

Chapter 11

“I -” I stuttered, “I can’t.”

“Of course you can,” Yvette said, laying a beautifully manicured hand on my thigh. “Let me take you to my bedroom. I assure you, you’ll enjoy it.”

“But-”

“But, what?” Yvette leaned in and planted a soft kiss on my lips then slid her hand up my thigh, finding and squeezing my erection through my jeans. “Oh,” she said. “Hello there.”

“I’m already in enough trouble with my w-wife,” I stammered. “And with Pat. I’ve already been roughed up once and-”

“I saw,” Yvette touched the bruised cut on my head then lightly kissed it. “I can make sure that doesn’t happen again too.”

“But I love Jessica.”

“I know,” Yvette sat back. “Then I guess I can’t help you.”

“No,” I said, panicking. This was my only way out of this hellish situation. “It’s just... will you at least let me think about it first? I didn’t come here prepared for you to ask me for sex. I haven’t showered or-”

“I don’t care about that.”

“But I do,” I replied, feeling my face flushing red. “This isn’t easy for me, Yvette. I find you beautiful and it’s tempting but I’m not the kind of

guy to just go around having sex with women. I'm not... confident like that, I suppose."

"Okay," she smiled. "So go home and think about it. Come back to me if and when you're ready and we'll take it from there."

Wow. Yvette was unlike any woman I'd ever met. I'd never come face to face with anyone like her and I simply didn't know how to handle it.

"One more thing," Yvette said as I nodded and stood up to leave. "I don't usually care who Patrick has sex with and he is pretty much as apathetic as to who I have in my bedroom. He doesn't have to know about you and me. I won't tell him if you don't. The same goes for your pretty little wife. Think about that."

"I will," I said, barely listening because I just wanted to get home.

"I'll see you soon, Lee."

Yvette's words echoed in my ears as I fled the house and got a taxi home. I couldn't even face Charlotte because my head was that messed up by the encounter. I just needed to get back to Jess.

* * *

"You're back," Jessica said as I finally walked through the front door. "I was beginning to worry."

"I'm sorry," I apologised. "I walked a bit further than intended but I'm back now."

"Do you feel any better?" she asked me as I took off my coat and shoes, relieved to be home. "I'm sorry too. It's just - all of this stuff going on - I need the odd day here and there where I can just pretend everything's

normal. I can't be thinking about Pat and Sharples and the debt all the time. I'll go crazy."

"Absolutely," I nodded. "I'm the same. It's just got on top of me today. Let's just sleep on it and talk when we're ready to talk."

And that's what we did. I brushed my teeth to try and mask the smell of wine on my breath and had a long glass of water and then we went to bed early.

Shortly afterwards, my phone beeped with a message and after checking that Jessica was asleep, I opened it to see a message from Charlotte.

You didn't say goodbye. Is everything okay?

I replied with, *Yes, sorry, I didn't know where you were so I got a taxi. Everything is fine. Your mother gave me some advice and things to think about. She said she'd help me if I need it.*

I couldn't tell Charlotte the truth, that her mother wanted me to have sex with her.

That's good. Call me when you want to talk about the other stuff I mentioned. Good luck with Jessica.

I put the phone away and lay down. This was all getting more complicated by the day.

Somehow, probably with some help from the Chablis, I managed to sleep and woke up surprisingly clear-headed the following morning. Jessica hadn't confessed last night but in a way, perhaps that was a blessing. As I'd explained to Yvette, I really did think that if I could just stop this now - nip it in the bud - I could move on from it. If I framed it in my mind as a blip in our relationship, three nights of Jessica making a mistake trying to fix something I'd broken, then maybe we could go back to being faithful to each other and make our marriage work, despite everything that had

happened. Ultimately, I loved Jess and I'd do anything; give anything; to make it work.

Which led me to my next move. I could sleep with Yvette and hope that she made good on the deal with her husband and my wife but that didn't fix the situation with Sharples and nor did it magically get me out of their debt. It might help with one thing but wouldn't that lead back to us having to find the money again eventually once the grace period that she'd earned had ended?

No, the answer was to be a man, to be brave, and talk to her about it face to face. This morning wasn't the right time. I wanted to have plenty of time to discuss things properly, even if it took all night. I did not doubt that there was going to be tears and raised voices when I told her that I knew what she'd done and the hour before I set off to work wasn't the best time for that.

So I went to work and through the day - a slow day - I had time to prepare and choose my words and how I was going to say them carefully and by the time I left, I had it all ready. I was braced for it. The talk was going to be a storm, but one I was prepared to ride to fix everything.

I walked through the door at the usual time - there was no Charlotte and no Vinny or Conroy waiting outside the salesroom for once - and I called out to Jessica as I took my coat and shoes off. There was no answer, so I walked through into the kitchen, expecting to find her chilling out in there or the living room with her headphones on - she did that sometimes - but there was no sign of her.

I headed upstairs but she wasn't up there either. She wasn't home. The front door had been locked just now but that wasn't unusual. Lately - since

the incident where Vinny followed me into the house, she'd taken to locking the door when she was alone.

I walked back downstairs and this time, I noticed a note stuck to the fridge.

I've been asked to go out with Pat for a couple of hours. I couldn't get hold of you so I said yes. There's plenty of food in the fridge but hopefully, I won't be too long. Love you xxx

No way. I pulled my phone from my pocket and noticed that it was out of battery. It can't have been that way for long though. I'd used it not long before I finished work.

Crap. This wasn't happening. I was totally geared up for the big talk with Jess tonight - that I knew she was having sex with Brewster and that I wanted it to stop. I'd rehearsed it on the way home and had got myself into the proper mindset to actually do it and now this.

I found a charger and plugged my phone in, then as soon as it came to life, I dialled Jessica's number.

Please answer. Please answer. Please answer.

"Hi," she said, answering after a couple of rings. My heart leapt at the sound of her voice. "Where are you? I've been trying to call."

"I just got home," I replied. "My phone died on the way. Where are you?"

"Did you not see my note?" Jess said, her voice sounding muffled for a moment so I couldn't hear whatever it was she said after that.

"Yes, you've gone out with Brewster," I acknowledged. "But listen, I really wanted to talk to you tonight about something important."

"I won't be too long," Jess said, slightly muffled again. Had she not heard what I just said? "I have to go. The meeting is starting now. Love

you.”

“Jessica. No. Stop,” I said. “I know you’re having sex with Brewster. Come home. I want to talk to you about it properly.” There was no answer. “Jessica?”

I looked down at my phone screen to see that the call had cut off. *Fuck*. I redialled but it went straight to answerphone.

Are you fucking kidding me?

“Jess, I got cut off. Call me as soon as you get this.”

I tried again and once more but both times it went straight to voicemail. She’d either run out of charge herself or was somewhere with no signal. Desperate to stop this, I did something reckless and called Pat himself but again, all I got was a voicemail.

I didn’t leave a message. I had Charlotte’s number. She might know what was going on.

“Hi,” Pat’s daughter picked up right away.

“Charlotte, where’s your father?” I asked, aware that I sounded panicked and tense.

“I don’t know,” she replied. “Is everything okay?”

“He’s taken Jessica out, without my permission and I don’t know where they are,” I rambled, “I tried ringing them but both of their phones aren’t connecting.”

“Wait one minute,” Charlotte said and then I heard voices as she talked to someone else but muffled like she’d put her hand over the microphone. “Right, okay. Yes, dad has gone out according to my brother. It was a last-minute thing. He’d had a brand new house built and is planning to let me and my brothers live there. He’s got a meeting with someone there, maybe

the builders or something, I don't know. Perhaps he's taken Jessica with him, to show her."

"Or taken her there to show off and then fuck her," I found myself saying out loud.

"I can't do anything," Charlotte said. "Just keep trying to call her. Don't call dad though. You don't want to get on his bad side. I thought my mother might have sorted it for you by now but obviously not."

"Okay, thanks anyway." I hung up and immediately tried Jessica again but her phone wasn't in service. I left her another message but knew it was in vain. I was too late. If only I'd noticed my phone battery was dead, I'd have put some charge into it in the office but I'd been distracted by figuring out what I was going to say tonight.

Right then a beep sounded on my phone and I saw a text come through from Jessica.

Sorry, I have to turn my phone off now for the meeting. I'm out in the countryside and there's very little reception here. You were breaking up. I'll come home as soon as I can though. Don't worry, Pat will look after me. I quite enjoy his company sometimes.

Had she sent this just now? Or had she sent it at the end of the last conversation and it had only just come through because of the poor reception where she was?

Then just like that, my desperation changed into something else. I became angry and I didn't really know why but I felt a sudden rage build up inside me. Perhaps not rage, but something more than just anger. Maybe it was anger mixed with regret. Or betrayal and shame. Or was it just frustration? Whatever it was, I raised my hand above my head to throw my phone at the wall and very nearly did it before stopping myself.

Instead, I threw my phone onto the couch and slammed my hand into the wall, two, three, four times until I stopped because I saw a spot of blood on the wall and realised that I'd taken the skin off my knuckles.

How dare she just head off out with Brewster? She'd tried to get hold of me, true, but without me saying okay, how dare she make the decision herself to go? This was the third time in a week. He was now spending more time and being more intimate with my wife than I was. I didn't care that I owed him money. He was utterly taking advantage of the situation and she was just as bad.

Pat will look after me.

How could she type that to me?

I quite enjoy his company sometimes.

I bet she does. I felt sick to my stomach.

She said she'd only be a couple of hours but I couldn't spend my evening like this. My guts felt like they'd been twisted into a knot. What were they doing right now? A mental image formed in my head of them alone in a new house, fucking against a wall or on the newly carpeted floor. Maybe it was newly furnished and he was christening the new bed with my wife.

My mind raced. This was too much.

I picked up my phone again, once I found it buried between the sofa cushions where I'd thrown it, and called Charlotte again.

"Charlotte, can I have your mother's number? I need to ask her something."

"Um," she paused. "Okay, sure."

I grabbed a pen and scribbled it down as she read it out, on the same note that Jess had left me and then I said 'thank you', hung up and

immediately dialled it.

“Hello? Who’s this?” Yvette answered in her throaty tone.

“It’s me, Lee,” I replied, my heart beating so loud in my chest that it sounded like thunder. “Are you free right now?”

“I might be,” she replied softly. “Why?”

“I want to take you up on your offer,” I said, unable to believe the words coming out of my mouth. “I’ll do whatever you want - I’ll fuck you, anything, whatever it takes for you to call your husband off my wife.”

“Then I suppose I should get changed into something more comfortable,” she replied. I could hear the smile in her voice. “I’ll see you shortly, Lee.”

“Excellent,” I replied, walking out and locking the door behind me.

Chapter 12

“I knew you’d come back,” Yvette said, greeting me as I walked into the conservatory. “Perhaps not this fast, but I knew.”

On the way here, I’d been worried that I’d bump into Charlotte and have to face an awkward conversation but fortunately, she wasn’t home, she was out with her brother. Yvette had arranged for me to be sent straight through the security gate and door and now here I was.

“He’s with her now,” I said with a shrug. “Did you know?”

“No, I didn’t know,” Yvette shook her head. “I know he was going over to the new house today, so it’s possible that he’s taken her there too... well, who knows why?”

“So what do I have to do to get you to stop this from happening again?” I said, trying to be patient and failing. “It’s three times he’s seen her in the past week. I can’t go on like this.”

“Let’s go upstairs and I’ll tell you.” Without waiting for a response, she breezed past me in her tweed skirt and grey blouse, into the hallway and up the spiralling staircase at the far end. As I followed her, breathing in the citrus scent of her perfume, I found my eyes drawn to her figure; her curvy hips and impressively narrow waist; her firm-looking ass; her womanly thighs and taut calves.

She led me into one of the bedrooms and told me to close the door behind me. When I turned back around, she was leaning against a grandiose king-size bed, her fingers already working on the upper buttons of her grey blouse.

“Take your clothes off,” she instructed. “Let me see your body.”

I removed my shoes and socks first, then nervously stripped out of my shirt. I was reasonably fit but not what you’d call muscular or even toned. I was average, I supposed.

“Not bad,” she said, appraising my chest, then undid and removed her own top, to reveal a lacy white bra through which I could already see the small dark circles of her nipples. “Keep going. Show me what you’ve got in your pants.”

Was I really doing this? I realised there was no way out. I’d come too far now.

I dropped my trousers and pants and kicked them away, standing before her totally naked and she slid down her skirt to reveal a lacy pair of white panties through which I could see the shape of a dark landing strip.

Yvette’s eyes drifted down my torso to my groin, looking at my cock which was already fully hard, standing out in front of me like a flagpole from the side of a building. I was only modestly endowed but Jessica had never complained about it, so I was okay with my size.

“Come here and take off my bra and panties,” she ordered in a firm voice.

I walked over, breathing rapidly and feeling a bead of sweat growing on my brow. Then I slipped the straps of the fancy bra from her shoulders and she turned so I could undo the clasp. The bra fell away and when she turned

back around, I couldn't help but stare at her large and perfectly shaped breasts.

"You like?" she whispered softly in my ear and then she lay back on the bed and stretched her arms over her head, waiting for me to join her. I did and slid down her panties next when she asked me to, revealing a thin landing strip of dark hair on her pubic mound.

"The blonde hair is out of a bottle," she said as she opened her thighs, letting me see between. "I hope you're not disappointed."

"Not at all," I said, then moaned as she grabbed my cock, pulling me towards her and then taking me in her mouth. She took my length fully into her mouth, holding it there while curving her tongue around my shaft then she eased me away after a few minutes.

"Fuck me," she said, spreading her legs wide.

I'd gone from doing this reluctantly to eagerly. I moved quickly, pointing the head of my cock at her pink folds and shoved forward. It went inside her easily. She wasn't as tight as Jessica but it felt good and I looked down as I began to fuck her, unable to believe I was having sex with an older but still beautiful, glamorous woman like this.

She slid her thighs upwards, wrapping them around my back along with her arms and pulled me down to kiss her, which I did, sliding my tongue into her mouth where it met hers.

I was fucking Pat Brewster's wife. Just like he'd fucked mine. That was why I was here.

I began to pound my cock into her hard, trying to make her moan but she just kept kissing me so eventually, I moved, taking charge and rolling her onto her front, then pulling her ass up to fuck her from behind.

I rammed my cock into her hard and fast - as hard and fast as I could - then grabbed her hair gently, easing her head back and thrusting as deeply into her as I could go. If I was going to fuck Pat Brewster's wife, I was going to do it properly.

"Okay, stop," Yvette said suddenly, then reached back and pushed me away. "I've let you have your fun."

What?

"I'm doing what you asked," I replied, confused and out of breath. "You wanted me to fuck you."

"What you're doing is trying to get revenge on my husband," Yvette replied, sitting on the bed and staring at me with her arms wrapped around her knees. "What were you trying to do? Fuck me roughly? Leave me a quivering mess by fucking me better than my husband can?"

"I'm sorry," I apologised. "It's not that at all. I was just doing it as I do it to my wife."

"Don't lie," Yvette rolled her eyes. "Do you really think you're going to fuck me senseless with that?" She pointed down at my erection.

"What?"

"I've had a lot of cock," Yvette said matter-of-factly. "White, black, thick, thin, big, average, small. I love sex and I've done it a lot. In fact, I've done it all. You're not going to come in here and give me *the time of my life*, Lee. I like lovers with either a decent-sized dick or failing that, some skill and finesse and you're clearly lacking in both departments."

Ouch. What was this? Some sort of weird fetish of hers or was she being genuinely horrible to me?

"Oh, I'm sorry," Yvette stuck out her bottom lip. "Did I hurt your feelings? Toughen up, Lee. Lick my pussy. Let's see if you can satisfy me

that way.”

I was still stung by what she'd said but I did it. I wasn't going to walk out of here without getting her to agree to sorting her husband out and making him back off from my wife.

I laid on the bed between her legs and worked my tongue between her folds, giving her the best pussy licking I could, spending time all around her pussy before focusing on her swollen clit, sucking it into my mouth and then flicking it with the tip of my tongue for a while before circling it instead as she started to respond, breathing heavier and heavier.

“That's better,” she moaned, her hands going to her breasts so she could play with her nipples while I kept licking her. After a short while, she finally came, her hips bucking upwards and thrusting herself against my face until finally sagging back down onto the bed.

“At least you're adequate at something,” she laughed, pulling herself up into a sitting position again. “Looking at your stiff little dicky, I suppose you need to cum too?”

“Yes. Then are we done?” I said, the term ‘little dicky’ annoying me.

“Oh, stop being so grumpy.” Yvette relaxed back against the puffy luxurious pillows behind her. “I'm only playing with you. This is fun. Tell me, aren't you having fun?”

As she said that, she reached down and stuck two fingers inside herself, beginning to work them in and out.

“Do you like watching me do this?”

“Yes,” I replied, unable to deny that the sight was turning me on.

“Good. Now, indulge me, Lee,” she said softly as she finger-fucked herself. “If you want me to talk to Patrick for you.”

“How?” I said. My dick was so hard it was beginning to hurt.

“Watch me cum,” she smiled. “Don’t take your eyes off me. Then I’ll let you cum.”

She stuck another finger inside, then another until her wrist bent forward and her whole hand disappeared into her pussy. I watched her slowly fist herself, her hips gyrating on her hand. I couldn’t help but reach down and grab my dick, slowly stroking myself while watching.

“That’s it,” she said, noticing the movement. “Play with your little cock. I want to see it shoot your lovely cum out.”

So she wasn’t going to make me cum. I had to do it myself. Oh well, whatever. I had to cum.

“Put it closer,” she said, still working her fist into her pink hole. “I want you to cum all over my hand and my kitty while you watch me orgasm.”

Fuck. This was so fucking hot. I couldn’t remember being this horny in a long time and it showed because right as Yvette orgasmed just a few seconds later, her backside lifting from the bed, I came too.

Her thighs shuddered and she pulled her hand out as my first streak of cum landed on it, then put two fingers on her clit and rubbed it frantically, extending her orgasm.

“Shove it in me,” she gasped. “Before you go soft.”

Another jet of spunk hit her pussy lips as I shuffled forward, pushing my cock inside her and then I felt another smaller spurt as I thrust it forward, going into her pussy.

“That’s it,” she moaned. “I want it inside me.”

My legs buckled and we sagged to the bed together so that I was lying on top of her, the pair of us breathing heavily and covered in sweat. Our eyes met, then closed as we kissed again, her arms wrapping around my

back until eventually my cock slipped out of her, totally spent and she eased me from on top of her.

“Adequate,” she grinned. “You can get dressed now.”

I didn’t say anything. Now that my anger had disappeared along with my lust, I felt suddenly regretful and also shocked that I’d even gone through with this. I just put my clothes back on and then stood there beneath her gaze, waiting for her to speak. I simply didn’t know what to say.

“I know how you’re feeling right now,” the blonde-haired woman said, lying on the bed completely unfazed by her nakedness. “You’re thinking ‘what the hell have I done’, aren’t you? Don’t worry, Lee. I won’t tell Patrick or Jessica. This is our little secret and I will try to sort things out for you, I promise. A deal is a deal.”

That was a relief to hear. “Thank you,” I said when I finally found my voice.

“You came here because you discovered that they were out having sex somewhere,” Yvette’s eyes seemed to bore into mine. “You came to get one over on Patrick and get your own back by fucking his wife and you’ve done it. Plus, you’re now even with Jessica too. Except of course, that you’re not, because she’s also had sex with Johnny Sharples.”

She knew about Sharples. I steadied myself at the revelation but didn’t say anything. I just wanted to go home now, so I let her finish saying what she was going to say and then hopefully she’d send me away.

“So you know about Sharples too,” Yvette’s eyebrows raised slightly. “Okay, well you can’t have sex with his wife. She’s dead,” Yvette mused, stroking her blonde hair with a long-fingered hand. “How are you going to get even with him?”

“I don’t know yet,” I shrugged. “I’m just trying to deal with one thing at a time.”

“I see,” Yvette nodded thoughtfully. “Don’t you want to know how I know about Johnny and your wife?”

“I know him and Pat talk,” I replied coolly. “I overheard him and Jessica talking. As I said before, I’m not stupid. Jessica might think I am, but I’m not. I’ll find a way to get rid of Sharples.”

“Yes, Johnny told Patrick that he’d also fucked your wife,” Yvette explained. “And Patrick told me. He finds it amusing that Johnny is trying to one-up him. That’s probably why he’s taken your wife out today. It’ll probably become some sort of competition now as to who can fuck her the most or the best.”

“What?” I said, my stomach clenching at the thought of them all talking about my wife like she was a piece of meat.

“Oh, don’t worry,” Yvette said with a warm smile. “A deal is a deal. Now you’re mine, I’ll sort it all out for you. You can go now.”

She stood up and walked over to a small door on the side wall which when she opened it, I saw led to an en-suite bathroom. She waited at the door, still standing there brazenly naked until I left, walking down the stairs and out of the house with my head spinning like a spinning top.

I’d just cheated on Jessica. It might make us even - almost - but it still wasn’t right. Even so, everything had changed now.

As I walked down the street, away from the house, I got my phone out of my pocket and saw a missed call from Jessica, followed by a text message to say she was on her way back. Did I still have the conversation with her that I’d been planning or did I let Yvette try to work her magic and fix things for me?

This was it. Decision time.

I went home.

Chapter 13

“I’ve only just got back myself,” Jessica said when I walked through the door. “Where have you been? Anywhere nice?”

“When I got home and found you’d gone out, I decided to go over to Greg’s for a couple of hours,” I said, unprepared for her being home before me. I thought I might make it in time.

“Well, I’m glad you’re back because I’ve got some good news,” she smiled, her bright red lips curving into a cute bow. “But first you need to earn it by licking my pussy.”

She looked stunning. Her hair was loose and straightened, flowing red down her neck and over her collarbones to rest on her pale cleavage which was on show over a black deep V-necked top. A short denim skirt and black stockings completed the slutty look.

Right. This is it.

I rehearsed how this was going to go in my head one more time as I let her lead me into the front room, where she stripped off her top and wriggled out of the skirt to reveal - quite shockingly - that she wasn’t wearing either a bra or panties.

“Where’s your underwear?” I said, all thoughts gone from my mind for a moment. I’d been about to blurt it all out - that I knew she’d been having

sex with Brewster, but seeing her like this, naked apart from just a pair of sheer black stockings made my voice catch in my throat.

Her tits looked so firm and round, her small pink nipples were erect and her pussy was neatly trimmed into the tidiest of reddish rectangles above her slit which was completely shaved.

“I already took it off,” she said. “I thought it’d turn you on.”

She was drunk. I hadn’t noticed it until now, but as she’d spoken I’d picked up that her voice was slightly slurred and there was a definite glaze to her eyes and a slight wobble to her stance that gave it away.

“We need to talk,” I sighed, realising that she’d probably gone out underwear-less for Brewster’s benefit. “Put your clothes on and sit down.”

My hard cock didn’t want her to get dressed but I knew I had to. The time had come. There wasn’t any more evading the issue. I needed to do this.

“Please, Lee,” Jessica said, using her sexiest tone of voice, “I’m really horny and I need you to do your thing and make me cum. I promise the good news will be worth it.”

“No,” I replied, shaking my head. “I’m being serious, Jessica. Please get dressed and let’s talk.”

“Come here,” she said, walking over to me and taking me by the hand to lead me over to the sofa. “Lie down.”

“Aren’t you listening to me?” I said, refusing to sit down as she patted the cushion next to her. “I’m not licking your pussy when I know that Brewster’s probably just fucked you.”

“Come on,” she said, her pale blue glazed eyes twinkling. Then she stopped dead as what I’d just said registered. “What?”

“You’ve been fucking Pat Brewster,” I shrugged, finally sitting down. “I know, Jessica.”

Her mouth opened but no words came out. She just stared at me and then I saw her jaw clench as she finally spoke. “I had to. It was the only way.”

“There had to be other ways, Jess,” I shook my head. “There are always other ways.”

“He said he was going to have me one way or another,” she said softly. “He said he wanted me the minute he saw me. We could do it the easy way or the hard way. The hard way also involved you probably ending up in the hospital.”

“And Johnny Sharples?” I couldn’t look at her so I examined my feet as I spoke. “Did he threaten you too or did you just get a taste for cheating on me?”

“You don’t actually *know* anything,” she pointed out. “Who told you? Was it Vinny?”

“Nobody told me,” I lied. “I’m not stupid, Jess. You threw your panties on the floor the other night and when I picked them up, they were full of sperm. You smelled like sex. You’ve come home today without your underwear. Do you take me for a complete idiot?”

The situation was surreal, Jessica was still naked in our front room while we were having a conversation about her fucking other guys. Not only that, but I couldn’t even be as angry with her as I wanted to be because just an hour ago, I’d cheated on her with Yvette which made me a hypocrite, something I wasn’t at ease with.

“I know you’re not an idiot,” Jess replied after a moment’s thought. “I always knew you’d find out eventually, so I was trying to get as much out

of Pat as I could. I guess we do - absolutely - need to talk, but please, I know this sounds weird, but just lick my pussy and then I'll take a shower. I'll get dressed. We can sit down and talk. If you want to leave me, whatever, but just lick me for a minute."

"What?" I squinted at her. "Are you for real? Why are you being so fucking weird? Do you really expect me to go down on you now that I know Brewster's been in you, probably shot his load inside you?"

"Pat is going to not only defer your payments for another week but write a week's worth off," Jess said, her voice sounding slightly panicked for some reason. "But you have to lick my pussy again."

I raised an eyebrow. This was the weirdest behaviour I'd ever seen from my wife. "So you're saying, if I go down on you, you'll tell Brewster to write some of our debt off."

Jessica closed her eyes. "Shit. I didn't want to tell you this, but I guess I have to. I presume you don't want to know all the dirty details, but when we first slept together, I was angry at you afterwards; angry that you'd forced me into this. Given me no choice. So when I came home, I made you lick my pussy to get back at you. Making you lick Pat's sperm out of me felt kind of... like a payback. Then I told him when I saw him at the weekend and he got a kick out of it too. He wanted me to do it again when I went home that night, so I did."

"That's disgusting," I said, horrified at what I was hearing.

"Then today, he made me this offer - to write off a week's payments altogether - but only if I did it again and sent him a photograph to prove it."

I felt nauseous but let her keep talking.

"Lee, I know that within a couple more times of doing this, I can talk him into writing the entire debt off. I know I can. I've got him wrapped

around my little finger.”

“And then what?” I asked her. “Once he’s said we’re debt-free, you’ll just break it off and think he’ll be okay with that? Or will he just go back to wanting his money again? Are you going to get him to put it in writing? Do you think that’s how Pat Brewster works?”

“I don’t know,” Jess shrugged. “I’m trying to get you out of the shit here, Lee. Have you forgotten this is all your fucking fault? You blew all of our money, all of *my* money that wasn’t even yours to spend. You got us in this trouble with Brewster, not me. And yet, I’m the one having to deal with it all.”

“I’ll find a way-” I started to say but Jess stood up, leaving over me and pointing a finger aggressively in my face.

“No, you won’t,” she yelled at me. “You’ve had plenty of time to sort this shit out and you haven’t. You can’t. Because you’re way over your head. I should have just left you and taken you to court for the money you owe me. But I didn’t. I thought there was a way I could fix things. I’ve tried to fix things. Perhaps I just let you get your legs broken and whatever else Brewster and Sharples want to do to you. Perhaps I should just walk away.”

“This is my mess,” I said, leaning away from the finger she was still wagging at me. “I’ll clean it up.”

“The only thing you’re capable of cleaning up is my pussy. Now lie the fuck down.”

I looked up at her in shock. I’d never heard her use that tone before.

“Lie down and lick Pat’s cum out of me,” Jessica’s face was like stone. “Let me take the photo and send it to him or I am walking out of your life and you’ll never see me again.”

“I’m not doing that,” I refused, caught totally off-guard by her being like this.

“In fact, I won’t be the one walking out,” she leaned in closer. “You will be. This house is rented in my name. You can go. And don’t think you’re taking a thing. I’m keeping everything as part payment on what you owe me. And don’t think I won’t be going to the police and doing everything I can to get every penny I can out of you. I mean it, Lee.”

Fuck. She was right; the house was in her name. She’d got me.

“Shower first,” I said, thinking quickly. “Wash your pussy then I’ll do it. Brewster won’t know the difference.”

“You’ve already eaten his cum twice,” Jessica pointed out. “Just do it.”

“Why?” I asked. “Because you want me to? Is this still part of your little revenge kick?”

“Do it and we can talk about where we go from here,” she said. “Last chance. If you want there to be anything left of our marriage - if you want us to have any chance of sorting all of this out - then lie down.”

I simply stared at her, wondering what the hell to do or say, still off-balance at how aggressive she was being.

“Make your choice,” she warned. “Either lie down or walk out of the door and don’t come back.”

“I don’t want to do either,” I said but she wasn’t going to let me talk further. She put a hand on my chest and pushed me backwards onto the sofa. I had the chance to resist but that meant walking out. Should I walk out? Did I no longer love her or want her? I needed time to think this over but Jess wasn’t about to give me any more time. She pushed me onto my back and then swung a leg over, straddling me and moving upwards so her pussy was directly over my face.

“Lick it,” she said in a commanding tone, again unlike anything I’d heard from her in all the time we’d been together.

“I can’t.”

She lowered herself then reached down, opening herself up with her fingers and ground her wet pussy against my mouth. “Lick it. It’s just cum.”

I closed my eyes and extended my tongue, immediately tasting the salty tang of Brewster’s sperm. I couldn’t believe I was doing this. I felt sick to my stomach.

“That’s it,” she said softly from above me. “Lick it all out. That’s a good boy.”

She leaned forward and I felt her hands unbuckling my trousers and pulling them down as I kept reluctantly lapping at her pussy.

“It can’t be that bad,” she commented. “You’re hard.”

Then she leaned further forward and took my cock in her mouth, beginning to suck it slowly. The angle to her pussy was changed and I stopped licking, suddenly worried that she’d smell or taste Yvette’s pussy on me but she didn’t.

“Don’t stop,” she berated me after a moment. “Lick my pussy or I won’t suck your cock.”

What the fuck was wrong with me? I had no idea but I wanted to cum. Her mouth felt so good around my dick that I put my tongue back into her, licking up and down and circling her clit in between.

Then I came. It only took a couple of minutes. I was suddenly there - right on the edge - no slow build-up. My dick exploded in her mouth and she held it there until I’d finished, swallowing every drop, then she returned to sitting upright and I saw that she had her phone in her hand. I closed my

eyes as she shuffled her pussy back onto my mouth and then I heard the click of the photo being taken.

“Now make me cum,” she said after she’d sent it to Brewster, grinding herself onto my tongue and beginning to play with her breasts.

There was more cum this time. I felt some of it ooze from her and into my mouth as she repositioned herself over me to take the picture and it made me choke slightly in disgust. When she orgasmed a couple of minutes later, I felt a huge wave of relief flood through me and as soon as she moved, I got up and rushed upstairs to the bathroom to wash my face and rinsed my mouth with water.

“How much of your cum have I swallowed over the years?” she said from behind me and I turned to see her standing in the bathroom doorway, arms folded beneath her breasts. “Have I ever once complained or had to wash my mouth out?”

As she shook her head in disappointment and walked away, I looked into the bathroom mirror at myself, wondering how it had all come to this. In a matter of months, we’d gone from being a happily married couple, planning on buying a house and starting a family to being debt-ridden to the wrong sort of people and cheating on each other.

And me? I’d just eaten another man’s spunk from my wife’s pussy, a thought that caused my stomach to turn over and me to feel another wave of nausea. I had to look away. I couldn’t look at myself. How could I ever live with myself after this, whether I walked away from Jessica or not?

I had to decide what to do.

Chapter 14

“**H**ave you spoken to Jessica today?” Greg asked me.

It was three days since the evening when everything had gone bad. Jess and I had spoken about what had happened but it had been too difficult for me and I asked her to give me some time and space to think.

She wanted to talk about it - about what she'd done and why - but I couldn't. She wanted to tell me every minute detail of what she'd done with Brewster and Sharples but I didn't want to hear it. As she'd started to tell me, I'd found myself putting my fingers in my ears like a defiant teenager and then I'd gotten up and walked out of the room.

Jessica tried to talk me around. She tried to explain. She pleaded with me to listen and hear her side of the story but I just wasn't ready. She said she loved me and I told her that I knew - and that I loved her too, still, despite what she'd done - but I just couldn't face the truth of what had happened and *was happening* right now.

She'd suggested I talk to someone, someone else, someone that wasn't her. Perhaps even stay in a hotel for a few days to give my head some time to clear. I didn't need a hotel though. There wasn't any point in wasting money on hotels when I had Greg. He could be that *someone*.

However, I didn't tell him everything or even very much. I just told him that Jessica and I had fallen out and we needed a few days apart to work

stuff out. He was - as always - gracious and generous and let me stay for a couple of nights, but every day he encouraged me to either talk to him or talk to my wife. I couldn't do either. Something inside me felt like it had died and I didn't know what to do about it. Without Jessica, I had nothing. No house, no money because I owed it all to Brewster and Sharples. I was screwed and couldn't see a way out besides just getting on a bus and leaving town to start somewhere new.

"I'm going to talk to her," I told my best friend as I got ready to leave for work. "Tonight. I'll make the call."

I probably wouldn't and I knew that but I said it anyway to appease him.

"Okay, just remember, you can't stay here forever." Greg's face was serious as she watched me walk out of the front door. "You've got to face your problems and deal with them sooner rather than later."

He was right. What he didn't know is that my problems were coming to me. As I walked up to the salesroom front entrance, I felt a hand on my shoulder and when I turned around, Yvette was standing there looking glamorous as always in a black fur coat and short skirt.

"You haven't answered my texts," she said coolly, looking me up and down. "What's going on, Lee?"

"I'm sorry," I said, casting a look over my shoulder to check that no one was watching from within the salesroom. "I've got a lot going on right now and-"

"You've walked out on your wife," Yvette nodded, taking a pull from the lit cigarette in her hand. "And you're staying with your friend, Greg. I know. That shouldn't stop you from answering my texts."

“You want me to come over to see you, but I can’t,” I explained. “My head’s fucked, Yvette. I can’t think straight. Everything is messed up.”

“I just wanted to talk to you,” she replied. “I’m not so cold-hearted that I’d expect you to have sex with me while you’ve got all of this going on. I just thought you could come over and talk.”

“I have to go to work. I’m late,” I apologised. “I’ll text you later, I promise.”

“No, you won’t,” Yvette shook her head. “Let me show you something.”

She reached into her fur coat pocket and drew out her phone, then brought up a video on the screen. My eyes opened when I realised what it was.

“You recorded us having sex?” I gasped.

“Yes,” Yvette smiled. “I have a camera set up in the bedroom. I like making naughty films. It turns me on to watch them back later. Most of my lovers like it too.”

“Why are you showing me?” I asked, giving my workplace another glance over my shoulder, hoping my boss didn’t come out, wanting to know who Yvette was.

“This is what’s going to happen,” Yvette’s face smoothed out, her words taking on a business-like tone. “If you don’t want me to show this video to both Patrick and your wife, you’re going to go home tonight and talk to her.”

“I told you, my head is a total mess,” I said. “My entire life is a mess. I’m not ready-”

“It’s not up for discussion,” Yvette snapped at me. “Jessica isn’t answering Pat’s calls or texts so he wants his money. If you don’t want

something bad to happen to her, you or even your friend, Greg, then you need to listen to me.”

Fuck.

“You do what I tell you, Lee. You pick up your stuff from your friend’s house and you go home. Tonight. Then you talk to Jessica and sort your shit out if you can. Tell her to talk to Pat. A simple text back to apologise for not replying will be enough for now.”

“And then what?” I said. “What if I can *sort out our shit*? What if I don’t want to? What if she doesn’t want to text Pat?”

“Just do it,” Yvette stubbed out the cigarette on the low wall that surrounded the salesroom. “Then wait for a call or text from me tonight to let you know what’s going on.”

“Fine.” I turned and stormed towards the office. I hated this; I hated being told what to do.

“I’m trying to help you, Lee,” Yvette’s voice called out after me and I knew she was telling the truth but I just wanted to get into work and try to sell some cars to take my mind off everything for a while.

That evening, I picked up the few belongings I’d brought with me and Greg gave me a ride home, wishing me good luck as I got out of the car.

“I hope you sort things out,” he said before winding the window up and driving away.

All I’d done is to text Jessica and ask if I could come home tonight, just to talk and she’d said ‘yes’ and that she was happy that I was coming. She said she had a lot to say too and hoped that I was ready to talk because she’d been really unhappy without me.

“Jessica?” I said, pushing the front door open and before I could even take a step inside, she appeared out of nowhere and threw her arms around

me.

“I’ve missed you so much,” she sobbed and when she finally pulled her face away from my chest, I saw tears leaking from her eyes, trailing streaks of mascara down her cheeks.

“Don’t cry,” I said softly, wiping the tears away with my hand while ushering her into the house and closing the door behind me. She might have cheated on me and done the weird stuff that she’d done but the sight of her so visibly upset still hurt me deeply in my heart. I still loved her. I knew that much. Just the feeling of her in my arms and the familiar smell of her red hair when she’d buried her head into my chest instantly made something inside me come to life.

“Does that-” she pointed to the bag of clothes I’d brought with me, “mean that you’re staying?”

“It means I’m back for the weekend so we can talk,” I nodded. It was Friday, so today was a good day to do this, giving us all of Saturday and Sunday together if we wanted it.

“Good,” she smiled, rubbing at her still-damp eyes. “Why don’t you have a shower and I’ll make us some food, then we can talk?”

So that’s what we did. I had a hot shower to freshen up and relax and she made us dinner and as we sat down around the kitchen to eat, she was the first to say something.

“I don’t want to lose you,” she said carefully. “I don’t want my marriage to end like this. But there are some things I should tell you if we’re going to talk properly.”

“Okay,” I replied, nervous at what she was going to say. “You go first.”

“I thought I could talk Pat around,” she started. “I thought I could use the fact that I knew his daughter at school and the fact that I’m a... not

unattractive woman, to appeal to his better nature. After what happened - when you got hurt - I knew I had to do something. Somehow I knew you'd have done everything you possibly could but that it wasn't enough."

"That's probably right," I conceded.

"I was always going to flirt with him," Jess continued. "That was part of the plan, to use my female charms, but I never intended to have sex with him. That wasn't in my mind at all. But he asked me how desperate I was to sort this situation out and when I replied 'very', he very bluntly - and rather rudely - asked me to suck his cock to prove it."

"I don't need to hear this," I reminded her, not wanting the mental pictures in my mind of her cheating on me.

"But I need to tell you," Jess said, reaching over the table to take my hand. "I need to. Do you understand? I don't want there to be any secrets between us ever again."

But I had a secret. A big one. Yvette.

Jessica took my silence as an okay to carry on. "Lee, I don't know what happened next. Something inside me just gave. I don't know how else to explain it. I was angry at you for everything; for losing our savings; for nearly getting your head smashed in; for screwing everything up that we'd worked so hard for."

"So you did it," I nodded, not needing any further explanation. "Then took it out on me even further by asking me to lick your pussy when you came home."

Jessica nodded but backtracked a little. "I was just going to give him a blowjob at first but as I was doing it, he said that if I let him fuck me, he'd give us a week's grace on the next payment. Again, something snapped. I said 'yes' not just for the deal but because I was mad at you."

“Okay,” I nodded, not knowing what else to say. I realised it was probably best to just let her get everything off of her chest, even if it was things I didn’t want to hear. It didn’t change anything. What had happened had happened and there was no changing it.

Jessica obviously expected more from me. She sat and waited but when she realised that I wasn’t going to reply further than ‘okay’, she pressed on.

“This all happened in the back of his car after the meeting,” she explained. “When he’d finished, he said we could make this a regular thing and I agreed but again, it wasn’t for the deal. Or even because I was mad at you. I enjoyed it, Lee. I enjoyed the sex. I’m sorry.”

I gazed at her, feeling another wave of numbness wash over me. *She enjoyed it?*

“And I enjoyed making you lick Pat’s cum out of my pussy,” she confessed. “When he asked to see me again, I was actually looking forward to it. Having sex with Pat made me feel bad. It made me feel cheap and slutty and... like a whore, if I’m honest, and I don’t know why but that turned me on. So I did it again, this time at his house. Then a third time at a new house that he’s just had built.”

“So he’s better than me in bed?” I concluded, numbly absorbing this new blow.

“For an older guy, he’s strong,” she admitted, her cheeks flushing bright red.

“And his dick? Is he bigger than me?”

Jessica blinked several times at the question but she nodded.

“And what about Sharples?” I asked. “Was that to get back at me too?”

“I haven’t fucked Johnny,” she said softly. “That’s the other thing I need to explain.”

“You might as well,” I sighed, accepting the fact that she was going to tell me whether I wanted to hear it or not.

“Patrick is kinky in that he and his wife have lovers,” she explained as if I didn’t already know. “They have an open relationship, each respecting the other’s wishes and agreeing to everything they do and it works for them. Johnny is kinky but in a different way.”

“His wife died,” I said, wondering if Jessica knew.

“I know,” she nodded, “And he’s never slept with a woman since. But he has needs, he explained to me. Johnny’s thing is that he likes to watch.”

“He likes to watch?” I frowned, not understanding.

“He made me masturbate in front of him, while he played with himself,” Jess said, taking a moment to gather herself. “Then he asked me to have sex with Jack.”

“Jack?”

“Conroy. His bodyguard.”

Chapter 15

Jessica put her hands over her face and I could tell she felt ashamed of herself, which made me want to hold her in my arms and tell her it was okay but I couldn't - because it wasn't. She'd fucked Conroy.

"Again, I did it and I don't know why," she said from behind her hands. "I was horny. Jack is a big guy and very good-looking. I was still mad at you because I'd found out you didn't just owe Pat but you also owed Johnny and... I don't know. I did it. I fucked him and Johnny watched and then at the end, I let him cum in my mouth."

"Johnny?" I said, remembering how her mouth had tasted that night when we kissed.

"And Conroy. Both of them," she admitted. "Since then, they've both been trying to get hold of me. They both want me to do it again but I haven't, I promise. I haven't even spoken to them or returned their texts."

"Right," I said, taking in all of the new information and swallowing the hurt of it down.

Jessica waved her hands at me as if surrendering. "I admit, I enjoyed it. All of it. I don't know what that makes me in your eyes - a slut, probably - but I just needed to say it to you so if we do split up, I won't feel like I lied to you. In the end, I did the right thing and told you everything."

“And that’s it? Is there anything else that you haven’t told me, or is that it?”

“Yes, that’s it. I swear to God.”

I sat with her in silence for a moment.

“Please, say something,” she said, reaching out and taking my hands in hers.

“I have something to tell you too,” I said, making a decision. She clearly felt bad and had done the brave thing and told me. The least I could do was the same.

“Just say it,” she said, a sadness in those light-blue eyes. “You’re leaving.”

“I slept with someone too,” I said, somehow managing to keep eye contact with her. I saw her flinch and then swallow, as though she was also holding back the pain.

“Who?” she said in a small voice.

“Yvette Brewster,” I admitted. “I slept with Pat’s wife.”

“Wow,” wasn’t the first word I expected to come from Jessica’s mouth but it was. “I should be angry but I can’t even say that I am.”

“It was the same day you met Pat the last time,” I admitted, surprised at her reaction - or lack of it.

“You knew about Pat so you slept with his wife as revenge.” Jessica pushed a strand of red hair out of her face and gazed at me as though seeing someone new. “After what I’ve done, I can’t be upset with you, even though I should be.”

“It’s not quite like that,” I replied. “I went to her for help. I thought she might be able to make Pat stop sleeping with you but kind of seduced me in return.”

Jess arched an eyebrow and leaned over the table as if to say something but stopped and suddenly looked forlorn. “She’s very beautiful, isn’t she? Is she better in bed than me?”

Oh, how the tables have turned, I thought but I wasn’t cruel or tactless like Jessica had been with me.

“No,” I said and it was the truth. “She’s beautiful but she’s not as beautiful or as good in bed as you are. I’m not just saying that, she’s not. She’s kind of...” I groped for the right word, “Fake. I don’t know what it is, but there’s something fake about her. If I had the choice of you or her, I’d choose you one million times out of a million.”

Jessica smiled at me, another tear leaking from the corner of her eye. “Lee, why aren’t you angry at me. You should be angry. You should be packing your things right now and walking out of the door. I don’t understand what’s going on or why you’re here. I expected that once I told you what I had to say that would be it. The final nail in the coffin. I hoped that you wouldn’t, but I didn’t dare believe it.”

“I don’t know myself if I’m honest,” I shrugged and I didn’t. “All I know is that I still have feelings for you. I still love you. I knew that the moment I walked in and saw you. I just don’t know what we do from here.”

“Me neither,” Jessica said, sitting up straight and staring into my eyes deliberately. “But I love you too, Lee. I know I said what I said, that I enjoyed the sex with Pat and Jack but that doesn’t mean that I don’t like sex with you too. It doesn’t mean that I don’t love you. I do. I always have. It’s the reason I tried to save things, as fucked up as it seems.”

“Okay,” I found myself saying for what felt like the hundredth time. I was working through things in my head slowly, trying to piece together

what was right emotionally and right logically. I found a question I needed answering, as painful as it might be to hear. “Do you want to do it again?”

“Do what again?” Jessica asked, holding her gaze away from me slightly as if uncertain what I meant.

“You’ve had a taste of sex with other men,” I continued, trying to figure out what I needed to know for myself as I went along. “And you enjoyed it. Is that the end of it or do you think this is what you need, moving forward?”

“It was exciting,” Jessica replied after a moment. “We’ve been together for a long time, so sex with someone new is going to be exciting. Anyone who says otherwise is lying. I’m sure sex with Yvette was exciting for you.”

“I guess,” I nodded, “But if we stayed together, would you find yourself being tempted into doing it again?”

“Can I be faithful to you?” she countered. “Can you be faithful to me?”

“Easily,” I replied confidently. “Yes. The Yvette thing just kind of happened. She didn’t give me much choice, to tell you the truth.”

“It started off like that with me,” Jess nodded understandingly. “But if I’m honest, I did it because I wanted to and that surprised me. I didn’t know I had it in me to do something like that.”

“So you want to do it again?”

“Maybe we have to,” Jessica said, looking away. “If you want to ever get out of debt with Pat, at least. I know you don’t want me to, but I know I can get Sharples to write all of the debt off. I know that for sure, he’s such a horny and kinky man, I know I can think of ways to sort him out. As for Pat, I’m 99% sure if I stick around and do what he wants, he’ll eventually forget what you owe him. As for what happens in the long term, I don’t know. You’re right. Maybe I’ll be stuck with him forever but I don’t think so.”

“Perhaps we should just pack our things in a suitcase and run away,” I laughed ironically.

“You and me,” Jessica shook her head, “we don’t run away from anything or anyone.”

“You didn’t answer the question,” I smiled at her sentiment but needed an answer. “Do you actually *want* to sleep with Pat again?”

“I don’t *want* to,” she said quickly - a little too quickly, so I knew she was lying - “But I will if you think I should. If there’s no other way.”

“And Sharples?”

“The same.”

We sat in silence again for a little while. I was thinking everything over, turning over all of the facts in my mind and working through my feelings. I could tell by looking at my wife that she was doing the same. We cleaned away the dinner pots and washed up together, then when we sat down in the living room, I was just about to say something when Jessica moved from where she was sitting to sit right next to me.

“I’ll do anything to make us work,” she said, “But if you decide you don’t want to, I understand.”

“We don’t have to make a decision straight away,” I replied. “Let’s just see how things work out. People often rush into big decisions and I don’t know why. I’m here. You’re here. We can talk, work things out slowly.”

“I’d like that,” she smiled with her eyes and mouth this time, a look of genuine happiness.

“But first,” I said, bringing up what I was going to say when we first sat down. “You do need to text Brewster back. Probably Sharples too. I spoke to Yvette earlier - she was just checking how I was because she’d heard I

moved out - and she said that Pat is getting pissed off that you're not replying."

"Shit," she cursed. "Okay. I'll text them now."

The way she looked at me then was a question and I knew it.

"So we don't have to decide about *us* straight away," I went back to what I was saying. "But I guess you *do* have to make a decision about Brewster and Sharples."

"I don't know." Jessica's face suddenly screwed up as though she was about to burst into tears and I quickly put an arm around her. "I don't know what to do."

"This is why I was asking if you *wanted* to do it or not," I explained. "If you do, it's okay. Do it. You've done it three times with Pat already. Another time or two isn't going to make a difference now."

"And what about Johnny?"

"If you say you can talk them both around, then I have to trust you," I shrugged. "As weird and as fucked up as this situation is, until we come up with something better, it's all we've got. No matter how hard it is for me, I have to face up to the fact that it's my fault so I have to live with it."

"But I'm scared," Jessica replied, "Scared that it'll make you hate me. You said you love me, but what if this just ends up pushing you even further away?"

"What if having sex with Pat and Conroy makes you not want to have sex with me?" I countered. "There are a million ifs and buts, we can't answer them all. Sometimes you just have to go with it and deal with the repercussions afterwards. What I do know is that if you don't at least text them back, things aren't going to get better - they're going to get worse."

Jessica got up to get her phone and sat back down next to me, reading out the text to me as she wrote and sent it.

“Hi, Pat,” she wrote. “I’m sorry I’ve not replied. Things have been a little crazy and I needed some space. Call me.”

“And Sharples,” I reminded her and she typed the exact same message to him.

“Done,” she said, looking at me. “If they call and ask to see me, what do I say?”

“You can either say yes,” I replied with a resigned laugh. “Or we do the runaway thing.”

Fortunately, neither of the men called. Pat texted back to say he was glad she was okay now and that he’d be in touch shortly and then Sharples responded to say that he was out right now but he’d call her tomorrow.

Then my phone rang and I pulled it out of my pocket, realising who it would be at I did.

“Hi, Yvette,” I said out loud, putting a finger to my lips for Jessica to stay quiet.

“You did it,” she said. “You talked. I know because Patrick just told me that your wife has finally texted him back. How did it go?”

“We’ve sorted some things out,” I told her. “We’ve still got some other stuff to work through but I’m back home now and we’re still talking.”

“Great.” Yvette went quiet for a moment. “Well, this is what’s happening next. I tried to delay Patrick but he’s rather keen on getting things sorted out sooner rather than later.”

“What do you mean?”

“He’s on his way over there right now,” Yvette said as my heart began to pound in my chest. “With Vinny. Don’t worry, he doesn’t mean you any

harm. I told him about you and he's cool with it but then I also said that I like you and that if he as much as lays a finger on you, he'll have me to answer to."

"So why is he coming over here?" I said, flashing a worried look at Jess to warn her.

"As I said, he wants to sort things out promptly," Yvette replied. "He won't hurt you, I promise. Just see what he has to say and let me know how it's gone when he's left."

"What do you mean 'sort things out'?" I asked but Yvette had already hung up.

"Brewster's coming," I said to Jess but before she could say anything, there was a knock at the door.

Chapter 16

“Good evening,” said Pat Brewster, walking straight past me as I opened the door. Vinny followed him in, smirking at me as I closed the door behind them.

“I didn’t know you were coming,” Jessica said with a smile, trying to appear calm but I could tell she was as disturbed as I was at his unexpected visit. She smoothed down the black t-shirt she was wearing, obviously suddenly self-conscious of being so casually dressed in the plain top and jeans now that Brewster was here.

“Yes, I hope you don’t mind my impromptu visit,” he replied. Pat was only short but was still physically imposing because of his powerful build. His entire frame was broad from his thick neck to his wide shoulders and deep chest, right down to the muscular thighs that rippled through his grey trousers as he sat down on the sofa in our living room.

Jessica glanced at me and I shrugged, trying to make it clear that I had no idea what he wanted or what to say. “Would you like a drink or anything?” she said, fiddling with her red ponytail over her shoulder.

“What do you have?” He asked. “Your text said to call but I thought it would be better to talk face-to-face.” Brewster pushed his wavy dark-grey hair behind his ear, which was a habit of his that I’d observed while playing poker against him. He always did that little gesture when he was confident

that he was going to win. I was good at picking up reads on people - one of the reasons I'd enjoyed so much success at times.

"Beer?" I offered and Brewster looked at me for the first time, almost as though he'd only just realised I was present.

"Beer would be good," he nodded but Vinny shook his head when I turned to ask him. "Vinny is driving," Pat explained.

"So to what do we owe the pleasure of your visit?" Jessica said as I fetched three bottles from the fridge. I needed one and I was pretty sure Jess could use one too.

"I was worried as to why you were avoiding me." Brewster took the beer from me and took a sip. "I thought we had an understanding."

"We do," Jessica smiled, taking her own beer and sitting next to him. "As I explained in the text, things haven't been great so I needed some time out."

"I heard," he nodded. He loosened the pink silk tie around his neck and undid the top button of his crisp white shirt. He was wearing a dark blue suit, looking like he was fresh from a business meeting or something. "I know that Lee went to stay with his friend for a few days. Have you two sorted your differences out now?"

"He found out about us," Jess admitted, which caught me by surprise. I hadn't expected her to handle things so candidly. She looked at me with a 'trust me' smile and then turned back to the older man. "I explained everything and we both needed a couple of days to figure out how we feel about things."

"So you found out, huh?" Brewster's pale grey eyes regarded me seriously with no hint of smugness. "If you'd just paid up, none of this would have been necessary, Lee."

“If I’d had the money to pay up, I would have,” I replied, holding his stare and trying not to appear intimidated. “I wasn’t holding out on you, Pat. You know that. You’ll get your money in time, as soon as I can possibly pay you.”

“Your wife has proved a welcome distraction and has negotiated with me to write some of your debt off via a regular arrangement.” He took another drink, then twined his fingers together around the bottle, holding it in his lap like an erect penis. He laughed, making me aware that the gesture was deliberate although I didn’t really understand the significance of it. Brewster could be weird like that. He’d often make jokes which only he found funny.

“An arrangement which we still have,” Jessica smiled, putting her hand on his thigh and squeezing it. “Right?”

“Well, I was beginning to worry that our arrangement was in jeopardy,” the powerful man replied, looking down at her hand. “And that I was going to have to resort to more drastic measures again to get my money back.”

I looked sideways at Vinny and saw him grin at me menacingly.

“Not at all,” Jessica replied quickly. “Just let me know when you want me again. Lee understands the situation, don’t you?”

I couldn’t speak. I felt my face redden, my cheeks flushing at the ignominy of it but I found it in myself to nod.

“Lee understands,” Brewster mused while returning his gaze to me. “Do you, Lee? Maybe Lee even enjoys the situation? Some men do. Some men get a bit of a kick out of it.”

“It’s not like that,” I started to say but Jessica stepped in.

“Lee has had to face the truth of the matter,” she said softly, “Which is that we can’t pay you in the normal way. That’s all it is. He knows we’ve

had sex and it's not easy for him but he's come to accept that it's the only way we have right now to set things right with you."

"And you're happy with this arrangement moving forward?" Brewster leaned forward as he asked. "You're okay with me fucking your wife?"

"You don't have to put it so bluntly," I clenched my jaw. "No, I'm not happy with it but if Jessica is okay doing it then I guess it is what it is. I don't seem to have a lot of choice in the matter."

Brewster leaned back again, taking another sip of the beer and glanced at Vinny as if to check his silent bodyguard was still there.

"So now that we're all together, let's negotiate the agreement anew," he said. "If you can't make a payment, I will defer that payment back one week in return for Jessica being my escort for the evening. In future, I might ask that she even stay the night, if she so wishes."

I was about to object but Jess said, "Okay," before I had the chance. I tried to catch her attention but she was focused on the broad man sitting next to her.

"I've already written off one week's worth of debt," Brewster went on to say. "And I'm willing to do that again in future, but only on special occasions or when I have a special request."

"The same... *special request* as last time?" Jessica said. Her hand was on his leg again. "Lee would be okay with that, I think. Wouldn't you?"

They both looked at me and something inside me wilted at the fact that Brewster was now aware that I knew about her cum being inside her when I licked her pussy.

"So you're okay with eating my cum too?" Brewster stuck out his mouth as though he was impressed. "You're a good little cuck, aren't you, Lee?"

I had no idea what a *cuck* was but I had no option other than to nod.

“This is getting better and better,” Brewster nodded. “So how about another special request. Right here, right now?”

“Now?” Jess’s blue eyes went wide as she looked at me and then quickly back to Pat. “What kind of special request?”

“I will knock off two week’s worth of payments from the total amount,” Brewster said, stroking his square chin. “That’s a grand - if you let me fuck you right now.”

“Two weeks?” Jessica double-checked with him before turning to me. “What do you think?”

I was about to reluctantly say ‘okay’ when Brewster butted in.

“That’s not all,” he said. “I’m not knocking a grand off your debt for a simple fuck. I want Vinny to join in *and* Lee has to watch and then lick your pussy afterwards.”

“There’s *no way*—” I started but Jess cut me off.

“You don’t have a choice,” she said in a sharp, loud voice. “It’s a grand, Lee. *A grand.*”

“Can I speak to my wife in private for a moment?” I asked and when Brewster shrugged, I walked into the kitchen and Jessica followed me.

“A threesome with Vinny? Really?” I hissed at her when we were out of earshot. “And you expect me to watch and then lick... *that* out of you?”

“Before Pat got here,” Jessica replied, her tone still quite harsh. “You said that you had to face up to facts that this is the only option we have. You said you’d accept it, no matter how hard it was for you.”

“I know but—”

“There are no buts, Lee. You said I’ve already done it with him three times, so a few more times won’t make a difference. I’ve also done it with

Jack Conroy and sucked Johnny's cock, so what difference does doing it with Vinny make? It's just one more."

I didn't have an answer to that.

"You said that we just had to do it and deal with the repercussions afterwards. Plus, I told you that I kind of get a kick out of it and you seemed okay with that too."

"Right," I nodded, trying to find a way out of this but failing as she continued talking.

"You admitted to it being your fault that we're in this situation. You fucked up, Lee. Not me. If you want to make this marriage work, I think you're going to have to let me take control of matters and let me fix things my way. What do you think?"

"So you actually *want* to do this?" I asked, looking over her shoulder at the two men waiting in the living room.

"Maybe it's something I'll enjoy," she nodded after a moment, her eyes glistening and a mischievous look appearing on her face. "Making you watch two guys fuck me. Why don't we just try it? Even if you hate it, it's a grand knocked off your debt."

The money wasn't as important as my marriage was but I didn't say that. I sighed and nodded. There wasn't any other choice. Not really.

"I can't believe we're doing this," I said quietly as we walked back into the living room.

"Me neither," Jessica whispered back. I stood behind her as she stepped in front of Brewster and looked at both him and Vinny. "Okay," she said with a resigned shrug. "Here or in the bedroom - where are we doing this?"

"Why do we have to restrict it to one room?" Pat said, standing up and removing his suit jacket. "We can start here then take it upstairs if we want

to.”

“That sounds okay,” my wife replied, smiling at him as he began to unbuckle his trousers then stepping in close so she could help him remove his tie and undo his shirt buttons.

“Do I just stand here?” I asked, feeling incredibly awkward where I was, standing next to Vinny.

“No. I want you to sit down,” Pat directed me to the armchair opposite. “I want you to watch and enjoy seeing how a real man fucks a woman.”

I bit my lip at the insult. One day, I’d get my own back on the bastard. I didn’t know how, but I would.

Chapter 17

I sat down in the armchair as Jessica helped Pat to strip down to just his boxer shorts, then watched as she knelt in front of him and tugged those down too. His cock swung out almost like a mini elephant's trunk, long and thick even when flaccid, but then it began to stiffen as she took it in her hand and began to fondle it.

"Suck it," he told her putting his meaty hand on the back of her red-haired head as she took it into her mouth, her lips struggling to open wide enough to engulf even just the large circumcised bell-end tip.

Vinny moved, sitting on the arm of the sofa nearby so he had a better view as Jessica began to suck the cock in her mouth. Her hand held the shaft which I could see thickening and hardening while she enthusiastically worked her mouth and tongue around the end until, after just a few minutes, his impressive penis was standing out straight in front of him.

"Good," he said, his voice soft and sleazy-sounding. "Now let's get you out of those clothes, Jessica."

I had to watch as my wife stood up and lifted her top up and over her head, then tugged her jeans down so she was standing there in just a plain grey t-shirt bra and panty set.

"And the rest," Brewster said, turning to grin at Vinny for a moment.

Jessica reached behind her and unclasped the bra, letting it fall to the floor to reveal her pale, full breasts and then shimmied her way out of the panties. The light reddish fuzz on her pubic mound caught in the artificial light of the living room, looking even more gingery than usual.

“You have a very beautiful wife, Lee,” Brewster said but the compliment left a sour taste in my mouth as she sat down and patted the sofa next to him. “Perhaps you should see this as a personal porn show. That way it might not be as difficult for you.”

Jessica sat next to Pat and they kissed, making my stomach clench at the sight. Knowing this had happened before was one thing, but watching it was something else and it became more difficult as I had to watch his big hands paw at her tits, finding one of her pale nipples and pinching it between her finger and thumb.

This isn't actually happening, the voice in my head said but it was and it got even more real as his hand slid down between her legs. Jessica parted her thighs for him and I watch him slide his thick digits into my wife's folds, parting them with some expertise before burying one into her.

Within a minute or so, it wasn't just one finger but two and he was working them in and out of her rapidly, making Jessica's chest rise and fall as she began to breathe more and more heavily. Then without any warning, he scooped her up from the seat and pulled her onto his lap, pushing her legs open so that he could aim his erection between them.

“Watch it go in,” he said, looking over her shoulder at me as she lowered herself down onto it.

I did. From where I was sat, I saw the thick purple head of his penis push against her pale pink lips and then disappear out of view as it slid inside.

“Oh, fuck,” Jessica moaned softly as she sank down onto him. “I should be used to your big cock by now but I’m still not.”

My own cock twitched in my shorts for some reason as she said that. Maybe Pat was right. Maybe I should just try and switch off from the fact that the woman being fucked in front of me was my wife and just try to imagine I was watching some random porn.

“You’ve got a tight pussy,” Brewster said. “It’s always going to be a bit of a shock when it first goes in.”

As he said that, Jess finally managed to take it all, her ass resting on his lap for a moment before she slowly raised back up to drop back down onto it, this time managing the descent much easier.

Pat’s hands cupped her ass cheeks and she began to bounce slowly up and down on him and then he began to push upwards, his thrusts meeting hers and eliciting a groan from my wife’s throat every time it pushed all the way in.

I watched them fuck like that for several minutes until Vinny suddenly stood up and began to strip off. I saw Jessica look at him but she didn’t say anything.

Shit. The threesome really was going to happen.

When Vinny was naked, his impressive body almost matching Pat’s, he stood on our sofa and offered her his cock to suck, which she didn’t object to. She simply turned her head and took it into her mouth.

As his cock stiffened, I saw that he was only of average size. Perhaps bigger than me, but not by a lot. He was, however, much girthier than me but I tried not to think about it. She was doing this to get us out of debt. That’s all it was. Wasn’t it?

After another few minutes of riding Brewster's cock while sucking Vinny to full hardness, she stopped and after taking a few seconds to catch her breath, she suggested we go upstairs.

"Let's take it to a proper bed where we're more comfortable," she said, still panting slightly.

"Sounds good to me," Brewster said and stood up, impressively lifting Jess with one arm, putting her over her shoulder.

Vinny took the opportunity to slap her on the ass, bringing an amused yelp from Jessica and leaving a faint handmark on her butt cheek.

"There will be chances for that sort of thing in the future," Brewster chastised his bodyguard. "Today I just need to fuck."

With that, he carted her towards the staircase and upwards, Vinny following him out of sight. I sat there for a few minutes, wondering what to do, until I heard Brewster call my name, telling me to come and watch.

Reluctantly, I stood up and headed up after them. I'd hoped they'd do the rest without me there, sparing me the pain but it wasn't to be. I took a deep breath as I walked into the bedroom but wasn't prepared for what I saw.

Jessica was on all fours on the bed and Brewster was in front of her, feeding his dick into her mouth as his bodyguard fucked her hard from behind. Her tits swung pendulously beneath her with every cannon of his toned abdomen against her behind and from where I was standing, I saw that his thick shaft was wet with her juices as he pulled out and then slammed back in again.

My wife wasn't moaning now. The sounds she was making around Brewster's cock were more like grunts and then to my surprised, she groaned and swore as her back arched and an orgasm rippled through her.

She would have sagged to the bed after she finished quivering but Brewster held her mouth around his dick and Vinny kept a hold of her hips, his dick still buried in her pussy as she came.

They fucked her like that again for a time before switching ends while positioning her flat on her back. Brewster roughly pushed her thighs apart, Jessica making no move to resist as Vinny gave her his wet cock to suck. As Brewster took her one more time, ramming his dick into her from above, Jess surprised me by taking Vinny's hairy balls into her mouth, sucking them for a while before moving onto his dick itself.

My own dick was throbbing in my trousers, almost asking me to get it out and stroke it, so the trick of imagining Jessica was someone else must be working. I shouldn't be aroused, it felt wrong, but I couldn't help it.

"I want to fuck those big tits," Vinny said, one of the few rare times that I'd heard him speak and the three of them changed position again. Brewster stayed inside her, but shifted to his side, his legs scissored around hers, his body at a ninety-degree angle as he started fucking her. In this position, I could see right between where their two bodies met and had the clearest view yet of his cock spearing in and out of her. Jessica's labia were stretched out around his shaft and I watched, fascinated at how his extra girth seemed to make them grip his cock, being pulled out and then pushed back in with thrusts.

She was groaning and grunting in equal measure, making noises of pleasure that I'd never heard her make before and she didn't stop as Vinny straddled her chest, placing his dick on her breastbone and then using his two hands to crush her tits together around it. He spat downwards, adding his saliva to the gap between her breasts as a sort of lube, then began to fuck her cleavage.

I'd never seen anyone else have sex before let alone watch a threesome involving my wife and two men so the sight of such debauchery was almost surreal. The atmosphere in the bedroom was so charged that the air felt thick and I realised it smelled of sweat and sex.

They were fucking like animals now, all three of them moaning, grunting and groaning and it took everything I had not to touch myself. I knew that if I did, I'd probably instantly make a mess in my pants.

"I'm gonna cum," Vinny said suddenly and before I had time to absorb the reality of what I was about to see - another man ejaculating - he released my wife's breasts so that his angry, throbbing erection popped up and then I saw it tense and a streak of white fluid shot out of the tip. It landed right down the centre of Jessica's face from her forehead, down the bridge of her nose and across her mouth to her chin. A second spurt landed on her mouth and chin and a third and fourth sprayed onto her neck and upper chest.

I expected her to grimace in disgust but she didn't. She stuck her tongue out and licked the spunk off her lips and then giggled. This wasn't my wife, I told myself. This wasn't Jessica. It was a porn actress in a real-life dirty movie.

Vinny stepped away from the bed on unsteady legs, slipping past me and out of the bedroom and then a minute or so later, I heard him running a tap in the bathroom. He must have gone to clean himself up but I was too intent on what was now happening on the bed. Brewster was fucking Jessica again but this time on his knees, with my wife's legs lifted up over his shoulders. His forward thrusts into her were short but powerful and as I watched, Jess had another orgasm, her thighs quaking against his chest but he didn't let up, continuing to push into her even as she cried out in ecstasy,

his unrelenting thrusts seeming to prolong her climax longer than I'd ever seen her cum before.

Then as Vinny rejoined me in the room - he was clothed again so he must have gone downstairs to retrieve his clothes - Brewster came. He didn't give any warning, he just rammed his cock in and out fast, his balls slapping against her ass with a 'thwack, thwack' sound and I saw his rhythm become slightly jerky right before he grunted and then held his cock there, impaled inside her. I could see the muscles in his lower back and backside twitching as his dick pumped his sperm into my wife's pussy.

Eventually, he withdrew, a long string of cum connecting the tip of his dick to Jess's puffy labia for a moment until he stepped from the bed and stretched, flexing his arms above his head.

"That was good," he grinned from ear to ear, "As always. But you know what time it is now, Lee?"

I didn't understand the question until Jessica pushed herself into a sitting position and beckoned me over to the bed. I approached and then I understood as she opened her thighs and looked down between them.

"Lick my pussy, Lee," she said.

Chapter 18

I stared at her, my feet rooted to the spot, unable to believe what she was asking me to do.

“It’s worth a grand,” Brewster reminded me and I turned to look at him. He was still naked, with his cock in his hand, slowly stroking his flaccid length while waiting for me to do what Jess was asking.

“I... I can’t,” I stammered, but I knew that I wasn’t going to wriggle out of this. I had to do it.

“You’ve licked his cum out of me three times now,” Jessica said encouragingly. “And you’ve tasted Johnny’s and Jack’s too.”

“You should be used to it by now,” Brewster joked.

Fuck. She was right, I’d done this before, even though the first few times I hadn’t been aware. I lay down between her thighs, noting how her lips were slightly opened, her hole visible and gaping slightly from being fucked so roughly by Brewster’s girthy penis.

“Lick it,” she said softly.

“Do it,” Pat’s voice came from somewhere behind me.

I leaned in, seeing some of his cum already leaking from her, a sticky white gloop running down the inside of her thigh and some matted in her reddish pubic hair. I opened my mouth and ran my tongue over her clit, which made her shudder in pleasure and then I did it - I pushed the tip of

my tongue downwards, through her folds to her hole, cleaning away the cum.

It tasted much stronger than it had before. There was a muskiness added to the salt and the sticky texture of it made me gag slightly but because of how Jessica was reacting, moaning loudly, I continued on licking.

“Oh, fuck, I’m going to cum again,” Jessica said unexpectedly and pushed her pussy forward, grinding onto my face, smearing more of Brewster’s spunk onto my mouth and chin. She rocked backwards and forwards while groaning with her orgasm until eventually sagging back onto the bed, seemingly totally exhausted now.

“I want to see you swallow it,” Brewster said, his hand on my face and turning me to face him. I did as he asked, licking my lips and then swallowing, my humiliation complete.

“You dirty bastard,” Brewster grinned. “I’ll tell you what, you deserve the grand. You’ve earned it. We’ll have to do this sometime.”

With that, he turned and walked out of the room, Vinny following him, but called over his shoulder. “Don’t worry, I’ll let myself out. We really must do this again soon, Jessica.”

I got up to watch him leave but Jessica reached out and grabbed my hand.

“You’ve earned more than a grand,” she said with a naughty grin. “You’ve earned a fuck.”

For some reason, I was incredibly turned on and wasn’t about to refuse her, no matter what I’d just been forced to do. I stripped out of my clothes and she opened her legs again as I climbed onto the bed and slid between them.

Her pussy felt so wet that I could barely tell I was even inside her. I had to look down after I pushed it in to make sure that I really was inside her because I could barely feel it.

“Fuck me,” she whispered into my ear as I laid my weight down upon her.

I began to work my dick in and out but it felt so dirty to be doing what I was doing - fucking a pussy that had already had two other cocks inside it and was still half-full with someone else's sperm - that I didn't last long. I didn't try to hold on, I just pumped into her and came, feeling my own dick spurt into her, my cum mixing with Brewster's.

“I'm sorry,” I moaned. “I was too turned on.”

“Have you cum?” she replied as I rolled off. “Don't take this the wrong way, but I didn't even feel it.”

“It's because you were so wet and-” I paused, realising she might misinterpret what I was about to say next.

“Wet and a little stretched out?” she guessed. “I know. Pat didn't go easy on me, did he? I'm going to be sore tomorrow, I think.”

We stayed in bed for a while, not even talking, just resting and recovering both physically and mentally from what we'd just done until eventually Jessica sat up and gazed down at me.

“I do love you,” she said softly, her red hair falling across her face. “You know that, don't you?”

I nodded. “I love you too.”

She pushed the hair out of her eyes. “I just don't want you thinking that I don't because of how I was with you earlier.”

“How you were with me?” I questioned. “What do you mean?”

“I made you watch me fuck two other men,” she replied, watching my face for my reaction. “And then I made you clean up Pat’s sperm. I don’t want you to think I hate you or anything or that it was revenge or anything.”

“So what was it?” I asked.

“It just turns me on,” she said, chewing her lip in thought. “Making you watch me with someone else is kind of horny. And then seeing you being all sort of... submissive and licking up Pat’s sperm was just... mind-blowing if I’m honest.”

“Really?” I’d gathered that this was the case, but I made out like I was surprised. “I thought you just liked it because his cock is much bigger than mine and he fucks you in ways that I obviously can’t compete with.”

“That too,” she admitted. “Your dick is a little bit on the small side for my tastes if I’m being totally honest with you but I do still love it because I love you. I hope you believe me.”

The comment about my size stung but I still managed to squeeze out a smile for her benefit. “I do, otherwise you wouldn’t still be here after the mess I got us into.”

“Don’t forget we knocked a whole grand off what you owe,” Jessica said, getting out of bed and wrapping a dressing gown around herself. “If we do this again - which I kind of want to - we’ll pay things off in no time.”

“I know,” I replied, also getting up and joining her in heading downstairs to grab something to eat. “Now we have to find a way of dealing with Sharples.”

* * *

We didn’t talk much the rest of the evening about what we’d done. I had to accept that Jessica enjoyed having sex with Brewster but also that she enjoyed doing it in front of me. This slightly sadistic and cruel streak had come as a surprise, but there was denying it or suppressing it. Eating Pat’s cum wasn’t something I wanted but I was going to have to get used to it for a while. Hopefully, we’d find an easier way of satisfying Johnny Sharples.

The answer to that question presented itself a day later in a surprising fashion.

It was Saturday and I wasn’t at work, so Jessica and I had planned to spend the day together and have lunch out as a mini-celebration of our reunion but as we left the house that morning, a familiar car was parked outside.

“Hey,” said the equally familiar driver from through the driver side window.

“Hi, Charlotte,” I said, surprised to see Pat’s daughter again. “What’s up?”

“My father tells me he’s partially settled some of your debt,” the girl said, looking past me at Jessica and I realised that they probably hadn’t been introduced.

“I’m sorry,” I said, letting Jess step up beside me. “This is Jessica, my wife. Jessica, this is Charlotte Brewster, Pat’s daughter.”

The two women exchanged a ‘hello’ before Charlotte continued. “But I also heard him say that he still wants his money. Lee, he’s not going to let you pay everything off in the way you think.”

I looked at Jessica and she frowned, concern etched on her brow at what Charlotte was saying.

“Do you remember that I had something else to tell you?” Charlotte went on. “You never gave me the time to explain last time.”

“How do you two know each other?” Jessica asked but I waved the question away for now.

“Tell me now if you like?” I said to the younger woman. “Jessica and I were just going for lunch but if it’s important I guess we can wait.”

“Get in,” she replied. “Where are you going to eat? I’ll drive you and tell you along the way.”

Jessica was still studying me, probably wondering if there was more to mine and Charlotte’s friendship than she knew about but we got into the car and let Charlotte drive us to the cafe where we’d planned to go.

“You’ve been cheated,” Charlotte stated simply when I asked her what this was all about.

“Cheated?” I asked her to clarify. “What do you mean?”

“You said your luck ran out,” Charlotte explained further. “Well, it didn’t. You were cheated. Father does it all the time. He has one or two of the other players working with him, sending secret signals as to what cards they’re holding so they make plays against their mark.”

“What?” I asked. I was aware of the practice in theory but never in a million years had I thought it might have been used in our private games.

“Dad and his buddies scour the casino looking for confident players like you,” his daughter revealed. “Someone who’s building up a reputation and some winnings and then they lure them into their private games. For a while, they’ll let them win, building up a false sense of security and then they start to fix the games.”

“By playing as a team against them?” I asked, unable to believe it.

“Not just that,” Charlotte shook her head, looking through her rearview mirror at me. “Sometimes, they simply fix the hand by using a fake deal.”

“We always rotated the dealer,” I shook my head. “Each player took it in turns to shuffle and deal the cards.”

“But when several of the players at the table are on dad’s payroll and when one or two of them are professionals at stacking the deck, it’s easy to fix one or two big hands and that’s all it takes. One big hand. I bet when you think back, you often lost all of your chips on one or two big hands.”

“Wow,” I said, the reality of this settling in. She was right. When I thought about it, that’s exactly what would happen. I’d do well for a while, whether I was playing aggressively or more conservatively and then I’d get dealt a big hand only to run into a freak turn or river card or simply an even bigger hand.

“Here you are,” Charlotte said, pulling up outside the cafe.

“If this is indeed true,” Jessica said, even though she probably hadn’t understood half of what she’d just heard. “Why are you telling us? Why would you drop your father in it?”

“I told Lee once before that you seem like a nice couple,” Charlotte shrugged. “He’ll tell you. I don’t approve of my father’s business practice and I feel bad for you. Don’t tell him any of this came from me. Oh, and

you might want to talk to Johnny Sharples about it too. He was one of the ones in on it.”

“Sharples knew?” I leaned forward, making Charlotte turn to look at me over her shoulder. “Are you sure about that?”

“Ask him,” she replied simply. “You’ll see. Now, I don’t mean to kick you out or anything, but I have somewhere to go.”

“Yes, sorry,” I said, opening the door and stepping outside. “Thank you, Charlotte.”

Charlotte waited until Jessica was alongside me on the pavement outside.

“You’re welcome,” she smiled. “Come visit me sometime and let me know how you got on. I’m living in the new house at the moment. “Your wife knows where it is.”

With that, she drove away, leaving both Jessica and me with more questions than answers, but also just a sliver of hope about how to deal with Sharples.

Chapter 19

“Hello, Frank,” I said to the big owner of the pub we found ourselves at later that evening. “Johnny told me to meet him here.”

The tall bald gangster looked down at me from where he was perched on a stool at the end of the bar. “You’re Lee Parker, right?”

“That’s right,” I nodded, watching Frank’s attention divert to my right and then his eyes roamed up and down Jessica’s body. She was standing next to me but she didn’t say anything, instead, she simply raised an eyebrow questioningly at him.

“So you’re the lady he’s been telling me all about,” the big man mused. “I see what he means about you being a looker.”

“Very nice,” my wife murmured. “Now is Sharples here yet, or not? We have business to attend to.”

“He’s here,” Frank grunted, a grin turning up the corners of his mouth. “He wasn’t joking about you being sassy either.”

With that, he waved a hand and I turned to see Conroy emerge from the crowd of revellers that filled the pub tonight. The tanned, black-haired brick wall of a man only nodded in my direction but cast a warm smile at Jessica when he saw her by my side.

“Hello, Jack,” she said in a surprisingly throaty voice. “We’re here to see your boss.”

“Yes, he’s expecting you,” his bodyguard replied, beckoning us to follow him.

“He’s in the backroom,” Frank explained, then called after us as we followed Conroy. “I’ll see you soon.”

Conroy led us through the main bar room into a smaller oak-panelled room with a snooker table in the middle. There were no windows, so the only lighting came from the small bar in the corner and the lamp hanging over the table to illuminate the green baize cloth and the coloured balls scattered across it. The smell of tobacco filled my nostrils, the smoke coming from the lit cigar in Sharples’ mouth filling the air and making the room slightly hazy.

“Greetings,” the fat mobster shook a snooker cue in my direction. “Do you play?”

“I don’t,” I confessed, not taking the stick which made Sharples shrug and give it to Jessica instead. She took it and watched as Sharples leant over the table and took a shot which sent a red ball fizzing into the corner pocket nearest to me.

“You don’t need to pay anything this week,” he said, pocketing the black ball next before moving on to the next red. “Or did you want to see me about something else?”

“Is it true that you and Brewster cheated me at poker?” I said, trying to remain calm even though this was a dangerous gambit that Jess and I had decided to risk.

“Cheated?” Sharples said as his attempt at potting the blue ball missed, the shiny ball rattling in the pocket before bouncing out. He stood up, his dark eyes locking onto mine. “Are you calling me a cheat?”

“Yes,” Jessica answered when I hesitated. “Yes, Johnny. We are. We know all about it.”

I took over, telling him everything that Charlotte had told us, then stood there in silence, keeping an eye on Conroy standing at the other side of the room, while waiting for his boss to reply.

“Out of interest,” he said eventually, stroking his fleshy chin with a podgy hand, “You’ve been told this... by who?”

“I don’t have to tell you that,” I responded, shaking my head. “Just tell me if it’s true or not. I know for sure that Brewster cheated me, but were you in on it too?”

“Pat Brewster and I are no longer in business,” Sharples replied, then indicated towards the table. “It’s your shot, Jessica.”

Jessica had changed into a grey t-shirt and black skirt and as she bent over the table to take her shot, Sharples used the tip of his cue to pull the skirt up, revealing her white panties.

“Johnny,” my wife complained but she didn’t move. “I’m trying to play.”

I took a step towards him as he refused to stop lifting her skirt higher but he pointed the cue in my direction, making me stop in my tracks.

“What?” he said. “What are you going to do, Lee?”

“Stop fooling around and tell me the truth,” I said, watching the tip of the snooker cue carefully as he waved it just a few inches from my face.

“Pat and I had a nice little racket going,” he nodded, making his multiple chins wobble. “And yes, you got caught up in it for a while. I wanted to stop because I liked you and I knew you were getting in over your head, but Pat wanted to keep it going. He kept it going so long that eventually, he ended up doing the dirty on me recently.”

“I knew it.” I exhaled, bunching my fists in anger. “You screwed me over, Sharples. And then still had the cheek to bleed me for even more cash by letting me borrow from you.”

“I was thinking of letting your debt go,” he shrugged. “I only tried to recover it from you because Brewster screwed me over too. It was wrong of me and I am sorry.”

Wow. Sharples was apologising.

I stared at him, trying to work out if he was being genuine or if this was some kind of trick. “Brewster cheated you too?”

“Yes,” he nodded, watching Jessica miss her next shot. “He doesn’t know that I know.”

“So, what does that mean for us?” Jessica asked, standing up from the table and pulling her skirt back down her thighs.

“I don’t know yet.” Sharples chalked the tip of his cue, perusing the table and deciding which shot to take next. Then his expression changed suddenly and he looked at me, a curious look on his face. “So you know about the fixed poker game. But do you know everything else there is to know?”

“He knows everything, Johnny,” Jess replied before I could speak. “He knows about Pat and me. He knows about you and I and Jack. He knows it all and he’s also slept with Pat’s wife, so he and I are kind of even.”

“You’ve fucked Yvette?” Johnny’s head tipped back and he laughed upwards at the smoke-stained ceiling. “Bravo. Well played, sir.”

“It’s not the most exclusive of clubs,” Conroy chuckled from the back of the room, making Sharples laugh even louder.

“You’ve fucked her too?” Jessica said, turning to the burly bodyguard and Conroy nodded.

“I have an idea,” Sharples said as he focused his attention back on me, the snooker table forgotten now. “I’ve been formulating a plan to get my own back on Pat and this... unexpected turn of events, might just work in my favour.”

“How so?” I asked.

“What if I said I could help you clear your debt on Brewster?” Sharples offered, placing his cue flat on the table and collecting a glass of whisky from the bar. “And clear your debt to me plus probably make a chunk of money for yourself.”

“It sounds like another con to me,” I started but Sharples waved the comment away.

“I’ve already started putting the plan in place,” he explained, “A game. A *big* game but this time, the cards are going to be stacked in my favour, you see my friend Frank - you met him just now - he’s just come out of prison with some *very* useful information. Information on Pat’s friend, Kai Frost.”

“And?” I said, not understanding how that was relevant.

“Which means that Kai is now working for me,” Sharples smiled, his white teeth glinting in the hazy light above the snooker table. “And no longer for Pat. Kai, if you didn’t know already, is Pat’s main game fixer.”

I didn’t know that, but it made sense. Kai Frost was one of the big league poker players that had won a lot of money from me. He liked to deal a lot and he was often the one that set the games up.

“Where are you going with this?” Jessica asked. She was standing next to Brewster now. Uncomfortably close.

“As I said before,” Johnny continued, “Brewster and I are no longer in business. He’s fucked me over and I want my money back but I don’t want

to end up at war with him. My plan is for Kai to fix this next game, but this time in my favour. The problem is that I'm not the best poker player and just two of us - Kai and me - don't have enough influence at the table to overturn Pat but if we had one more player... One good player... We could win *big*."

"You want me to play?" I said, Sharples plan becoming clear now.

"I could get any number of players," the greasy-haired gangster shrugged. "I know plenty. I just haven't got around to it yet, but yes. If you want this opportunity, I suppose I could arrange it."

"We've already come to an agreement with Pat," Jessica said, her gaze meeting mine for a moment.

"Ah," Sharples nodded, turning to face me. "I should have expected that. But are you really happy with your wife fucking him and his cronies for the rest of your life? It won't just be him all the time, you know? He'll let Vinny fuck her then all of his other minions. That's how Pat works. He'll pass her around like his cheap whore for all his buddies to use."

"I've already slept with Vinny," my wife said casually, making my eyes widen in an attempt to tell her to shut up. I didn't need shaming any worse than I already had been. "But that was my choice, not Pat's."

"Okay, enough," I said sharply, trying not to get into a conversation about my wife fucking other men yet again. "If this card game is going to work like you say it is - me, you and Kai working as a team. Kai fixing the deal where he can. I want in."

"We'll chip away at Pat during the game," Sharples said, formulating the plan out loud. "Then I'll get Kai to fix one big hand in your favour. Pat will never see it coming. Whatever you win, we split three ways between

you, me and Kai. And we'll make it big enough to settle your debt with both Pat and me."

"That sounds like a big buy-in," I commented. "I don't have any spare money, Johnny. If this is yet another ruse to get me more in debt, I'm not interested."

"In that case," Sharples took a long drag from his cigar and blew a cloud of smoke out into the vertical shaft of light shining down from the snooker light. "I suppose I could pay your buy-in."

"In return for what?" Jessica said, anticipating where this was going.

Sharples turned towards my wife, a lecherous smile appearing on his face. "One last fun session," he proposed. "I want to watch you get fucked again, Jessica.

Through the hazy atmosphere, I saw Conroy walk over towards us from the far side of the room, already undoing the top button on his shirt.

"Okay," Jessica agreed without even consulting me.

Then Sharples picked up his cue and swept all of the remaining balls from the green surface of the snooker table before patting a spot on the green cloth.

"Not just by Conroy," the big man leered from Jessica to me. "By both of you."

Chapter 20

“**Y**ou want to watch me and Lee?” Jessica asked in surprise.

“You and Lee,” Sharples confirmed, patting the cloth again with the fleshy palm of his right hand. “Right here and now.”

“And this isn’t a trick?” I asked again. “If we do this, you’ll help me beat Brewster through a fixed game.”

“You have my word,” Sharples nodded, his cheeks spreading into a wide smile. “For what my word is worth, at least.”

“Would you rather we go somewhere a little more... comfortable?” Jessica asked but Sharples shook his head and reached out with one hand, stroking her reddish hair as she stood next to the table beside him.

“There’s no time like the present to do things,” he said softly. Then his hand slid downwards, along her neck, lingering at her collar bone before moving to her breast, cupping it and squeezing it gently.

Conroy was there now too and had removed his shirt to reveal a barrel-like chest and powerful, thick, hairy arms. He began to unbuckle his jeans as Jess looked to me for guidance on what to do.

“Wait,” Sharples said, putting his hand on his bodyguard’s shoulder. “Lee hasn’t agreed yet.”

“You had better not be playing with me,” I sighed, realising I had little choice than to play along. “If it’s okay with Jessica, then I guess we have a

deal.”

“You’re the one that knows what you’re doing with the game,” Jess shrugged. “I don’t really understand it but if what Johnny is saying makes sense, then it’s okay with me.”

“Great,” Sharples said, clapping his hands together loudly when I nodded at my wife. “Let’s do this.”

Conroy continued undoing his trousers but again Sharples made him pause by shaking his finger at him. “I want to see the married couple together first.”

Jess looked at me, her light blue eyes not blinking despite the smoky atmosphere in the dimly lit room. Perhaps sensing my hesitation over what we had to do, she beckoned me towards her with a curled finger and nodded ever-so-slightly in encouragement.

“It’s just sex,” she murmured, taking hold of my shirt and lifting it over my head, then she whispered into my ear, “Just pretend there’s no one here but us.”

Her hands were at my waistband, pulling my trousers and shorts down together and suddenly, my dick was exposed to everyone in the room. I couldn’t take her advice and imagine that Conroy and Sharples weren’t there because I was now acutely aware of my modest flaccid dick and balls wobbling around as I stepped out of my trousers and discarded my socks.

I saw Sharples and Conroy exchange a look between themselves after they’d seen my cock and I knew they were judging me as small but I wasn’t given too much time to think about it as Jessica knelt at my feet and took me in her mouth.

As she sucked me, I tried to focus on her red hair and gorgeous face but out of the corner of my eye, I couldn’t help but notice Conroy finishing

getting undressed and I looked at his penis as he began to stroke it while watching Jessica give me a blowjob.

“Conroy has a lovely big one, doesn’t he?” Sharples commented when he saw me look. “You’ll get to see it penetrate your wife shortly. It’s quite the sight.”

Pat Brewster’s dick had been impressive but Conroy’s was slightly bigger from what I could see as he tugged it to full hardness. It was thick and long with a sharp upwards curve and an angry-looking vein ran the full length of it.

“Are you ready to fuck me?” Jessica asked, standing up but continuing to wank off my hard cock with one hand.

“Is that as big as it gets?” Sharples chuckled. I looked down at my own erection, maybe half the size of Conroy’s. It was standing out proudly, all five inches or so, curving upwards slightly as she pumped her fist up and down it.

“He might only have a smallish one but he knows how to use it,” Jess defended me as she stripped off her grey t-shirt. “Don’t you?”

I nodded, trying to find some pride and to restore my energy which had been sapped by the sudden turn of events and Jess’s and Sharples’s embarrassing comments.

“Let me help you,” Conroy growled in his deep tone, moving behind Jessica to undo the strap of her plain white bra. As she let it fall away, she was already wriggling out of the black skirt she was wearing and I had to watch as Conroy slid her panties down to reveal her reddish bush so that she was naked now too.

“I do love that fire crotch of yours,” Sharples grunted in approval.

“Just do as I said,” Jessica whispered into my ear again, pulling me close and leaning against the snooker table. “Pretend they’re not here and just fuck me.”

With that, she turned around and bent over, pushing her pale behind against me and I did as she asked, trying to ignore that Conroy was standing naked, playing with his dick, just a couple of feet away in one direction while Sharples stood watching behind him.

The tip of my erection found her pussy and slid inside her easily. I was surprised at how wet she already was and at how she groaned as it went in.

“Go on, Lee,” Sharples called out. “Give your wife some cock.”

I put my hands on her hips and began to fuck her, attempting to block out his continued baiting.

“Get her warmed up for a real man’s dick,” he said, amongst other similar comments as I began to get into a good rhythm, even managing to enjoy the feeling of her pussy and the sounds of her soft moans from in front of me.

I thrust into my wife hard and fast to prove her right - that I did know how to use the modest equipment that I had - but just as I was really getting into it, Sharples told us to stop.

“It’s so fucking erotic, watching a married couple fuck,” he said, walking over to us and taking Jessica by the hand, to pull her away from me slightly. Then he scooped her up into his arms and laid her gently down on the green table’s surface. “But even more fun is watching her fuck someone else.”

Conroy took that as a hint to step forward and climb up onto the table. To my slight surprise, Jessica didn’t flinch. She even gave the bodyguard a slight smile and then I saw her hand take hold of his cock, beginning to

stroke him up and down before Sharples even told them to start doing anything.

“Show Lee how it’s done,” he said finally, after a moment of watching my wife wank the burly thug’s cock. It was so thick that her fingers barely met around the base of it.

Conroy pushed Jess’s thighs open, exposing her pussy fully to Sharples and me. Her red pubes glowed from the table lamp, the light from which was shining straight down onto her creamy-pale naked body. Then he clambered on top of her, waited until Jessica put the head of his dick between her folds and then his hips surged forward, ramming it into her with one smooth movement.

Jessica moaned loudly as it filled her, then grunted as their groins met with a thud. As he withdrew, her lips gripped his shaft even more tightly than they had Brewster’s and as the giant of a man began to bang his cock into her harder and harder, she moaned louder than she had with the other gangster too.

“Give it to her hard,” Sharples urged. “Make her cum.”

Jessica’s red hair was fanned out around her face, sweat beginning to drip down her face and between her tits, which were bouncing with the motion of Conroy’s thrusts but she didn’t seem to care what she looked like. Her eyes were closed but she opened them briefly and I saw them roll back into her head as she orgasmed.

Sharples lowered his head, looking down between their bodies at where Conroy’s dick was still pounding into her as she convulsed between him.

“Oh, shit,” he chuckled. “She’s squirted, I think. I’ll have to pay Frank for his table to be re-clothed.”

I looked between her legs and saw a large wet circle spreading outwards as Conroy continued to fuck her, prolonging her orgasm. Her thighs were trembling but once they'd calmed down, she wrapped them around his back and began to pull him into her, wanting more.

"Wait," Sharples called out after a few more minutes. "Lee, I want you to lay on the table for the last bit."

"What?" I asked. "They've almost finished."

"Jessica, I want you to get on top of your husband in the sixty-nine position," Sharples went on, ignoring me.

"Just do it," Jessica said as Conroy moved away. She was out of breath, so didn't say anything else. She just moved to one side so that I could climb up onto the damp and slightly dusty snooker table and then as I laid on my back, aware that the bright lamp was shining straight down onto my dick, she climbed on top, positioning her pussy over my face and her own near to my erection.

"Now carry on, Conroy," I heard Sharples say as I looked up at Jessica's wet, puffy folds. "Jessica, you can suck your husband if you want."

It took me a moment to realise what was happening and before I could say anything, Conroy's muscular thighs were on either side of my head and his enormous dick and scrotum were hovering just inches from my face.

I watched, finding myself fascinated with the close-up view, as he managed to direct his dick into Jess without even touching it. The bulbous purple tip pushed against her labia and then they parted as he applied pressure with his hips and it slid in. From where I was, I could see exactly how stretched out her pink lips were, especially when he was fully inside her.

As he began to move in and out, I felt her mouth envelop my cock, her tongue sliding up and down my shaft but when Conroy began thrusting in and out faster and harder, she had to stop, reverting to just wanking me with one hand while he fucked her.

Some of her pussy juices trickled out, landing on my mouth but I didn't care. The view in front of my face was like nothing I'd ever seen before. I didn't even care that Sharples was watching. This was... *exciting*. Even though it was my own wife being fucked right in front of my face, it was arousing somehow.

Jessica had another orgasm, her body shuddering on top of mine, her hand forgetting my cock for a moment, slipping from her grasp. I felt her face press into my groin as she cried out, suppressing the moan but again, Conroy didn't stop.

His dick was unrelenting, driving in and out of her, his balls swinging loosely, slapping against her pubes and lower belly, threatening to almost hit me in the face at times and then suddenly, he grunted and held himself inside her.

I could see the underside of the base of his shaft; the thick tube pulsing as he came inside my wife. I saw his balls tighten and throb as he emptied every drop of his cum into her and then just as suddenly, he withdrew and I was presented with the sight of her ravaged pussy slit and gaping hole.

When the cum began to ooze out, I didn't have time to move and even when I did, Jessica moved her legs together around my face and then pushed her pussy back onto my face.

"That's it," Sharples laughed. "Give him that cum."

"Eat it," Jessica said in an incredibly aroused voice and I realised how much this turned her on. "Lick it all out, Lee."

I didn't have any choice. Her pussy was crushed against my nose and mouth, so I stuck out my tongue and ran it the length of her slit, letting it slide against her hole. A mass of cum was in my mouth but I tried to ignore it and did as she told me. It was salty and warm but I did as I was told, letting my tongue play against her swollen lips until they found her clit and then I pressed against her, lapping against it with the flat of my tongue and then swirling it with the tip until she came one more time.

As she did, writhing above me, I grabbed her hips and refused to stop, even though the orgasm only served to squeeze out more of Contoy's cum into my mouth until finally, she told me to stop and then collapsed into a heap on the table.

I turned and looked sideways to see Sharples with his own dick out, pumping it frantically in his hand. It was small, smaller than mine and buried in a dense ball of thick grey pubes but that didn't stop Jessica from sliding off the table after a few seconds to recover from the last orgasm to kneel in front of him.

"On your tits," the fat man gasped and Jess pushed her pale, freckled breasts together just in time to catch the thick stream of semen that shot from the tip of his short penis.

I watched as Jessica helped him to milk the last few drops of cum out of him and then I lay back on the table looking up into the light, the strong taste of Conroy's spunk on my lips and the realisation of what I was in my mind.

I was one of those men who got a kick out of sharing his wife. It'd taken me a long time to figure it out, but it was true. I was a cuckold.

Epilogue

“Cum inside me,” Yvette said, rocking her hips urgently against me. I was lying on our sofa, with Pat’s beautiful wife naked on top of me.

“I don’t want to cum yet,” I moaned. I was enjoying this too much.

“I want it,” she said softly, then leaned back so that she could reach between her legs and play with her clit.

I watched her fingers part her soft, dark pubic hair to find the little pink nub and then begin to tease it as she fucked me. The sight was too much. A few seconds later, I felt my cock stiffen and my balls tighten and then the cum burst from my dick deep into her pussy.

“Okay, Patrick,” Yvette said, moving from the sofa to the armchair where her husband was sitting, watching. “Time to do what you promised.”

“Do I have to?” he grimaced.

“Yes,” said Jessica from his lap. They’d already had sex while Yvette and I watched, Brewster fucking her expertly and making her cum at least twice. “A bet is a bet, that’s what you said.”

Sharples had arranged the card game as promised and it had gone to plan perfectly. The one big hand that he’d said would be ‘fixed’ was dealt, with Pat and I being the two players at the table with the most chips. Pat had been dealt a pair of Kings and I saw his face light up as another third

King was dealt face up, giving him three of a kind. Unfortunately for him, I'd known what was coming. I had Ace/Queen and with a Jack also on the table, that gave me a chance at a straight, five cards in sequence and of course, as I knew would happen, once all of our chips were in the centre, the last card was a Ten. I won.

I'd won enough money to pay off both him and Sharples. The job was complete but what I didn't expect was Brewster to want one last bet.

"One more hand," he'd said. "Just a private bet between us."

"What's at stake?" I'd asked.

"Our wives," he'd said.

The hand we played after that was fair. I nodded and we played one more hand, this time an honest hand. I didn't mind losing. I'd learned over the past few days that I enjoyed - in some strange, masochistic way - Jessica being satisfied by other men. I even liked letting her get her dominant thrill from making me clean her pussy afterwards.

So for me, it was a win/win. If I lost, I got to see Brewster fuck my wife one more time. If I won, I got to fuck Yvette again.

I was dealt a pair of fives. Brewster, Jack-Ten. None of the cards that came down improved his hand and I won. I sat there smiling triumphantly at him for a moment, enjoying his dismay before extending a hand for him to shake.

He took it and as we shook, I leaned over the table and whispered in his ear. "Why don't we both fuck each other's wives?"

The other part of the deal was insisted upon by Jessica afterwards. We could both have sex with each other's partners, but when it came down to it, I'd won. There had to be some sense of victory for me.

And here it was.

“That’s a good boy,” Yvette said as Brewster replaced me on the sofa, so she could straddle her husband’s face. I saw Pat grimace as my cum dribbled out and onto his lips. “Clean me up, Patrick.”

Jess and I looked at each other and we both smiled at the same time as Pat reluctantly licked his wife’s cum-filled pussy. Things hadn’t worked out so bad after all.

Then the door to our living room swung open, just as I heard a familiar voice.

“Are you alright?” Greg said. “You’re not answering your calls or the door and when I tried the handle it was open-” Then he stood there, his mouth agape at the scene before him - four naked people, with one woman riding the face of one of the men. “What the fuck...?” he managed to gasp after a moment.

“Okay,” I began, covering my dick with my hand while rapidly trying to think of an explanation. “Well, the good news is that I’ve got the money I owe you.”

“And the bad news?” he said slowly, his eyes finding Jessica and widening as he saw her nakedness. My wife had made no attempt to cover herself. Instead, she just smiled at him.

“There is no bad news,” she purred. “But you want an explanation of what’s going on here, I’ll tell you. You just have to take your clothes off first.”

I looked at Brewster to see that he was grinning at me. I turned to Yvette to see her eyeing my best friend just as hungrily as Jessica was.

Greg shrugged, smiled and kicked off his shoes.

A Note To The Reader

I just wanted to say thank you very much for purchasing my book, and reading it right to the end! At least I hope you did, and that you didn't just skip forward!

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Until next time,

Paul

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About the Author

Paul Garland is an author of erotic novels and short stories, guaranteed to keep you turning the lust-filled pages until the early hours of the night. He lives with his wife and two children in a small house in the suburbs of Sheffield, England along with a lazy green budgerigar, an African Grey parrot that curses and a tubby tabby cat which would love to eat either. (Preferably the vulgar-tongued parrot.)

He has been writing since the turn of the millennium but only turned to the erotica genre in 2018 with his *Cerulean Erotica Presents* series and *No Angels* series of books which rapidly gained him a following. In 2020, he began ‘*The Cuckold Collection*,’ a brand new collection of cuckold-themed books and two new series of shorter stories: *The No Angels Stories* and *The Sexy Season Shorts* and has yet another as-yet-untitled series in the works for 2021.

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